SIMPLE ENGLISH

From Beginner to Fluent

A complete English course in easy words:
sounds, grammar, all 12 tenses, vocabulary,
speaking, listening, reading, writing
and a 90-day fluency plan

With hundreds of practice exercises and a full answer key

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Part 1: Getting Started

How to use this book, how English works, and the sounds of English

How to Use This Book

Welcome!

Hello, and welcome! If you think your English is "very bad", that is okay. Every person who speaks English well today was once a beginner. Nobody is born speaking English. People learn it, one word at a time, one day at a time. You can do the same.

This book is written in **simple English**. The sentences are short. The words are easy. When we use a new or difficult word, we explain it. You do not need a teacher to use this book. You only need the book, a notebook, a pen, and about **30 to 60 minutes every day**.

What is inside this book?

This book has eight parts:

- **Part 1: Getting Started** – how to study, and the sounds of English.
- **Part 2: Grammar Foundations** – nouns, articles, pronouns, adjectives, the verb "be", and more.
- **Part 3: The 12 Tenses** – how to talk about the past, the present and the future.
- **Part 4: Building Sentences** – questions, negatives, modal verbs, conditionals, passive voice and more.
- **Part 5: Vocabulary** – more than 1,500 useful words, phrasal verbs, idioms and collocations.
- **Part 6: Speaking and Conversation** – real phrases for real life: shops, work, travel, the doctor, the phone.
- **Part 7: Reading, Listening and Writing** – short stories, emails, letters and paragraphs.
- **Part 8: Your Fluency Plan** – a 90-day plan, daily habits, and how to keep improving.

At the end there is an **Answer Key** for every exercise.

How each lesson works

Every grammar lesson follows the same pattern:

- **What it is** – a simple explanation.
- **How to make it** – a table with the form.
- **When to use it** – clear rules with many examples.
- **Common mistakes** – the errors learners make, and the correct way. Look for ✗ (wrong) and ✓ (right).
- **Practice** – exercises. The answers are at the back of the book.

> **Tip:** Yellow boxes like this one give you extra advice. Read them carefully. They help you remember.

Seven rules for learning English fast

Rule 1: A little every day is better than a lot one day

Studying 30 minutes every day is much better than studying 5 hours on Sunday. Your brain learns by repetition. Make English a daily habit, like brushing your teeth.

Rule 2: Learn phrases, not only words

Do not learn only "decision". Learn "**make a decision**". Do not learn only "attention". Learn "**pay attention to**". Native speakers think in groups of words. When you learn groups, you speak faster and more naturally.

Rule 3: Speak out loud

Read every example sentence in this book **out loud**. Your mouth must practise, not only your eyes. Speaking alone in your room is a great exercise. Nobody is listening, so you cannot be embarrassed!

Rule 4: Mistakes are good

Every mistake teaches you something. Children make thousands of mistakes when they learn to speak. They do not stop. They keep talking. Be like a child. Speak, make mistakes, learn, and speak again.

Rule 5: Listen a lot

You cannot speak well if you do not hear English. Listen to English every day: songs, YouTube videos, podcasts, films, news. At first you will understand only a little. That is normal. Keep listening and your ears will learn.

Rule 6: Review old lessons

You will forget things. This is normal. Every week, go back and review what you learned before. Look at your notebook. Read old examples again.

Rule 7: Use English in your real life

Change your phone language to English. Write your shopping list in English. Think in English when you walk or cook. Describe what you see: "I see a red car. The man is crossing the road." Small habits make a big difference.

Your English notebook

Buy a notebook only for English. Divide it into four sections:

Section	What to write
1. New words	The word, its meaning, and one example sentence that you write yourself.
2. Phrases	Useful phrases you hear or read, e.g. "Could you say that again, please?"
3. Mistakes	Your own mistakes and the correct version.
4. Diary	Three to five sentences every day about your day.

> **Tip:** Writing by hand helps your memory more than typing. Try to write a little every day.

How fast can I improve?

This depends on you. If you study one hour every day and follow the 90-day plan in Part 8, you can expect big changes:

Time	What you can do
After 30 days	Introduce yourself, talk about your day, ask simple questions, understand simple sentences.
After 60 days	Use all the main tenses, talk about the past and future, write a short email, follow slow conversations.
After 90 days	Have real conversations on everyday topics, explain your opinions, understand much more of what you hear.
After 6–12 months	Speak with confidence, understand films with subtitles, write clearly, keep improving on your own.

Fluency does not mean "perfect". Fluency means you can **communicate easily**, without stopping all the time. Many fluent speakers still make small mistakes. That is fine!

A suggested daily routine (45–60 minutes)

Time	Activity
10 minutes	Review: read your notebook and yesterday's lesson.
20 minutes	New lesson from this book. Read examples out loud.
10 minutes	Do the practice exercises. Check the answer key.
10 minutes	Listen to something in English (a song, video or podcast).
5 minutes	Write 3–5 sentences in your diary.

Set your goal

Before you start, answer these questions in your notebook:

- Why do I want to learn English? (job, study, travel, friends, films, confidence)
- What do I want to be able to do in 3 months?
- When will I study every day? (For example: 7:00–7:45 in the morning.)
- Where will I study?

Write your answers and read them when you feel tired or lazy. Your reason is your fuel.

✎ Practice: Getting ready

1. How many minutes per day does this book suggest you study?

2. Is it better to study 5 hours on Sunday or 30 minutes every day?

3. Should you learn "decision" or "make a decision"?

4. What do the symbols ✗ and ✓ mean?

5. What are the four sections of your English notebook?

The English Alphabet and Sounds

The 26 letters

English has 26 letters. 5 are **vowels**: A, E, I, O, U. The other 21 are **consonants**. (Sometimes Y works like a vowel, as in "my" and "happy".)

Letter	Name sounds like	Example word
A a	"ay"	apple, cake
B b	"bee"	ball, baby
C c	"see"	cat, city
D d	"dee"	dog, door
E e	"ee"	egg, tree
F f	"ef"	fish, phone (ph = f)
G g	"jee"	go, giraffe
H h	"aych"	hat, house
I i	"eye"	ink, ice
J j	"jay"	jam, job
K k	"kay"	king, kite
L l	"el"	lion, lamp
M m	"em"	man, milk
N n	"en"	nose, nine

Letter	Name sounds like	Example word
O o	"oh"	orange, open
P p	"pee"	pen, pizza
Q q	"kyoo"	queen, quick
R r	"ar"	red, rain
S s	"es"	sun, rose (s = z)
T t	"tee"	tea, table
U u	"yoo"	umbrella, use
V v	"vee"	van, very
W w	"double-yoo"	water, window
X x	"eks"	box, six
Y y	"why"	yes, yellow
Z z	"zed" (UK) / "zee" (US)	zoo, zero

Tip: When you spell your name on the phone, say each letter clearly: "My name is Ravi: R – A – V – I."

English spelling is not always the same as the sound

In many languages, you say a word exactly as you write it. In English, this is not always true. The same letters can have different sounds:

- "ough" in **though** (oh), **through** (oo), **tough** (uff), **thought** (aw)
- "ea" in **eat** (ee), **bread** (e), **great** (ay)
- "oo" in **food** (oo), **good** (u), **blood** (uh)

Do not worry. You will learn the sounds by listening and repeating. When you learn a new word, always check how to say it. Use an online dictionary and press the speaker button to hear it.

Short and long vowel sounds

Short vowels

Vowel	Sound	Examples
a	/æ/ as in "cat"	hat, bag, man, apple, black
e	/e/ as in "bed"	pen, red, ten, egg, desk
i	/ɪ/ as in "sit"	big, fish, milk, ship, sit
o	/ɒ/ as in "hot"	dog, box, stop, hot, not
u	/ʌ/ as in "cup"	bus, sun, run, cut, but

Long vowels

A long vowel often "says its name". A silent "e" at the end of a word often makes the vowel long.

Short	Long (with silent e)
cap	cape
hat	hate
pet	Pete
bit	bite
kit	kite
hop	hope
not	note
cut	cute
tub	tube

Important pairs: ship or sheep?

Many learners say "ship" and "sheep" the same way. They are different! "Ship" has a short /ɪ/. "Sheep" has a long /iː/ – make your mouth wide like a smile and hold the sound longer.

Short /ɪ/	Long /iː/
ship	sheep

Short /ɪ/	Long /iː/
sit	seat
live	leave
fill	feel
hit	heat
bit	beat
chip	cheap
still	steal

Practise saying each pair out loud. "I live here." / "I leave at six."

Full /uː/ and short /ʊ/

Short /ʊ/	Long /uː/
full	fool
pull	pool
look	Luke
good	food (different spelling, same long sound in food)

Difficult consonant sounds

TH – two sounds

Put the tip of your tongue **between your teeth** and blow air.

- Voiceless /θ/ (no voice, only air): **think, thank, three, thing, mouth, birthday**
- Voiced /ð/ (with voice, it vibrates): **this, that, they, mother, brother, the**

  ✗ "I tink so." ✓ "I think so."

  ✗ "Dis is my bruder." ✓ "This is my brother."

V and W

- **V**: top teeth touch your bottom lip. Voice on: **very, van, voice, love, give**
- **W**: make your lips round like a small circle, then open: **we, water, window, wine, what**

Say: "**V**ery **w**ell", "**W**e **v**isit **V**ienna every **w**inter."

P and F

- **P**: close lips, then pop: **pan, pin, pool**
- **F**: top teeth on bottom lip, blow: **fan, fin, fool**

L and R

- **L**: tongue touches the top of your mouth behind your teeth: **light, love, long**
- **R**: tongue does not touch anything; curl it back a little: **right, red, road**

Pairs: light/right, lead/read, long/wrong, glass/grass, fly/fry.

S and SH

- **S**: like a snake: **see, sip, sort, sell**
- **SH**: lips forward, like telling someone to be quiet: **she, ship, short, shell**

Silent letters

Some letters are written but **not** spoken:

Silent letter	Examples
k (before n)	**k**now, **k**nife, **k**nee, **k**nock
w (before r)	**w**rite, **w**rong, **w**rist
b (after m)	clim**b**, com**b**, thum**b**, bom**b**
h	**h**our, **h**onest, w**h**at (often), g**h**ost
l	ta**l**k, wa**l**k, ha**l**f, cou**l**d, shou**l**d, wou**l**d
t	lis**t**en, cas**t**le, of**t**en (often both ways)
gh	nigh**t**, ligh**t**, daugh**t**er, though
p	**p**sychology, recei**p**t

The -ed ending: three sounds

The past tense ending **-ed** has three pronunciations:

Sound	When	Examples
/t/	after p, k, f, s, sh, ch (no voice)	helped, worked, laughed, missed, washed, watched
/d/	after voiced sounds	played, called, lived, opened, cleaned
/ɪd/ (extra syllable)	after t or d	wanted, needed, started, decided

✗ "work-ed" (two syllables) ✓ "workt" (one syllable)

✗ "want" + "ed" said as "wantt" ✓ "want-id" (two syllables)

The -s ending: three sounds

Sound	Examples
/s/	cats, books, stops, laughs
/z/	dogs, pens, plays, lives
/ɪz/ (extra syllable)	buses, watches, washes, boxes, pages

Word stress

In English words with two or more syllables, one syllable is **stronger** (louder and longer). This is called **stress**. Wrong stress can make you hard to understand.

Word	Stress (CAPITAL = strong)
photograph	PHO-to-graph
photographer	pho-TO-gra-pher
banana	ba-NA-na
computer	com-PU-ter
hotel	ho-TEL
important	im-POR-tant
comfortable	COMF-ta-ble
vegetable	VEJ-ta-ble

Word	Stress (CAPITAL = strong)
interesting	IN-tres-ting
develop	de-VEL-op

Nouns and verbs

Some words are a noun **and** a verb. Often the noun has stress at the front, the verb at the end:

Noun	Verb
a RE-cord	to re-CORD
a PRE-sent (gift)	to pre-SENT
an OB-ject	to ob-JECT
an IN-crease	to in-CREASE
an EX-port	to ex-PORT

Sentence stress and rhythm

In a sentence, we stress the **important words** (nouns, main verbs, adjectives, adverbs, negatives). Small words (a, the, to, of, is, are) are weak and fast.

- I **WANT** to **GO** to the **PARK**.
- She **BOUGHT** a **NEW CAR** last **WEEK**.
- We **DIDN'T SEE** him.

English has a "da-DUM da-DUM" rhythm. Listen to native speakers and copy their music, not only their words.

Weak forms

Small words often become very short in natural speech:

Written	Natural speech
to	/tə/ — "I want tə go."
for	/fə/ — "This is fə you."
and	/ən/ — "bread ən butter"

Written	Natural speech
can	/kən/ — "I kən swim." (but "Yes, I **can**." is strong)
of	/əv/ — "a cup əv tea"

Connected speech

Native speakers join words together:

- "an apple" sounds like "a-napple"
- "turn off" sounds like "tur-noff"
- "want to" sounds like "wanna" (informal)
- "going to" sounds like "gonna" (informal)
- "got to" sounds like "gotta" (informal)
- "Did you" sounds like "Didja"
- "What do you" sounds like "Whaddaya"

> **Tip:** You do not need to speak like this. But you must **understand** it, because native speakers do it all the time.

Intonation: the music of your voice

- **Falling** tone (voice goes down) for statements and Wh- questions: "I live in Delhi. ↘" "Where do you work? ↘"
- **Rising** tone (voice goes up) for yes/no questions: "Do you like coffee? ↗" "Are you ready? ↗"
- Lists: rise, rise, fall: "I bought apples ↗, bananas ↗, and oranges ↘."

✎ Practice: Sounds and spelling

1. Which letter is silent in "knife"?

2. Which letter is silent in "listen"?

3. How do you say the -ed in "wanted": /t/, /d/ or /ɪd/?

4. How do you say the -ed in "played"?

5. How do you say the -ed in "watched"?

6. How many syllables does "watches" have?

7. Where is the stress in "banana"?

8. Where is the stress in "photographer"?

9. Does your voice go up or down at the end of "Are you hungry?"

10. Which is longer: the vowel in "ship" or in "sheep"?

11. Which letter is silent in "hour"?

12. Which letter is silent in "climb"?

Part 2: Grammar Foundations

The building blocks of every English sentence

Parts of Speech: The 8 Word Families

Why learn parts of speech?

Every English word belongs to a family. When you know the family, you know **where to put the word** in a sentence. This is the secret of good grammar.

Part of speech	What it does	Examples
Noun	names a person, place, thing or idea	teacher, Mumbai, phone, love
Pronoun	takes the place of a noun	I, you, he, she, it, we, they
Verb	shows an action or a state	run, eat, think, is, have
Adjective	describes a noun	big, happy, red, beautiful
Adverb	describes a verb, adjective or another adverb	quickly, very, always, well
Preposition	shows place, time or direction	in, on, at, under, before
Conjunction	joins words or sentences	and, but, or, because, so
Interjection	shows a sudden feeling	Wow! Oh! Ouch! Hey!

Look at one sentence

"**Wow**, my **young** brother **quickly ate three apples and** a banana **in** the kitchen."

Word	Part of speech
Wow	interjection
my	possessive adjective (determiner)
young	adjective
brother	noun
quickly	adverb
ate	verb
three	number (determiner)
apples	noun

Word	Part of speech
and	conjunction
in	preposition
kitchen	noun

Basic English word order: S + V + O

English has a **fixed word order**. This is very important. The basic order is:

Subject + Verb + Object (+ Place + Time)

Subject (who?)	Verb (action)	Object (what?)	Place (where?)	Time (when?)
I	eat	rice	at home	every day.
She	watched	a film	at the cinema	yesterday.
We	will visit	our grandparents	in Pune	next week.
They	play	football	in the park	on Sundays.

✗ I rice eat. ✓ I eat rice.

✗ Yesterday a film she watched. ✓ She watched a film yesterday. (or: Yesterday, she watched a film.)

> **Tip:** Remember "**S-V-O-P-T**": Subject, Verb, Object, Place, Time. Place usually comes before time.

Every sentence needs a subject and a verb

In some languages, you can drop the subject. In English, you almost always need it.

✗ Is raining. ✓ **It** is raining.

✗ Is very hot today. ✓ **It** is very hot today.

✗ Am happy. ✓ **I** am happy.

✗ My brother very tall. ✓ My brother **is** very tall.

One word, many families

The same root can change its family by adding an ending (suffix):

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
happiness	–	happy	happily
beauty	beautify	beautiful	beautifully
success	succeed	successful	successfully
decision	decide	decisive	decisively
care	care	careful	carefully
danger	endanger	dangerous	dangerously
education	educate	educational	educationally
strength	strengthen	strong	strongly
speed	speed	quick / fast	quickly / fast
difference	differ	different	differently

Common endings help you guess the family

Ending	Usually a...	Examples
-tion, -sion, -ment, -ness, -ity, -er, -or	noun	information, decision, payment, kindness, city, teacher, actor
-ful, -less, -ous, -ive, -able, -al, -ic, -y	adjective	helpful, useless, famous, active, comfortable, national, basic, sunny
-ly	adverb (usually)	slowly, really, happily
-ize, -ise, -en, -fy, -ate	verb	organize, widen, simplify, create

✎ Practice: Name the part of speech of the word in bold

1. She is a **doctor**.

2. They **run** every morning.

3. It is a **beautiful** day.

4. He speaks **slowly**.

5. The cat is **under** the table.

6. I like tea **but** I don't like coffee.

7. She is my sister.

8. Ouch! That hurts.

9. This test is **very** easy.

10. We need more **information**.

✎ Practice: Put the words in the correct order

1. football / play / on Sundays / we

2. my mother / tea / drinks / every morning

3. a new phone / bought / he / yesterday

4. at school / English / they / study

5. is / it / cold / today

Nouns: Singular, Plural, Countable, Uncountable

What is a noun?

A noun is a name. It can be a person (**girl, doctor, Amit**), a place (**school, London, park**), a thing (**book, car, water**), an animal (**dog, bird**) or an idea (**love, freedom, time**).

Common and proper nouns

- **Common nouns** are general names: city, river, boy, month. Write them with a small letter.
- **Proper nouns** are special names: Delhi, the Ganges, Rahul, January. Always start them with a **capital letter**.

  ✗ I live in mumbai. ✓ I live in **M**umbai.

  ✗ My birthday is in july. ✓ My birthday is in **J**uly.

> **Tip:** In English we use capital letters for days (Monday), months (March), languages (English, Hindi), nationalities (Indian, French) and the word "I".

Making plurals

The normal rule: add -s

book → books, car → cars, friend → friends, apple → apples

Add -es after s, ss, sh, ch, x, z (and some words ending in o)

Singular	Plural
bus	buses
class	classes
dish	dishes
watch	watches
box	boxes
tomato	tomatoes

Singular	Plural
potato	potatoes
hero	heroes

But: photo → photos, piano → pianos, radio → radios, video → videos.

Consonant + y → -ies

baby → babies, city → cities, country → countries, party → parties, story → stories

But vowel + y → just add -s: boy → boys, day → days, key → keys, toy → toys

-f / -fe → -ves

leaf → leaves, knife → knives, wife → wives, life → lives, half → halves, wolf → wolves, shelf → shelves

But: roof → roofs, chef → chefs, belief → beliefs

Irregular plurals – learn these by heart!

Singular	Plural
man	men
woman	women
child	children
person	people
foot	feet
tooth	teeth
mouse	mice
goose	geese
ox	oxen

Same in singular and plural

sheep → sheep, fish → fish, deer → deer, series → series, species → species

Always plural

trousers, jeans, shorts, glasses (for eyes), scissors, clothes, police

- My jeans **are** blue. (not "is")
- The police **are** here.
- I need **a pair of** scissors.

Countable and uncountable nouns

This is one of the most important topics in English grammar.

Countable nouns can be counted: one apple, two apples, three apples. They have a singular and plural form.

Uncountable nouns cannot be counted with numbers. They have **no plural**. We cannot use "a/an" with them.

Countable	Uncountable
a chair, two chairs	furniture
a suitcase, bags	luggage / baggage
a coin, a note	money
a job	work
a suggestion, a tip	advice
a fact, a news story	information, news
a word	vocabulary
a song	music
a loaf, a slice	bread
a meal	food
a car	traffic
a trip, a journey	travel

More uncountable nouns

- **Liquids**: water, milk, juice, tea, coffee, oil
- **Materials**: wood, paper, glass, plastic, gold
- **Food**: rice, sugar, salt, bread, cheese, butter, meat

- **Ideas**: love, happiness, time, help, knowledge, patience, fun
- **Other**: homework, equipment, research, weather, hair, electricity

  ✗ I need an advice. ✓ I need **some advice**. / I need **a piece of** advice.

  ✗ She gave me many informations. ✓ She gave me **a lot of information**.

  ✗ The news are bad. ✓ The news **is** bad.

  ✗ I have a lot of homeworks. ✓ I have a lot of **homework**.

  ✗ We bought new furnitures. ✓ We bought new **furniture**.

  ✗ His hairs are long. ✓ His **hair is** long.

How to "count" uncountable nouns

Use a container or unit word:

Unit	Examples
a glass of	water, milk, juice
a cup of	tea, coffee
a bottle of	water, oil, wine
a piece of	advice, information, paper, cake, furniture
a slice of	bread, pizza, cheese
a loaf of	bread
a kilo of	rice, sugar, meat
a bowl of	rice, soup
a packet of	biscuits, crisps
a bar of	chocolate, soap
a spoonful of	sugar, salt
a drop of	water, rain

Possessive nouns ('s)

Use **'s** to show that something belongs to someone.

- Riya's bag (the bag of Riya)
- my father's car
- the teacher's desk

For plural nouns ending in -s, add only an apostrophe (') :

- my parents' house (two parents)
- the students' books

For irregular plurals, add 's: the children's toys, the women's room, people's opinions.

✗ The car of my father is new. ✓ My father's car is new.

Tip: Use 's mainly for people and animals. For things, we often use "of": the end **of** the film, the top **of** the page, the name **of** the street.

✎ Practice: Write the plural

1. book
2. box
3. city
4. child
5. knife
6. tooth
7. boy
8. woman
9. potato
10. sheep
11. person
12. watch

✎ Practice: Countable (C) or uncountable (U)?

1. chair

2. water

3. advice

4. egg

5. luggage

6. information

7. friend

8. music

9. idea

10. homework

✎ Practice: Correct the mistake

1. I have many homeworks.

2. Can you give me an advice?

3. The news are very good.

4. This is the house of my uncle.

5. The childrens are playing.

Articles: A, An and The

What are articles?

Articles are small words that come before nouns. English has three: **a**, **an** and **the**. Many languages do not have articles, so learners often forget them. Practise them carefully – they appear in almost every sentence!

A and An (the indefinite article)

Use **a** or **an** with a **singular countable noun** when:

- you talk about it for the **first time**: "I saw **a** dog in the street."
- it is **one of many** / not a specific one: "Can I borrow **a** pen?"
- you say someone's **job**: "She is **a** nurse." "He is **an** engineer."
- you describe something: "It's **a** beautiful day."

A or an?

The rule is about the **sound**, not the letter.

- **a** + consonant **sound**: a book, a car, **a university** (you-ni...), **a European** country, **a one**-way street
- **an** + vowel **sound**: an apple, an egg, an idea, an orange, an umbrella, **an hour** (h is silent), **an honest** man, **an MBA** (em-bee-ay)

  ✗ She is engineer. ✓ She is **an** engineer.

  ✗ I have a umbrella. ✓ I have **an** umbrella.

  ✗ He is an university student. ✓ He is **a** university student.

The (the definite article)

Use **the** when the listener knows **which one** you mean.

- When you mention something **again**: "I saw a dog. **The** dog was very big."
- When there is **only one**: **the** sun, **the** moon, **the** world, **the** sky, **the** Internet
- When it is clear from the situation: "Close **the** door, please." (the door of this room)
- With superlatives: **the** best, **the** tallest, **the** most important

- With ordinal numbers: **the** first, **the** second, **the** last
- With some places: **the** cinema, **the** theatre, **the** bank, **the** post office, **the** station
- With musical instruments: play **the** guitar, play **the** piano
- With rivers, seas, oceans, mountain ranges: **the** Ganges, **the** Pacific Ocean, **the** Himalayas
- With some countries: **the** USA, **the** UK, **the** Netherlands, **the** Philippines
- With plural family names: **the** Sharmas (the Sharma family)

No article (zero article)

Do **not** use an article:

- With plural or uncountable nouns used in a general sense: "**Dogs** are friendly." "I love **music**." "**Water** is important."
- With names of people, most cities and countries: **Priya**, **Paris**, **India**, **Japan**
- With meals: have **breakfast**, have **lunch**, have **dinner**
- With languages and school subjects: I speak **English**. I study **maths**.
- With sports: play **cricket**, play **football**
- With days, months, years: on **Monday**, in **June**, in **2026**
- In some fixed phrases: go to **school**, go to **work**, go to **bed**, go **home**, at **night**, by **bus**, by **car**, in **hospital** (UK)

  ✗ I love the music. (meaning music in general) ✓ I love music.

  ✗ The life is beautiful. ✓ Life is beautiful.

  ✗ I go to the home at 6. ✓ I go home at 6.

  ✗ She plays guitar very well. (US accepts this, but standard is) ✓ She plays **the** guitar very well.

  ✗ I had a lunch with my friend. ✓ I had lunch with my friend.

General or specific?

Compare:

General (no article)	Specific (the)
I like **coffee**.	**The coffee** in this café is excellent.
Children need love.	**The children** in my class are noisy.
Money isn't everything.	Where is **the money** I gave you?
Books are expensive.	**The books** on the table are mine.

School, hospital, prison, church

- "He goes to **school**." = he is a student (the normal purpose).
- "His mother went to **the school** to talk to the teacher." = she visited the building.
- "She is in **hospital**." (UK) = she is a patient.
- "I went to **the hospital** to visit her." = visiting the building.

Article summary table

Situation	Article	Example
First mention, singular	a / an	I bought **a** shirt.
Second mention	the	**The** shirt is blue.
Only one exists	the	**The** moon is bright.
Jobs	a / an	He's **a** pilot.
General plural	–	**Cats** like milk.
General uncountable	–	**Sugar** is sweet.
Names, cities, countries	–	**Ravi** lives in **Chennai**.
Superlatives	the	the best day
Meals, sports, languages	–	have **dinner**, play **tennis**, learn **French**

✎ Practice: Write a, an, the or – (no article)

1. I saw ___ elephant at the zoo.

2. She is ___ teacher.

3. ___ sun is very hot today.

4. I love ___ chocolate.

5. He is ___ honest man.

6. Can you close ___ window, please?

7. We had ___ dinner at 8 o'clock.

8. She is ___ best student in the class.

9. I need ___ umbrella. It's raining.

10. My brother plays ___ piano.

11. They live in ___ India.

12. It takes ___ hour to get there.

13. ___ Himalayas are very high mountains.

14. I bought a book and a pen. ___ book was expensive.

15. He studies at ___ university in Delhi.

Pronouns and Possessives

Subject and object pronouns

Pronouns take the place of nouns, so we do not repeat words.

"Ali is my friend. **Ali** lives near me." → "Ali is my friend. **He** lives near me."

Subject pronoun	Object pronoun	Possessive adjective	Possessive pronoun	Reflexive pronoun
I	me	my	mine	myself
you	you	your	yours	yourself / yourselves
he	him	his	his	himself
she	her	her	hers	herself
it	it	its	–	itself
we	us	our	ours	ourselves
they	them	their	theirs	themselves

Subject pronouns

Use them **before** the verb – they do the action.

- **I** like tea.
- **She** works in a bank.
- **They** are my cousins.
- **It** is raining. (We use "it" for weather, time and distance: "It's 5 o'clock." "It's 10 km to the city.")

Object pronouns

Use them **after** the verb or **after a preposition** – they receive the action.

- Call **me** tomorrow.
- I love **her**.
- Can you help **us**?
- This gift is for **you**.

- Come with **them**.
  ✗ Me and my friend went shopping. ✓ My friend and **I** went shopping.
  ✗ She gave the book to I. ✓ She gave the book to **me**.
  ✗ Between you and I... ✓ Between you and **me**...

Possessive adjectives and pronouns

Possessive adjectives come **before a noun**: my book, your car, her phone, our house, their dog.

Possessive pronouns stand **alone** (no noun after them): The book is **mine**. Is this pen **yours**? The red car is **hers**.

- This is **my** bag. → This bag is **mine**.
- That is **their** house. → That house is **theirs**.
  ✗ This is mine bag. ✓ This is **my** bag.
  ✗ The phone is her. ✓ The phone is **hers**.

Its or it's?

- **its** = possessive: "The dog wagged **its** tail."
- **it's** = it is / it has: "**It's** cold today." "**It's** been a long day."

Your or you're?

- **your** = possessive: "Is this **your** pen?"
- **you're** = you are: "**You're** very kind."

Their, there or they're?

- **their** = possessive: "**Their** house is big."
- **there** = place / there is: "Put it **there**." "**There** is a problem."
- **they're** = they are: "**They're** coming at 6."

Reflexive pronouns

Use them when the subject and the object are the **same person**:

- I cut **myself** while cooking.
- She taught **herself** to play the guitar.
- Enjoy **yourselves** at the party!
- He looked at **himself** in the mirror.

Also for emphasis: "I made this cake **myself**." (nobody helped me)

"**by myself**" = alone: "I live **by myself**."

✗ He hurt hisself. ✓ He hurt **himself**.

✗ They enjoyed theirselves. ✓ They enjoyed **themselves**.

Demonstratives: this, that, these, those

	Near (here)	Far (there)
Singular	this book	that book
Plural	these books	those books

- **This** is my brother. (he is next to me)
- Look at **that** bird! (it is far away)
- **These** shoes are comfortable.
- Who are **those** people?

On the phone: "Hello, **this is** Sara." (not "I am Sara")

Indefinite pronouns

	Person	Thing	Place
some-	someone / somebody	something	somewhere
any-	anyone / anybody	anything	anywhere
no-	no one / nobody	nothing	nowhere
every-	everyone / everybody	everything	everywhere

- **Someone** is at the door.
- Is there **anything** to eat?

- **Nobody** knows the answer.
- **Everyone** is happy. (singular verb: "is", not "are")
- I can't find my keys **anywhere**.

✗ Nobody don't know. ✓ Nobody knows. (only one negative)

✗ Everybody are here. ✓ Everybody **is** here.

Who, whose

- **Who** is that man? (person)
- **Whose** bag is this? (who is the owner?) – "It's Maria's." / "It's mine."

✗ Who's bag is this? ✓ **Whose** bag is this?

✎ Practice: Choose the correct pronoun

1. (I / Me) am a student.

2. Please help (we / us).

3. This is (my / mine) phone.

4. The blue car is (our / ours).

5. She hurt (herself / himself).

6. (Their / There / They're) going to the cinema.

7. The cat is cleaning (its / it's) paws.

8. Give the keys to (him / he).

9. (Whose / Who's) jacket is this?

10. Look at (that / those) stars!

11. My brother and (I / me) went to the market.

12. Is this umbrella (your / yours)?

13. (Everybody / Nobody) is here, so we can start.

14. They built the house (themselves / theirselves).

15. (Your / You're) my best friend.

The Verb "To Be"

Why "be" is so important

"Be" is the most common verb in English. We use it to say who we are, what we are like, where we are, our age, our feelings and much more. It is also used to make other tenses (I am working, it was made).

Present: am, is, are

Positive	Short form	Negative	Short form
I am	I'm	I am not	I'm not
You are	You're	You are not	You aren't / You're not
He is	He's	He is not	He isn't / He's not
She is	She's	She is not	She isn't / She's not
It is	It's	It is not	It isn't / It's not
We are	We're	We are not	We aren't / We're not
They are	They're	They are not	They aren't / They're not

Tip: In speaking, we almost always use short forms: "I'm tired." "She's at home." "They aren't here." This sounds natural.

Questions with be

Change the order: **Be + subject + ...?**

Question	Short answer: yes	Short answer: no
Am I late?	Yes, you are.	No, you aren't.
Are you a student?	Yes, I am.	No, I'm not.
Is he your brother?	Yes, he is.	No, he isn't.
Is it cold?	Yes, it is.	No, it isn't.
Are they at home?	Yes, they are.	No, they aren't.

✗ Yes, I'm. ✓ Yes, I **am**. (no short form in positive short answers)

Wh- questions with be

- **Where** are you from? – I'm from Kerala.
- **What** is your name? – My name is Anjali.
- **How** are you? – I'm fine, thanks.
- **How old** is your son? – He's seven.
- **Who** is that woman? – She's my aunt.
- **Why** are you sad? – Because I lost my phone.
- **When** is your birthday? – It's on 5th May.

Uses of "be"

Use	Example
Name	I'm Karan.
Job	She's a dentist.
Nationality / origin	We're Indian. They're from Brazil.
Age	I'm 25 (years old).
Feelings	He's hungry. I'm nervous.
Description	The house is big. You're tall.
Place	The keys are on the table.
Time / weather	It's 3 o'clock. It's sunny.
Price	It's 200 rupees. How much are these shoes?

✗ I have 25 years. ✓ I **am** 25 years old.

✗ I have hungry. ✓ I **am** hungry.

✗ She is agree with me. ✓ She agrees with me.

✗ I am understand. ✓ I understand.

Past: was and were

Positive	Negative	Question
I was	I wasn't	Was I...?
You were	You weren't	Were you...?
He / She / It was	He / She / It wasn't	Was he / she / it...?
We were	We weren't	Were we...?
They were	They weren't	Were they...?

- I **was** at home yesterday.
- They **were** very tired after the trip.
- It **wasn't** expensive.
- **Were** you at the party? – Yes, I **was**. / No, I **wasn't**.
- Where **were** you last night?

✗ They was late. ✓ They **were** late.

There is / There are

Use **there is / there are** to say that something **exists** or is in a place.

	Singular / uncountable	Plural
Positive	There is (There's) a bank near here.	There are three banks in this street.
Negative	There isn't any milk.	There aren't any chairs.
Question	Is there a hospital?	Are there any shops?
Past	There was a storm.	There were many people.
Future	There will be a meeting.	There will be problems.

✗ In my city have many parks. ✓ In my city **there are** many parks.

✗ Have a problem with my computer. ✓ **There is** a problem with my computer.

✗ There is many cars. ✓ There **are** many cars.

✎ Practice: Complete with am, is or are

1. I ___ hungry.
2. She ___ a doctor.
3. They ___ my friends.
4. It ___ very hot today.
5. We ___ from Nepal.
6. ___ you ready?
7. My parents ___ at work.
8. The book ___ on the table.

✎ Practice: Complete with was or were

1. I ___ tired yesterday.
2. They ___ at the cinema.
3. ___ she at school last week?
4. We ___ not happy with the hotel.
5. The film ___ very long.

✎ Practice: Correct the mistakes

1. I have 30 years old.
2. She is agree with you.
3. In my village have a big temple.
4. Yes, I'm.
5. There is two cats in the garden.

Have and Have Got

Have for possession

We use **have** to talk about things we own, family, illnesses and features.

Positive	Negative	Question
I / You / We / They **have**	I / You / We / They **don't have**	**Do** I / you / we / they **have**...?
He / She / It **has**	He / She / It **doesn't have**	**Does** he / she / it **have**...?

- I **have** two brothers.
- She **has** long hair.
- We **don't have** a car.
- **Does** he **have** a job? – Yes, he **does**. / No, he **doesn't**.
- I **have** a headache.

  ✗ She have a new phone. ✓ She **has** a new phone.

  ✗ He doesn't has time. ✓ He doesn't **have** time.

  ✗ Does she has a sister? ✓ Does she **have** a sister?

Tip: After "does" and "doesn't", the verb always returns to its base form: does + have, doesn't + have.

Have got (mostly British English, informal)

"Have got" means the same as "have" for possession.

Positive	Negative	Question
I've got a cat.	I haven't got a cat.	Have you got a cat?
She's got a cold.	She hasn't got a cold.	Has she got a cold?

Past: had

- I **had** a bicycle when I was a child.
- **Did** you **have** a good time? – Yes, I **did**.
- We **didn't have** enough money.

Have for actions (not possession)

"Have" is also used in many fixed expressions. Here it is an action, so we can use continuous tenses ("I'm having lunch").

Expression	Example
have breakfast / lunch / dinner	We have dinner at 8.
have a shower / bath	I'm having a shower.
have a good time	Have a good time at the party!
have a party	We're having a party on Saturday.
have a rest / a break	Let's have a break.
have a look	Can I have a look?
have a chat / a conversation	We had a long chat.
have a problem / difficulty	I have a problem with my laptop.
have a baby	She had a baby last month.
have fun	We had fun at the beach.
have a try / a go	Let me have a go.
have a meeting	I have a meeting at 10.
have an argument	They had an argument.
have a drink / a coffee	Let's have a coffee.

✗ I am having a car. (possession) ✓ I **have** a car.

✓ I'm **having** dinner now. (action – correct)

Have to (obligation)

"Have to" means it is necessary.

- I **have to** go to work at 8.
- She **has to** wear a uniform.
- We **don't have to** pay. It's free. (= it is not necessary)
- **Do** you **have to** work on Saturdays?
- I **had to** wait for an hour. (past)

(See the chapter on modal verbs for more.)

✎ Practice: Complete with have, has, don't have or doesn't have

1. My sister ___ three children.

2. I ___ a car, so I go by bus.

3. ___ your brother have a job?

4. They ___ a big house with a garden.

5. He ___ any money. He is poor.

6. We ___ English classes on Monday and Friday.

✎ Practice: Correct the mistakes

1. She have a beautiful voice.

2. Does he has a car?

3. I am having two sisters.

4. He doesn't has a passport.

5. We had a fun at the party.

Adjectives: Describing Things

What is an adjective?

An adjective describes a noun. It tells us **what kind**, **what colour**, **how big**, **how many** and more.

- a **red** car, a **tall** man, **cold** water, an **interesting** book

Where do adjectives go?

1. **Before a noun**: a **big** house, **delicious** food

2. **After be, look, seem, feel, taste, smell, sound, become, get**: The house is **big**. You look **tired**. This soup tastes **good**.

✗ a house big ✓ a **big** house

✗ the girl beautiful ✓ the **beautiful** girl

Adjectives never take -s

✗ They are goods students. ✓ They are **good** students.

✗ I have two reds cars. ✓ I have two **red** cars.

Order of adjectives

When you use two or more adjectives, there is a usual order:

Opinion	Size	Age	Shape	Colour	Origin	Material	Purpose	Noun
beautiful	big	old	round	brown	Italian	wooden	dining	table
lovely	small	new	–	white	Indian	cotton	–	shirt

- a **lovely little old** house
- a **big black leather** bag
- **beautiful long black** hair
- a **new red sports** car

> **Tip:** In real life we rarely use more than two or three adjectives together. Remember: **opinion** first, then **facts** (size, age, colour...).

-ed and -ing adjectives

This is a very common mistake!

- **-ed** adjectives describe **how a person feels**: I'm **bored**. She is **interested** in art. We were **tired**.
- **-ing** adjectives describe **the thing that causes the feeling**: The film is **boring**. Art is **interesting**. It was a **tiring** day.

-ed (feeling)	-ing (cause)
bored	boring
interested	interesting
excited	exciting
tired	tiring
surprised	surprising
confused	confusing
embarrassed	embarrassing
frightened	frightening
worried	worrying
amazed	amazing
annoyed	annoying
disappointed	disappointing
relaxed	relaxing
satisfied	satisfying

✗ I am very boring in this class. ✓ I am very **bored** in this class. ("I am boring" means you make other people bored!)

✗ The news was very shocked. ✓ The news was very **shocking**.

Comparatives and superlatives

We use **comparatives** to compare two things: "Delhi is **bigger than** Jaipur."

We use **superlatives** to compare one thing with a whole group: "Mumbai is **the biggest** city in India."

The rules

Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
One syllable: add -er / -est	tall → taller	the tallest
	cheap → cheaper	the cheapest
	old → older	the oldest
Ends in -e: add -r / -st	nice → nicer	the nicest
	large → larger	the largest
One vowel + one consonant: double the consonant	big → bigger	the biggest
	hot → hotter	the hottest
	thin → thinner	the thinnest
Ends in -y: y → -ier / -iest	happy → happier	the happiest
	easy → easier	the easiest
	busy → busier	the busiest
Two or more syllables: more / most	beautiful → more beautiful	the most beautiful
	expensive → more expensive	the most expensive
	interesting → more interesting	the most interesting

Irregular forms – very common!

Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
good	better	the best
bad	worse	the worst
far	farther / further	the farthest / furthest

Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
little (amount)	less	the least
much / many	more	the most

Examples

- My brother is **taller than** me.
- This phone is **more expensive than** that one.
- Today is **hotter than** yesterday.
- She is **the best** singer in our school.
- That was **the worst** day of my life.
- Gold is **heavier than** silver.
- This is **the most beautiful** place I have ever seen.

  ✗ He is more tall than me. ✓ He is **taller** than me.

  ✗ She is the most good. ✓ She is **the best**.

  ✗ This is more better. ✓ This is **better**. (never "more better")

  ✗ He is taller then me. ✓ He is taller **than** me. ("then" = after that)

Other ways to compare

as ... as (the same)

- She is **as tall as** her mother. (same height)
- This book is **not as interesting as** the film. (the film is more interesting)
- Come **as soon as** possible.

less ... than

- This hotel is **less expensive than** that one.

much / a lot / a bit / slightly + comparative

- He is **much older** than his wife.
- Can you speak **a bit slower**, please?
- This one is **a lot cheaper**.

the ... the ...

- **The more** you practise, **the better** you speak.
- **The sooner, the better.**

getting + comparative + and + comparative

- It's getting **colder and colder**.
- Your English is getting **better and better**!

Too and enough

- **too** + adjective = more than is good: "This tea is **too hot** to drink." "He is **too young** to drive."
- adjective + **enough** = sufficient: "She is **old enough** to vote." "This room isn't **big enough**."
- **enough** + noun: "We have **enough money**." "There isn't **enough time**."

✗ He is enough old. ✓ He is old **enough**.

✗ It is too much hot. ✓ It is **too** hot. / It is **very** hot.

Tip: "Too" usually has a negative feeling. "It's very beautiful" (good). "It's too beautiful" sounds strange. Say "It's so beautiful!"

Very, really, so, quite, extremely

Word	Strength	Example
a bit / a little	weak	I'm a bit tired.
quite / fairly / pretty	medium	The test was quite easy.
very / really	strong	She's very kind.
so	strong (emotional)	You're so funny!
extremely / incredibly	very strong	It was extremely cold.

Strong adjectives

Some adjectives are already very strong. Use **absolutely** or **really** with them, not "very":

Normal	Strong
good	excellent, fantastic, amazing, brilliant
bad	terrible, awful, horrible
big	huge, enormous, massive
small	tiny
tired	exhausted
hungry	starving
cold	freezing
hot	boiling
angry	furious
happy	delighted, thrilled
scared	terrified
surprised	amazed, astonished
dirty	filthy
clean	spotless
interesting	fascinating
funny	hilarious

- I'm **absolutely starving**! (not "very starving")
- The film was **really hilarious**.

100 common adjectives with opposites

Adjective	Opposite	Adjective	Opposite
big	small	old	new / young
tall	short	long	short
fat	thin	heavy	light
hot	cold	warm	cool
fast	slow	early	late
rich	poor	expensive	cheap
easy	difficult	right	wrong

Adjective	Opposite	Adjective	Opposite
happy	sad	good	bad
clean	dirty	full	empty
strong	weak	hard	soft
loud	quiet	open	closed
safe	dangerous	wet	dry
young	old	beautiful	ugly
kind	cruel / unkind	polite	rude
busy	free	near	far
deep	shallow	wide	narrow
high	low	thick	thin
sweet	bitter / sour	dark	light / bright
noisy	quiet	modern	traditional / old-fashioned
interesting	boring	tidy	messy / untidy
healthy	unhealthy / ill	brave	cowardly / afraid
clever	stupid	hardworking	lazy
honest	dishonest	patient	impatient
possible	impossible	comfortable	uncomfortable
friendly	unfriendly	careful	careless
useful	useless	true	false
alive	dead	same	different
public	private	simple	complicated
calm	nervous	generous	mean / selfish
awake	asleep	fresh	stale / rotten
smooth	rough	tight	loose
sharp	blunt	straight	curly / crooked
legal	illegal	common	rare
correct	incorrect	familiar	strange / unfamiliar
guilty	innocent	ancient	modern
crowded	empty	asleep	awake

Adjective	Opposite	Adjective	Opposite
positive	negative	major	minor
wealthy	poor	delicious	disgusting
confident	shy	cheerful	gloomy
thick	thin	real	fake

✎ Practice: Choose the correct word

1. The film was very (bored / boring).

2. I am (interested / interesting) in history.

3. She was (surprised / surprising) to see me.

4. It was a (tired / tiring) journey.

5. We were (excited / exciting) about the holiday.

✎ Practice: Write the comparative and superlative

1. cheap

2. big

3. happy

4. good

5. expensive

6. bad

7. nice

8. far

✎ Practice: Correct the mistakes

1. My sister is more young than me.

2. This is the most good restaurant.

3. He isn't enough tall to play basketball.

4. I bought two news books.

5. This exercise is more easier.

6. She is as tall than her brother.

Adverbs: How, When, Where, How Often

What is an adverb?

An adverb gives more information about a **verb** (how/when/where something happens), an **adjective** or another **adverb**.

- She sings **beautifully**. (how?)
- I'll call you **tomorrow**. (when?)
- Come **here**. (where?)
- He is **always** late. (how often?)
- It's **very** cold. (how much?)

Making adverbs of manner (-ly)

Most adverbs of manner = adjective + **-ly**.

Adjective	Adverb
slow	slowly
quick	quickly
careful	carefully
quiet	quietly
bad	badly
easy	easily (y → ily)
happy	happily
angry	angrily
gentle	gently (le → ly)
terrible	terribly
automatic	automatically (ic → ically)

Irregular adverbs

Adjective	Adverb
good	**well**

Adjective	Adverb
fast	**fast**
hard	**hard**
early	**early**
late	**late**
straight	**straight**

- She is a **good** singer. → She sings **well**.
- He is a **fast** runner. → He runs **fast**.
- She works **hard**. ("hardly" means "almost not": "I can **hardly** hear you.")
- He arrived **late**. ("lately" means "recently": "Have you seen him **lately**?")

  ✗ He speaks English very good. ✓ He speaks English very **well**.

  ✗ Drive careful! ✓ Drive **carefully**!

  ✗ She works very hardly. ✓ She works very **hard**.

"Well" as an adjective

"Well" can also mean "healthy": "I don't feel **well**." "Get **well** soon!"

Some -ly words are adjectives

friendly, lovely, lonely, ugly, silly, elderly, likely are **adjectives**: "She is very **friendly**." To make an adverb: "She spoke **in a friendly way**."

Adverbs of frequency (how often?)

100%					0%
always	usually	often	sometimes	rarely / seldom	never

Other: normally, generally, frequently, occasionally, hardly ever

Position

- **Before** the main verb: I **always** drink tea in the morning. She **never** eats meat.
- **After** the verb "be": He is **always** late. They are **often** busy.
- After the first auxiliary: I have **never** been to Japan. You can **always** call me.

✗ I go always to the gym. ✓ I **always go** to the gym.

✗ She never is late. ✓ She is **never** late.

"How often" expressions (usually at the end)

every day, every week, once a week, twice a month, three times a year, on Mondays, at weekends, from time to time, now and then

- I visit my parents **twice a month**.
- We go to the cinema **once a week**.

Adverbs of time and place

- **Time**: now, today, tomorrow, yesterday, soon, later, already, yet, still, just, recently, before, ago, tonight
- **Place**: here, there, everywhere, somewhere, nowhere, inside, outside, upstairs, downstairs, abroad, nearby, away, home

Order at the end of the sentence: **Manner + Place + Time**

- She sang **beautifully at the concert last night**.
- I worked **hard at the office yesterday**.

Still, yet, already, just

Word	Meaning	Example
already	sooner than expected	I've **already** finished.
yet	until now (negatives, questions)	Have you eaten **yet**? I haven't finished **yet**.
still	continuing, not finished	She's **still** sleeping. I **still** don't understand.
just	a very short time ago	He's **just** left.

✎ Practice: Adjective or adverb?

1. She is a (careful / carefully) driver.

2. She drives (careful / carefully).

3. He speaks English (good / well).

4. The test was (easy / easily).

5. I can do this (easy / easily).

6. They work very (hard / hardly).

7. Please speak (quiet / quietly).

8. You look (sad / sadly).

✎ Practice: Put the adverb in the correct place

1. I drink coffee. (never)

2. She is happy. (always)

3. They play tennis. (sometimes)

4. We have been to Goa. (never)

5. He is late for work. (often)

Prepositions of Time, Place and Movement

Prepositions of time: AT, ON, IN

AT (exact time)	ON (days and dates)	IN (longer periods)
at 5 o'clock	on Monday	in the morning
at 7:30	on Sunday morning	in the afternoon / evening
at noon / midnight	on 15th August	in July
at night	on my birthday	in summer / winter
at the weekend (UK)	on the weekend (US)	in 2026
at Christmas / Diwali (the period)	on Christmas Day	in the 1990s
at the moment	on New Year's Eve	in the 21st century
at lunchtime	on weekdays	in two weeks (future)

Tip: Think of a triangle: **IN** is for big periods (years, months, seasons), **ON** for days, **AT** for exact times.

✗ I was born in 5th May. ✓ I was born **on** 5th May.

✗ See you on 6 o'clock. ✓ See you **at** 6 o'clock.

✗ I study at the morning. ✓ I study **in** the morning.

✗ We met in night. ✓ We met **at** night.

No preposition before: this, next, last, every, tomorrow, yesterday

- I'll see you **next week**. (not "in next week")
- We met **last Friday**. (not "on last Friday")
- I go swimming **every day**.

Other time prepositions

Preposition	Example
for (length of time)	I lived there **for** five years.
since (start point)	I've lived here **since** 2019.
during (within a period)	He slept **during** the film.
from ... to / until	The shop is open **from** 9 **to** 6.
until / till (up to a time)	Wait **until** I come back.
by (not later than)	Please finish the work **by** Friday.
before / after	Wash your hands **before** eating.
ago (back from now)	I came here two years **ago**.
within	Reply **within** 24 hours.

Prepositions of place: AT, ON, IN

AT (a point)	ON (a surface / line)	IN (inside / an area)
at the bus stop	on the table	in the box
at the door	on the wall	in the room
at home / at work / at school	on the floor	in the car / in a taxi
at the station / airport	on the bus / train / plane	in the garden
at the top / bottom	on the first floor	in Delhi / in India
at the corner	on the left / right	in the picture
at a party / concert	on the screen / page	in bed / in hospital
at 25 MG Road (full address)	on MG Road (street)	in the newspaper

✗ I am in home. ✓ I am **at** home.

✗ The picture is in the wall. ✓ The picture is **on** the wall.

✗ She is on the car. ✓ She is **in** the car. (but **on** the bus / train)

Other place prepositions

Preposition	Example
under / below	The cat is **under** the bed.

Preposition	Example
above / over	There's a clock **above** the door.
next to / beside	The bank is **next to** the post office.
between	I sat **between** Ali and Sara.
among	a house **among** the trees
in front of	There's a car **in front of** my house.
behind	The garden is **behind** the house.
opposite	The school is **opposite** the park.
near / close to	I live **near** the station.
inside / outside	Wait **outside**, please.
around	We sat **around** the table.
across from (US)	The café is **across from** the bank.

✗ beside of the house ✓ **beside** the house

✗ next the bank ✓ next **to** the bank

Prepositions of movement

Preposition	Example
to	I go **to** work by bus.
into	She walked **into** the room.
out of	He ran **out of** the house.
onto	The cat jumped **onto** the table.
off	Get **off** the bus at the next stop.
up / down	Walk **up** the stairs. / Come **down**!
along	We walked **along** the beach.
across	Swim **across** the river.
through	The train went **through** the tunnel.
past	Go **past** the hospital and turn left.
over	Jump **over** the wall.
around / round	Walk **around** the lake.

Preposition	Example
towards	He ran **towards** me.
from	I came **from** the office.

✗ I go to home. ✓ I go home. (no "to" with home)

✗ We arrived to the airport. ✓ We arrived **at** the airport. (arrive **at** a place, arrive **in** a city/country)

✗ I'm going to abroad. ✓ I'm going abroad.

Transport: by, on, in

- **by** + transport (no article): by car, by bus, by train, by plane, by bike, by taxi
- **on foot** (walking)
- **on** the bus / train / plane / bike / boat (big transport, you can stand)
- **in** a car / taxi / small boat (you sit and cannot walk around)

✗ I came by my car. ✓ I came **in** my car. / I came **by car**.

Common adjective + preposition combinations

Phrase	Example
good at	She's **good at** maths.
bad at	I'm **bad at** drawing.
interested in	He's **interested in** music.
afraid of / scared of	I'm **afraid of** dogs.
proud of	We're **proud of** you.
tired of	I'm **tired of** waiting.
famous for	Agra is **famous for** the Taj Mahal.
married to	She's **married to** a doctor.
angry with (person) / about (thing)	He's **angry with** me.
worried about	Don't be **worried about** the exam.
similar to	My bag is **similar to** yours.
different from	Tea is **different from** coffee.

Phrase	Example
responsible for	You are **responsible for** this project.
excited about	I'm **excited about** the trip.
full of	The box is **full of** books.
kind to / nice to	Be **kind to** animals.
fond of	She is **fond of** chocolate.
aware of	Are you **aware of** the rules?
keen on	He's **keen on** football.
ready for	Are you **ready for** the test?

Common verb + preposition combinations

Phrase	Example
listen to	I **listen to** music every day.
wait for	Please **wait for** me.
look at	**Look at** this photo!
look for	I'm **looking for** my keys.
depend on	It **depends on** the weather.
belong to	This book **belongs to** me.
talk to / about	Can I **talk to** you **about** something?
think about / of	What do you **think of** my idea?
agree with	I **agree with** you.
apologize for	I **apologize for** being late.
pay for	Who **paid for** the dinner?
ask for	She **asked for** help.
believe in	Do you **believe in** ghosts?
care about	I **care about** you.
dream of / about	I **dream of** visiting Paris.
laugh at	Don't **laugh at** me!
worry about	Don't **worry about** it.

Phrase	Example
succeed in	He **succeeded in** passing the exam.
arrive at / in	We **arrived at** the hotel. / **in** London.
complain about	She **complained about** the noise.

✗ I am waiting you. ✓ I am waiting **for** you.

✗ Listen me! ✓ Listen **to** me!

✗ We discussed about the problem. ✓ We discussed the problem. (no "about")

✗ He entered into the room. ✓ He entered the room.

✗ Call to me. ✓ Call me.

✎ Practice: Complete with at, on or in

1. My birthday is ___ March.

2. The meeting is ___ 10 o'clock.

3. I don't work ___ Sundays.

4. She was born ___ 1998.

5. I usually read ___ night.

6. We go skiing ___ winter.

7. The party is ___ Saturday evening.

8. Your keys are ___ the table.

9. My father is ___ work.

10. They live ___ Bangalore.

11. There is a picture ___ the wall.

12. I'll meet you ___ the bus stop.

13. He is sitting ___ the car.

14. We were ___ the train for six hours.

15. She is ___ hospital.

✎ Practice: Choose the correct preposition

1. I have lived here (for / since) 2015.

2. I have lived here (for / since) ten years.

3. She is good (in / at) English.

4. I'm waiting (you / for you).

5. We arrived (to / at) the station at 6.

6. He is afraid (from / of) spiders.

7. This bag belongs (to / with) me.

8. Please listen (me / to me).

9. I came to work (by / with) bus.

10. The cat jumped (into / in) the box.

Some, Any, Much, Many and Other Quantifiers

Some and any

Word	Used in	Example
some	positive sentences	I have **some** friends in Delhi. There is **some** milk.
any	negatives	I don't have **any** money. There aren't **any** eggs.
any	questions	Do you have **any** questions? Is there **any** sugar?
some	offers and requests	Would you like **some** tea? Can I have **some** water?

"Any" in a positive sentence means "it doesn't matter which": "Take **any** seat you like."

Much, many, a lot of

Word	With	Example
many	countable plural (mostly questions/negatives)	How **many** brothers do you have? There aren't **many** people.
much	uncountable (mostly questions/negatives)	How **much** money do you need? I don't have **much** time.
a lot of / lots of	both (mostly positive sentences)	She has **a lot of** books. We drank **lots of** water.

✗ How much people? ✓ How **many** people?

✗ I have much money. ✓ I have **a lot of** money.

✗ There are much cars. ✓ There are **many / a lot of** cars.

A few, a little, few, little

	Countable	Uncountable
small amount (positive)	**a few** friends	**a little** sugar
almost none (negative)	**few** friends	**little** hope

- I have **a few** friends here. (some – I'm happy)
- I have **few** friends here. (almost none – I'm lonely)
- Can I have **a little** milk in my tea?
- There is **little** time left. Hurry!

Too much, too many, enough

- There are **too many** cars in the city. (countable)
- I ate **too much** food. (uncountable)
- Do we have **enough** chairs for everyone?

All, most, some, none, both, either, neither

- **All** my friends are students.
- **Most** people like music.
- **None of** us knew the answer.
- **Both** my parents are teachers.
- You can take **either** bus. (one or the other)
- **Neither** answer is correct. (not this one and not that one)
- **Each** student has a book. (every one, separately)
- **Every** day is a new chance.

  ✗ All of people ✓ All people / All **the** people / All **of the** people

  ✗ Most of people ✓ Most people

How much / how many – asking about quantity

- **How many** children do you have?
- **How many** times have you been to Goa?
- **How much** is this shirt? (price)
- **How much** water do you drink every day?

✎ Practice: Choose the correct word

1. I don't have (some / any) brothers.

2. Would you like (some / any) coffee?

3. How (much / many) sugar do you want?

4. How (much / many) students are in your class?

5. There are (a lot of / much) people here.

6. I have (a few / a little) money. Let's buy a snack.

7. She has (a few / a little) good friends.

8. There is (too much / too many) noise.

9. Are there (some / any) shops near here?

10. (Both / Either) my sisters live in Canada.

Numbers, Dates, Time and Money

Cardinal numbers

1 one	11 eleven	21 twenty-one	100 a / one hundred
2 two	12 twelve	30 thirty	101 a hundred and one
3 three	13 thirteen	40 forty	250 two hundred and fifty
4 four	14 fourteen	50 fifty	1,000 a / one thousand
5 five	15 fifteen	60 sixty	10,000 ten thousand
6 six	16 sixteen	70 seventy	100,000 a hundred thousand (one lakh)
7 seven	17 seventeen	80 eighty	1,000,000 a / one million
8 eight	18 eighteen	90 ninety	10,000,000 ten million (one crore)
9 nine	19 nineteen	99 ninety-nine	1,000,000,000 a / one billion
10 ten	20 twenty	0 zero / "oh"	

Tip: Be careful with stress: thir**TEEN** (13) vs **THIR**ty (30), fif**TEEN** (15) vs **FIF**ty (50).

✗ two hundreds people ✓ two **hundred** people (no -s after a number)

But: hundreds of people, **thousands of** stars (when there is no exact number).

✗ forty ✓ fourty (wrong spelling!) – correct spelling is **forty**.

Ordinal numbers (order)

1st first, 2nd second, 3rd third, 4th fourth, 5th fifth, 6th sixth, 7th seventh, 8th eighth, 9th ninth, 10th tenth, 11th eleventh, 12th twelfth, 13th thirteenth, 20th twentieth, 21st twenty-first, 22nd twenty-second, 23rd twenty-third, 30th thirtieth, 100th hundredth

- She lives on the **third** floor.
- Today is my **twenty-first** birthday.

Dates

Write	Say (British)	Say (American)
5 May / 5th May	the fifth of May	May fifth
14/02/2026 (UK)	the fourteenth of February, twenty twenty-six	–
02/14/2026 (US)	–	February fourteenth, twenty twenty-six

Years: 1999 = nineteen ninety-nine, 2005 = two thousand and five, 2026 = twenty twenty-six

Decades: the 1980s = the nineteen eighties

Telling the time

Time	Way 1	Way 2 (digital)
7:00	seven o'clock	seven
7:05	five past seven	seven oh five
7:15	(a) quarter past seven	seven fifteen
7:30	half past seven	seven thirty
7:40	twenty to eight	seven forty
7:45	(a) quarter to eight	seven forty-five
12:00	noon / midday / midnight	twelve

- **a.m.** = in the morning (after midnight, before noon). **p.m.** = after noon.
- "What time is it?" / "What's the time?" – "It's half past six."
- "What time does the train leave?" – "At 8:20."

  ✗ It's 6 o'clock p.m. ✓ It's 6 p.m. / It's 6 o'clock in the evening.

Money

- £5.50 = five pounds fifty
- $12.99 = twelve dollars ninety-nine (cents)
- ₹450 = four hundred and fifty rupees
- €2.75 = two euros seventy-five
- "How much is it?" / "How much does it cost?" – "It's 300 rupees."
- "That's expensive!" / "That's a good price." / "Can you give me a discount?"

Maths in English

Symbol	Say
2 + 3 = 5	two plus three equals (is) five
7 – 4 = 3	seven minus four equals three
3 × 4 = 12	three times four / three multiplied by four is twelve
10 ÷ 2 = 5	ten divided by two is five
50%	fifty percent
0.5	(zero) point five
½ ¼ ¾	a half, a quarter, three quarters
⅓	a third

Days, months and seasons

- **Days**: Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday, Saturday, Sunday (weekend = Saturday and Sunday)
- **Months**: January, February, March, April, May, June, July, August, September, October, November, December
- **Seasons**: spring, summer, autumn (UK) / fall (US), winter; also the monsoon / rainy season
- **Time words**: second, minute, hour, day, week, fortnight (two weeks), month, year, decade (10 years), century (100 years)
- the day before yesterday – yesterday – today – tomorrow – the day after tomorrow

✎ Practice: Write in words

1. 15

2. 50

3. 342

4. 3rd

5. 12th

6. 7:45

7. 9:30

8. 2026 (year)

9. 1,500

10. 21st

Part 3: The 12 Tenses

Past, present and future – made simple

Understanding Tenses: The Big Picture

What is a tense?

A tense tells us **when** an action happens: in the past, the present or the future. It also tells us **how** we see the action: finished, in progress, or connected to another time.

English has **3 times** × **4 aspects** = **12 tenses**.

	Simple	Continuous	Perfect	Perfect Continuous
Present	I work	I am working	I have worked	I have been working
Past	I worked	I was working	I had worked	I had been working
Future	I will work	I will be working	I will have worked	I will have been working

What do the four aspects mean?

- **Simple**: a fact, a habit, a complete action. "I work in a bank."
- **Continuous** (be + -ing): an action in progress at a time. "I am working now."
- **Perfect** (have + past participle): an action completed before another time; connects two times. "I have finished."
- **Perfect continuous** (have been + -ing): an action that continued up to a time, with a focus on duration. "I have been working for three hours."

Tip: Don't try to learn all 12 at once. The most important for daily conversation are: **present simple, present continuous, past simple, present perfect, and future (will / going to)**. Master these five first. They make up about 90% of everyday English.

The three verb forms

Every English verb has three main forms. You must know them!

Base form (V1)	Past simple (V2)	Past participle (V3)
work	worked	worked
play	played	played
go	went	gone
eat	ate	eaten
see	saw	seen
write	wrote	written

Regular verbs add **-ed** for V2 and V3. Irregular verbs change in different ways – see the full list of irregular verbs in Part 5.

Plus the **-ing form**: working, playing, going, eating.

Spelling of -ing

Rule	Examples
Most verbs: + ing	work → working, eat → eating, go → going
Ends in -e: drop e + ing	make → making, write → writing, come → coming
One vowel + one consonant (stressed): double + ing	run → running, swim → swimming, sit → sitting, begin → beginning
Ends in -ie: ie → ying	lie → lying, die → dying, tie → tying
Ends in -ee, -ye, -oe: keep e	see → seeing, agree → agreeing

Spelling of -ed

Rule	Examples
Most verbs: + ed	walk → walked, clean → cleaned
Ends in -e: + d	live → lived, dance → danced
Consonant + y: y → ied	study → studied, cry → cried
Vowel + y: + ed	play → played, enjoy → enjoyed

Rule	Examples
One vowel + one consonant (stressed): double + ed	stop → stopped, plan → planned, prefer → preferred

Present Simple

What is it?

The present simple is for **facts, habits, routines and things that are always true**.

- I **drink** tea every morning. (habit)
- Water **boils** at 100°C. (fact)
- She **works** in a hospital. (permanent situation)
- The sun **rises** in the east. (always true)

How to make it

Positive

Subject	Verb
I / You / We / They	work, play, live
He / She / It	work**s**, play**s**, live**s**

The golden rule: with **he, she, it** (or one person/thing), add **-s** to the verb.

Spelling of -s

Rule	Examples
Most verbs: + s	works, reads, sleeps
Ends in -s, -sh, -ch, -x, -o: + es	misses, washes, watches, fixes, goes, does
Consonant + y: y → ies	study → studies, cry → cries, fly → flies
Vowel + y: + s	play → plays, buy → buys
Irregular	have → **has**

Negative: don't / doesn't + base verb

Subject	Negative
I / You / We / They	**don't** (do not) work
He / She / It	**doesn't** (does not) work

Questions: Do / Does + subject + base verb?

Question	Short answers
Do you **like** pizza?	Yes, I do. / No, I don't.
Does she **speak** French?	Yes, she does. / No, she doesn't.
Do they **live** here?	Yes, they do. / No, they don't.
Where do you **work**?	I work in a bank.
What time does the shop **open**?	It opens at 9.

✗ She work in a bank. ✓ She work**s** in a bank.

✗ He don't like coffee. ✓ He **doesn't** like coffee.

✗ She doesn't likes coffee. ✓ She doesn't **like** coffee.

✗ Does he works here? ✓ Does he **work** here?

✗ You like pizza? (in writing) ✓ **Do** you like pizza?

✗ Where you live? ✓ Where **do** you live?

Tip: The "-s" goes to only ONE place. In positive sentences it goes on the verb (she work**s**). In negatives and questions it goes on "do" (she **does**n't work, **does** she work?).

When to use it

1. Habits and routines

- I **get up** at 6 o'clock every day.
- She **goes** to the gym three times a week.
- We usually **have** dinner at 8.

Signal words: always, usually, often, sometimes, never, every day, on Mondays, once a week

2. Facts and general truths

- Cats **like** fish.
- It **rains** a lot in Kerala.
- The Earth **goes** around the Sun.

3. Permanent situations

- My parents **live** in Kolkata.
- He **works** for Google.

4. Timetables and schedules (future)

- The train **leaves** at 7:30 tomorrow.
- The film **starts** at 9 p.m.

5. Stative verbs (see below)

- I **know** the answer.
- She **loves** her children.

Stative verbs

Some verbs describe **states** (feelings, thoughts, senses, possession), not actions. We usually do **not** use them in the continuous form.

Type	Verbs
Feelings	love, like, hate, want, need, prefer, wish
Thinking	know, believe, understand, remember, forget, mean, think (= opinion), agree, suppose
Senses	see, hear, smell, taste, seem, look (= seem), sound
Possession	have (= own), own, belong, possess
Others	be, cost, weigh, contain, depend, matter

✗ I am knowing the answer. ✓ I **know** the answer.

✗ She is wanting a new car. ✓ She **wants** a new car.

✗ I am understanding you. ✓ I **understand** you.

✗ This is belonging to me. ✓ This **belongs** to me.

Daily routine: example text

Read this text out loud. Notice all the present simple verbs.

"My name is Meera. I **am** 28 and I **work** as a nurse. I **live** in Chennai with my husband and our son. Every day I **wake up** at 5:30. I **have** a quick shower and I **make** breakfast. My husband **takes** our son to school. I **start** work at 7. I **don't have** much free time, but on Sundays we **go** to the beach. My son **loves** the sea. He **doesn't like** vegetables, but he **eats** a lot of fruit. What **do** you **do** on Sundays?"

✎ Practice: Write the correct form of the verb

1. She ___ (go) to school by bus.

2. I ___ (not / like) coffee.

3. ___ he ___ (play) cricket?

4. My father ___ (watch) the news every evening.

5. They ___ (not / live) in London.

6. The baby ___ (cry) a lot.

7. Water ___ (freeze) at 0°C.

8. ___ you ___ (speak) Hindi?

9. He ___ (have) two cars.

10. My sister ___ (not / eat) meat.

11. Where ___ your brother ___ (work)?

12. The bank ___ (open) at 9:30.

✎ Practice: Correct the mistakes

1. He go to work at 8.

2. She don't speak English.

3. Does she likes music?

4. I am knowing him for years.

5. Where you live?

6. My brother study at university.

Present Continuous

What is it?

The present continuous is for actions happening **now**, around now, temporary situations, and future plans.

- I **am reading** this book now.
- She **is cooking** dinner at the moment.

How to make it: am / is / are + verb-ing

Positive	Negative	Question
I **am** (I'm) work**ing**	I'm **not** working	**Am** I working?
You / We / They **are** (you're) working	You **aren't** working	**Are** you working?
He / She / It **is** (he's) working	He **isn't** working	**Is** he working?

- What **are** you **doing**? – I'**m watching** TV.
- **Is** it **raining**? – Yes, it **is**. / No, it **isn't**.

✗ I watching TV. ✓ I **am** watching TV.

✗ She is cook dinner. ✓ She is cook**ing** dinner.

✗ What you are doing? ✓ What **are you** doing?

When to use it

1. Actions happening now

- Be quiet! The baby **is sleeping**.
- Look! It**'s snowing**.
- I can't talk now. I'**m driving**.

Signal words: now, right now, at the moment, Look!, Listen!

2. Temporary actions (around now, not exactly at this moment)

- I'**m reading** a great book this week.
- She **is living** with her friend until she finds a flat.
- We **are learning** English this year.

3. Changing situations

- The weather **is getting** colder.
- Prices **are rising**.
- Your English **is improving**!

4. Future plans and arrangements

- I'**m meeting** Rahul tomorrow at 6.
- We **are flying** to Dubai next Friday.
- What **are** you **doing** this weekend?

5. Annoying habits (with always)

- He **is always losing** his keys!
- You'**re always complaining**!

Present simple or present continuous?

Present simple	Present continuous
Habit / always	Now / temporary
I **work** in an office.	I'**m working** from home this week.
She **plays** tennis on Sundays.	She'**s playing** tennis right now.
It **rains** a lot in July.	It'**s raining** now. Take an umbrella.
What **do** you **do**? (= What is your job?)	What **are** you **doing**? (= now)
He usually **drinks** tea.	Today he'**s drinking** coffee.

Verbs with two meanings

Some stative verbs can be actions with a different meaning:

State (simple)	Action (continuous)
I **think** it's a good idea. (opinion)	I'**m thinking** about my holiday. (using my brain)
I **have** a car. (possession)	I'**m having** lunch. (eating)
The soup **tastes** good. (quality)	The chef **is tasting** the soup. (action)
You **look** tired. (seem)	Why **are** you **looking** at me? (action)
I **see** what you mean. (understand)	I'**m seeing** the doctor tomorrow. (meeting)

✎ Practice: Present simple or continuous?

1. Shh! The baby ___ (sleep).

2. I usually ___ (walk) to work.

3. Look! The bus ___ (come).

4. She ___ (not / eat) meat. She's vegetarian.

5. What ___ you ___ (do) now?

6. Water ___ (boil) at 100°C.

7. We ___ (meet) our friends tonight.

8. I ___ (not / understand) this word.

9. He ___ (work) in Dubai this month.

10. ___ you ___ (like) spicy food?

11. My English ___ (get) better every day.

12. I ___ (think) you are right.

Present Perfect

What is it?

The present perfect connects the **past** and the **present**. We use it when the time is **not important or not finished**, or when a past action has a **result now**.

- I **have lost** my keys. (I don't have them now.)
- She **has been** to London three times. (in her life)
- We **have lived** here since 2018. (and we still live here)

How to make it: have / has + past participle (V3)

Positive	Negative	Question
I / You / We / They **have** (I've) finished	I **haven't** finished	**Have** you finished?
He / She / It **has** (she's) finished	She **hasn't** finished	**Has** she finished?

- **Have** you **eaten**? – Yes, I **have**. / No, I **haven't**.
- She **has gone** home.
- They **haven't arrived** yet.

When to use it

1. Life experience (ever / never)

The time is not important – only that it happened in your life.

- I **have been** to Japan.
- **Have** you **ever eaten** sushi? – No, I **never have**. / No, I've **never eaten** it.
- She **has never seen** snow.
- This is the best film I'**ve ever seen**.

2. Past action with a present result

- I'**ve broken** my leg. (I can't walk now.)
- He **has lost** his wallet. (He doesn't have it now.)
- Someone **has stolen** my bike!

- Look, I'**ve bought** a new dress!

3. Recent actions (just, already, yet)

- I'**ve just finished** my homework. (a moment ago)
- She **has already left**. (sooner than expected)
- **Have** you **finished yet**? / I **haven't finished yet**.

4. Unfinished time (for / since)

The action started in the past and **continues now**.

- I **have lived** here **for** ten years. (I still live here.)
- She **has worked** at the bank **since** 2020.
- We **have known** each other **since** childhood.
- How long **have** you **been** married?

for + a period of time	since + a point in time
for two hours	since 9 o'clock
for three days	since Monday
for a week	since last week
for ten years	since 2016
for a long time	since I was a child

5. Unfinished time periods (today, this week, this year)

- I'**ve drunk** three cups of coffee **today**. (today is not finished)
- She **hasn't called** me **this week**.

Present perfect or past simple?

This is very important!

Past simple – finished time	Present perfect – unfinished / no time
I **saw** the film **yesterday**.	I'**ve seen** the film. (no time said)
She **went** to Paris **in 2019**.	She'**s been** to Paris. (in her life)
I **lost** my keys last week (but I found them).	I'**ve lost** my keys. (I can't find them now.)

Past simple – finished time	Present perfect – unfinished / no time
He **lived** in Delhi for 5 years (now he doesn't).	He**'s lived** in Delhi for 5 years (and still does).
When did you **arrive**?	**Have** you **arrived** yet?

Golden rule: If you say **when** (yesterday, last week, in 2015, two days ago), use the **past simple**.

✗ I have seen him yesterday. ✓ I **saw** him yesterday.

✗ I have visited Goa in 2020. ✓ I **visited** Goa in 2020.

✗ When have you arrived? ✓ When **did** you arrive?

✗ I live here since 2010. ✓ I **have lived** here since 2010.

✗ I know him for five years. ✓ I **have known** him for five years.

✗ I am here since morning. ✓ I **have been** here since morning.

Been or gone?

- She **has gone** to the market. (She is there now – not here.)
- She **has been** to the market. (She went and came back.)
- **Have** you ever **been** to Mumbai? (visited and returned)

✎ Practice: Complete with the present perfect

1. I ___ (finish) my work.

2. She ___ (never / see) the sea.

3. ___ you ever ___ (be) to Japan?

4. They ___ (not / arrive) yet.

5. He ___ (lose) his phone.

6. We ___ (live) here since 2015.

7. ___ she ___ (eat) yet?

8. I ___ (just / call) my mother.

✎ Practice: For or since?

1. ___ three years
2. ___ Monday
3. ___ 2010
4. ___ a long time
5. ___ I was ten
6. ___ two hours

✎ Practice: Past simple or present perfect?

1. I ___ (see) that film last week.
2. ___ you ever ___ (try) Thai food?
3. She ___ (go) to Paris in 2018.
4. I ___ (know) him since school.
5. When ___ you ___ (start) this job?
6. Oh no! I ___ (forget) my password.
7. We ___ (move) to this house two years ago.
8. He ___ (work) here for six months, and he likes it.

Present Perfect Continuous

What is it?

The present perfect continuous is for an action that **started in the past** and **has continued until now** (or has just stopped). The focus is on **how long** or on the **activity** itself.

- I **have been waiting** for you for an hour!
- It **has been raining** all day.

How to make it: have / has + been + verb-ing

Positive	Negative	Question
I / You / We / They **have been** working	I **haven't been** working	**Have** you **been** working?
He / She / It **has been** working	She **hasn't been** working	**Has** she **been** working?

- How long **have** you **been learning** English?
- She **has been studying** since 8 o'clock.

When to use it

1. Duration up to now (how long?)

- I'**ve been working** here **for** five years.
- They'**ve been talking** on the phone **since** 7 p.m.
- How long **have** you **been living** in Pune?

2. Recent activity with visible results

- You look tired. **Have** you **been running**? (You are sweating.)
- Why are your hands dirty? – I'**ve been fixing** the car.
- It **has been raining**. The streets are wet.

Present perfect simple or continuous?

Present perfect simple	Present perfect continuous
Result / how many	Activity / how long
I'**ve written** three emails.	I'**ve been writing** emails all morning.
She'**s read** the book. (finished)	She'**s been reading** the book. (maybe not finished)
I'**ve painted** the room. (done)	I'**ve been painting** the room. (that's why I'm dirty)

Tip: With stative verbs (know, like, have = own, be), use the simple form: "I've **known** her for years." (not "I've been knowing")

✎ Practice: Complete with the present perfect continuous

1. I ___ (wait) for the bus for 20 minutes.

2. She ___ (learn) English since January.

3. It ___ (rain) all morning.

4. How long ___ you ___ (live) here?

5. They ___ (play) football for two hours.

6. He's tired because he ___ (work) all day.

✎ Practice: Simple or continuous?

1. I've ___ (read) five books this month.

2. I've ___ (read) this book all week.

3. She has ___ (know) him for ten years.

4. We've ___ (clean) the house all morning.

5. Have you ___ (finish) your homework?

Past Simple

What is it?

The past simple is for actions that **started and finished in the past**, usually at a known time.

- I **visited** my grandmother **yesterday**.
- She **bought** a new car **last month**.
- We **didn't go** to school **on Monday**.

How to make it

Positive: verb + -ed (regular) or V2 (irregular)

The form is the **same for all persons** (I, you, he, she, we, they). No "-s"!

Regular	Irregular
I work**ed**	I **went**
She play**ed**	She **ate**
They studi**ed**	They **saw**
We stop**ped**	We **had**

Negative: didn't + base verb

- I **didn't work** yesterday.
- She **didn't go** to the party.

Questions: Did + subject + base verb?

Question	Short answers
Did you **see** the match?	Yes, I did. / No, I didn't.
Did she **call** you?	Yes, she did. / No, she didn't.
Where did you **go**?	I went to Goa.
What did they **eat**?	They ate pizza.
When did he **arrive**?	He arrived at 9.

✗ I didn't went. ✓ I didn't **go**.

✗ Did you saw him? ✓ Did you **see** him?

✗ She didn't called me. ✓ She didn't **call** me.

✗ Yesterday I go to the market. ✓ Yesterday I **went** to the market.

✗ I goed / I eated / I buyed ✓ I **went** / I **ate** / I **bought**

Tip: After "did" and "didn't", the verb always returns to the **base form**. The "did" already shows the past. You don't need to show the past twice!

Most common irregular verbs in the past

Learn these first – they appear in every conversation.

Base	Past	Base	Past
be	was / were	make	made
have	had	know	knew
do	did	think	thought
go	went	take	took
say	said	see	saw
get	got	come	came
give	gave	find	found
tell	told	feel	felt
leave	left	bring	brought
buy	bought	eat	ate
drink	drank	sleep	slept
write	wrote	read	read (said "red")
speak	spoke	meet	met
run	ran	sit	sat
begin	began	pay	paid
lose	lost	send	sent
spend	spent	teach	taught
win	won	become	became

(See the full list of 150 irregular verbs in Part 5.)

When to use it

1. Finished actions at a definite time

- I **met** her **in 2015**.
- They **arrived two hours ago**.
- **Last night** we **watched** a film.

Signal words: yesterday, last night/week/month/year, ago, in 2010, when I was a child, then, after that

2. A sequence of past actions (a story)

- I **woke up**, **had** a shower, **got** dressed and **left** for work.

3. Past habits

- When I was a child, I **played** in the street every day.

4. A finished period of time

- He **lived** in Paris for ten years. (He doesn't live there now.)

"Ago"

"Ago" means "back from now". It goes **after** the time period.

- I came here **three years ago**.
- She called **ten minutes ago**.
- How long **ago** did you start?

  ✗ I came before two years. ✓ I came two years **ago**.

  ✗ Ago two days ✓ two days **ago**

A short story in the past simple

Read the story aloud.

"Last Saturday **was** a terrible day for Arjun. He **woke up** late because his alarm **didn't ring**. He **jumped** out of bed and **ran** to the bus stop, but the bus **left** just before he **arrived**. He **took** a taxi, but there **was** a lot of traffic. When he finally **got** to the office, he **realised** something: it **was** Saturday! The office **was** closed. He **laughed**, **bought** a coffee and **went** back home to sleep."

Questions about the story

- Why did Arjun wake up late? – Because his alarm didn't ring.
- Did he catch the bus? – No, he didn't.
- How did he go to the office? – He took a taxi.
- Why was the office closed? – Because it was Saturday.

✎ Practice: Write the past simple

1. go

2. play

3. buy

4. study

5. eat

6. stop

7. see

8. write

9. think

10. teach

✎ Practice: Complete the sentences

1. I ___ (visit) my uncle last week.

2. She ___ (not / come) to the party.

3. ___ you ___ (enjoy) the film?

4. We ___ (have) a great time in Goa.

5. He ___ (lose) his keys yesterday.

6. Where ___ you ___ (go) on holiday?

7. They ___ (not / see) the accident.

8. I ___ (meet) my wife ten years ago.

9. What ___ she ___ (say)?

10. The film ___ (start) at 9 and ___ (finish) at 11.

✎ Practice: Correct the mistakes

1. I didn't saw him.

2. Did you went to school?

3. She buyed a new dress.

4. I have seen him yesterday.

5. We go to the cinema last night.

Past Continuous

What is it?

The past continuous is for an action that was **in progress** at a time in the past.

- At 8 o'clock last night, I **was watching** TV.
- What **were** you **doing** when I called?

How to make it: was / were + verb-ing

Positive	Negative	Question
I / He / She / It **was** working	I **wasn't** working	**Was** she working?
You / We / They **were** working	They **weren't** working	**Were** you working?

When to use it

1. An action in progress at a specific past time

- At 7 a.m. I **was having** breakfast.
- This time last year, we **were living** in Bangalore.

2. A long action interrupted by a short action

The long action → past continuous. The short action → past simple.

- I **was cooking** when the phone **rang**.
- She **was walking** home when she **saw** an accident.
- While we **were sleeping**, someone **broke** into the house.

3. Two long actions at the same time (while)

- **While** I **was studying**, my brother **was playing** video games.

4. Background description in a story

- It **was raining**. People **were hurrying** home. A dog **was barking** somewhere...

When or while?

- **when** + past simple (short action): "I was reading **when** she **arrived**."
- **while** + past continuous (long action): "She arrived **while** I **was reading**."

✗ When I was sleep, the phone rang. ✓ When I **was sleeping**, the phone rang.

✗ I was knowing the answer. ✓ I **knew** the answer. (stative verb)

✎ Practice: Complete with past simple or past continuous

1. I ___ (read) when the lights ___ (go) out.

2. What ___ you ___ (do) at 9 last night?

3. She ___ (cut) her finger while she ___ (cook).

4. We ___ (watch) TV when you ___ (call).

5. While they ___ (play) football, it ___ (start) to rain.

6. I ___ (see) Priya while I ___ (wait) for the bus.

7. It ___ (snow) when we ___ (wake up).

8. He ___ (not / listen) when the teacher ___ (explain) the lesson.

Past Perfect

What is it?

The past perfect is "the past of the past". We use it to show that one past action happened **before** another past action.

- When I arrived at the station, the train **had** already **left**.

(First: the train left. Second: I arrived.)

How to make it: had + past participle (V3)

The form is the same for all persons.

Positive	Negative	Question
I / She / They **had** (I'd) finished	I **hadn't** finished	**Had** you finished?

When to use it

1. The earlier of two past actions

- She **had cooked** dinner before her husband came home.
- When we got to the cinema, the film **had** already **started**.
- I **had** never **seen** the sea before I went to Goa.

2. Reported speech (see Part 4)

- He said he **had lost** his phone.

3. Third conditional (see Part 4)

- If I **had studied**, I would have passed.

Compare

- When I arrived, she **left**. (I arrived, then she left.)
- When I arrived, she **had left**. (She left first. I didn't see her.)

> **Tip:** You don't need the past perfect if "before" or "after" already makes the order clear: "I ate dinner before I went out" is fine.

✎ Practice: Complete with the past perfect

1. When I got home, my family ___ (eat) dinner.

2. She was sad because she ___ (lose) her ring.

3. I ___ (never / fly) before that trip.

4. By the time the police came, the thief ___ (escape).

5. ___ you ___ (finish) the work before the manager arrived?

6. He ___ (not / study), so he failed the exam.

Past Perfect Continuous

What is it?

The past perfect continuous shows that an action **continued for some time before** another past moment.

- I **had been waiting** for two hours when the bus finally came.
- She was tired because she **had been working** all day.

How to make it: had been + verb-ing

Positive	Negative	Question
I / He / They **had been** working	I **hadn't been** working	**Had** you **been** working?

When to use it

1. Duration before a past point

- They **had been living** in London for ten years before they moved to Canada.
- How long **had** you **been studying** English before you went to Australia?

2. Cause of a past situation

- His eyes were red because he **had been crying**.
- The ground was wet. It **had been raining**.

✎ Practice: Complete with the past perfect continuous

1. I was tired because I ___ (run).

2. They ___ (wait) for an hour when the doctor came.

3. She ___ (work) there for five years before she got a promotion.

4. The road was wet. It ___ (rain).

5. How long ___ he ___ (drive) before he stopped?

Used To and Would (Past Habits)

Used to

We use **used to + base verb** for past habits or states that are **not true now**.

- I **used to** play cricket every day. (but I don't now)
- She **used to** live in Mumbai. (she lives somewhere else now)
- There **used to** be a cinema here. (now there isn't)

Positive	Negative	Question
I **used to** smoke.	I **didn't use to** smoke.	**Did** you **use to** smoke?

✗ I use to play cricket. (past) ✓ I **used to** play cricket.

✗ Did you used to live here? ✓ Did you **use to** live here?

✗ I am used to play football when I was young. ✓ I **used to** play football when I was young.

Be used to / get used to (different meaning!)

be used to + -ing / noun = be familiar with, it is normal for me.

- I **am used to** waking up early. (It's normal for me – not difficult.)
- She **isn't used to** the cold weather.

get used to + -ing / noun = become familiar with.

- You will **get used to** driving on the left.
- It took me a month to **get used to** my new job.

Structure	Meaning	Example
used to + verb	past habit	I **used to** work at night.
be used to + -ing	normal for me	I'**m used to working** at night.
get used to + -ing	becoming normal	I'**m getting used to working** at night.

Would (past repeated actions)

"Would" can also describe repeated past actions (not states), often in stories about childhood.

- Every summer, we **would** go to my grandparents' village. My grandmother **would** make sweets for us.

  ✗ I would have long hair when I was young. (state) ✓ I **used to** have long hair.

✎ Practice: Complete with used to / didn't use to / use to

1. I ___ live in a village, but now I live in the city.

2. She ___ like vegetables, but now she loves them.

3. Did you ___ play with dolls?

4. There ___ be a park here. Now it's a car park.

5. My father ___ smoke, but he stopped five years ago.

✎ Practice: Choose the correct form

1. I'm not used to (get / getting) up so early.

2. He used to (work / working) in a bank.

3. You'll soon get used to (live / living) here.

4. When I was a child, I (would / used to) have a dog.

Future Simple: Will

How to make it: will + base verb

The form is the **same for all persons**.

Positive	Negative	Question
I / You / She / They **will** (I'll) help	I **won't** (will not) help	**Will** you help?

- I'**ll** call you later.
- She **won't** be happy about this.
- **Will** you marry me? – Yes, I **will**!

  ✗ She will goes. ✓ She will **go**.

✗ I will to call you. ✓ I will call you.

✗ Will you to come? ✓ Will you come?

When to use "will"

1. Decisions made at the moment of speaking

- "The phone is ringing." – "I'**ll** answer it."
- "I'm cold." – "I'**ll** close the window."
- "What would you like?" – "I'**ll** have the chicken, please."

2. Predictions based on opinion (think, believe, probably)

- I **think** it **will** rain tomorrow.
- You'**ll** love this film.
- He **probably won't** come.

3. Promises

- I **will** always love you.
- I **won't** tell anyone. I promise.

4. Offers

- I'**ll** carry your bag.
- **Shall** I open the window? (offer – British, with I/we)

5. Requests

- **Will** you help me, please?

6. Future facts

- The sun **will** rise at 6:15 tomorrow.
- I'**ll** be 30 next year.

7. Threats and warnings

- Stop or I'**ll** call the police!
- Be careful, you'**ll** fall!

Future with "Going To"

How to make it: am / is / are + going to + base verb

Positive	Negative	Question
I'**m going to** study.	I'**m not going to** study.	**Am** I **going to**...?
She'**s going to** travel.	She **isn't going to** travel.	**Is** she **going to**...?
They'**re going to** move.	They **aren't going to** move.	**Are** they **going to**...?

When to use "going to"

1. Plans and intentions (decided before now)

- I'**m going to** buy a new laptop next month. (I've already decided.)
- We'**re going to** get married in December.
- What **are** you **going to** do after university?

2. Predictions based on evidence (what you can see now)

- Look at those black clouds! It'**s going to** rain.
- Be careful! You'**re going to** drop those plates!
- She's pregnant. She'**s going to** have a baby.

Will or going to?

Will	Going to
Decision **now**	Plan made **before**
"We have no milk." – "Oh, I'**ll** buy some."	"Why are you taking your bag?" – "I'**m going to** buy milk."
Prediction (opinion)	Prediction (evidence)
I think Brazil **will** win.	Brazil is 3-0 up. They'**re going to** win.

Present Continuous and Present Simple for the Future

Present continuous for arrangements

When you have a **fixed arrangement** with other people (time, place – often in your diary), use the present continuous:

- I'**m meeting** my boss at 3 o'clock.
- We'**re having** a party on Saturday.
- She'**s flying** to Singapore tomorrow morning.
- What **are** you **doing** tonight?

Present simple for timetables

For official schedules (trains, flights, films, classes), use the present simple:

- The train **leaves** at 6:45.
- The concert **starts** at 8.
- Our English class **begins** on 3rd March.

Future time clauses: when, before, after, until, as soon as, if

After these words, we use the **present** (not will) to talk about the future.

- I'll call you **when** I **arrive**. (not "when I will arrive")
- **As soon as** she **finishes**, we'll leave.
- Wait here **until** I **come** back.
- **Before** you **go**, please close the window.
- **If** it **rains**, we'll stay home.

✗ I'll call you when I will get home. ✓ I'll call you when I **get** home.

Summary: talking about the future

Form	Use	Example
will	decisions now, promises, predictions (opinion)	I'll help you. I think it'll be fine.
going to	plans, predictions (evidence)	I'm going to study medicine. It's going to rain.
present continuous	fixed arrangements	I'm seeing the doctor at 4.
present simple	timetables	The bus leaves at 10.
be about to	very near future	Hurry! The film is about to start.

✎ Practice: Will or going to?

1. "I'm thirsty." – "I ___ get you some water."

2. Look at the sky! It ___ rain.

3. We ___ visit Kerala next summer. We booked the hotel.

4. I think she ___ pass the exam.

5. "The bag is heavy." – "I ___ help you."

6. He ___ start a new job next month. He signed the contract.

7. I promise I ___ be late again.

8. Be careful! You ___ fall!

✎ Practice: Correct the mistakes

1. I will to go to the shop.

2. When I will finish, I'll call you.

3. She will comes tomorrow.

4. If it will rain, we stay home.

5. Are you go to study tonight?

Future Continuous

What is it?

The future continuous is for an action that will be **in progress** at a time in the future.

- This time tomorrow, I'**ll be flying** to London.
- At 8 p.m. we'**ll be having** dinner. Don't call then!

How to make it: will be + verb-ing

Positive	Negative	Question
I **will be** working	I **won't be** working	**Will** you **be** working?

When to use it

1. In progress at a future time

- At 10 a.m. tomorrow, I'**ll be sitting** in an exam.
- Don't call at 7 – I'**ll be driving**.

2. Polite questions about plans

- **Will** you **be using** the car tonight? (Can I use it?)
- **Will** you **be coming** to the meeting?

3. Things that will happen as a normal course of events

- I'**ll be seeing** Rahul at work tomorrow, so I can give him your message.

✎ Practice: Complete with the future continuous

1. This time next week, I ___ (lie) on a beach.

2. At 9 tomorrow, she ___ (teach).

3. ___ you ___ (use) your laptop this evening?

4. Don't phone at 6. We ___ (have) dinner.

5. In 2030, people ___ (drive) electric cars.

Future Perfect

What is it?

The future perfect is for an action that **will be finished before** a time in the future.

- By 2030, I **will have finished** university.
- By the time you arrive, I'**ll have cooked** dinner.

How to make it: will have + past participle (V3)

Positive	Negative	Question
I **will have** finished	I **won't have** finished	**Will** you **have** finished?

Signal words: by (by tomorrow, by 5 p.m., by next year), **by the time**, **before**, **in two weeks' time**

- **By** next June, we **will have been** married for ten years.
- She **won't have finished** the report **by** Friday.
- **Will** they **have arrived by** 8?

✎ Practice: Complete with the future perfect

1. By 10 p.m., I ___ (finish) my homework.

2. By next year, she ___ (save) enough money.

3. The film ___ (start) by the time we get there.

4. ___ you ___ (read) the book by Monday?

5. By 2030, they ___ (build) the new airport.

Future Perfect Continuous

What is it?

The future perfect continuous shows **how long** an action will have continued up to a point in the future.

- By December, I **will have been working** here for ten years.
- When she retires, she **will have been teaching** for 40 years.

How to make it: will have been + verb-ing

- By 6 o'clock, we **will have been waiting** for three hours.
- Next month, they **will have been living** in Canada for five years.

Tip: This tense is rare in conversation. You need to understand it, but you will not use it often. Don't worry about it too much!

✎ Practice: Complete with the future perfect continuous

1. By noon, I ___ (study) for four hours.

2. In June, we ___ (live) here for two years.

3. By the time he finishes, he ___ (work) for 12 hours.

All 12 Tenses: Summary and Review

One verb, 12 tenses

Tense	Example with "eat"	Key use
Present simple	I eat rice every day.	habits, facts
Present continuous	I am eating now.	now, temporary, arrangements
Present perfect	I have eaten sushi.	experience, result now, unfinished time
Present perfect continuous	I have been eating for 20 minutes.	duration up to now
Past simple	I ate at 8 last night.	finished past
Past continuous	I was eating when you called.	in progress in the past
Past perfect	I had eaten before you arrived.	before another past action
Past perfect continuous	I had been eating for an hour when...	duration before a past point
Future simple	I will eat later.	decisions, predictions, promises
Future continuous	I will be eating at 8.	in progress in the future
Future perfect	I will have eaten by 9.	finished before a future time
Future perfect continuous	By 9, I will have been eating for an hour.	duration up to a future point

Questions in all tenses

Tense	Question
Present simple	**Do** you **work** here?
Present continuous	**Are** you **working**?
Present perfect	**Have** you **worked** here long?
Present perfect continuous	How long **have** you **been working** here?
Past simple	**Did** you **work** yesterday?

Tense	Question
Past continuous	**Were** you **working** at 9?
Past perfect	**Had** you **worked** there before?
Past perfect continuous	How long **had** you **been working**?
Future simple	**Will** you **work** tomorrow?
Future continuous	**Will** you **be working** at 5?
Future perfect	**Will** you **have finished** by 5?
Future perfect continuous	How long **will** you **have been working**?

Signal words help you choose the tense

Signal words	Tense
always, usually, often, every day, on Mondays	present simple
now, at the moment, Look!, Listen!, this week	present continuous
ever, never, just, already, yet, for, since, so far	present perfect
how long, all day, for, since (with action verbs)	present perfect continuous
yesterday, ago, last week, in 2010, when I was young	past simple
while, at 8 last night, when (+ interruption)	past continuous
before, after, already, by the time (past)	past perfect
tomorrow, next week, I think, probably, soon	will / going to
this time tomorrow, at 8 tomorrow	future continuous
by tomorrow, by the time, by 2030	future perfect

✎ Practice: Mixed tenses – choose the correct form

1. I ___ (live) in Delhi since 2012.

2. Look! The children ___ (dance).

3. She ___ (go) to the dentist yesterday.

4. We ___ (have) dinner when the guests arrived.

5. He usually ___ (drink) tea in the morning.

6. By the time we arrived, the shop ___ (close).

7. I think it ___ (be) sunny tomorrow.

8. ___ you ever ___ (meet) a famous person?

9. I ___ (wait) for you for 30 minutes! Where are you?

10. This time tomorrow, I ___ (travel) to Jaipur.

11. They ___ (not / see) the film yet.

12. Water ___ (boil) at 100 degrees.

13. When I was young, I ___ (play) outside every day.

14. Next year, she ___ (study) in Canada. She has a visa.

15. By 2030, I ___ (finish) my degree.

16. She ___ (cook) when she cut her finger.

17. I ___ (not / understand) this question.

18. We ___ (meet) the manager at 4 p.m. tomorrow.

19. He ___ (work) here for ten years by next June.

20. They were tired because they ___ (walk) for hours.

Part 4: Building Sentences

Questions, modal verbs, conditionals, passive voice, reported speech and more

Asking Questions

Two types of questions

1. **Yes/No questions** – the answer is yes or no: "Are you hungry?" "Do you like tea?"

2. **Wh- questions** – ask for information: "Where do you live?" "Why are you late?"

Yes/No questions: the auxiliary comes first

Use the **auxiliary verb** (be, do, have, can, will...) before the subject.

Statement	Question
She **is** a teacher.	**Is** she a teacher?
They **are** coming.	**Are** they coming?
He **can** swim.	**Can** he swim?
You **have** finished.	**Have** you finished?
It **will** rain.	**Will** it rain?
You **like** pizza.	**Do** you like pizza?
She **works** here.	**Does** she work here?
They **went** home.	**Did** they go home?

> **Tip:** If there is no auxiliary in the sentence (present simple or past simple), add **do / does / did**.

Question words

Word	Asks about	Example
What	thing / information	**What** is your name? **What** do you do?
Where	place	**Where** do you live?
When	time	**When** is the meeting?
What time	exact time	**What time** does the bus leave?

Word	Asks about	Example
Who	person	**Who** is your best friend?
Whom	person (object, formal)	**Whom** did you invite?
Whose	owner	**Whose** car is this?
Which	choice from a group	**Which** colour do you prefer, red or blue?
Why	reason	**Why** are you crying?
How	way / manner / condition	**How** do you go to work? **How** are you?
How much	price / uncountable amount	**How much** is this? **How much** water?
How many	countable number	**How many** brothers do you have?
How old	age	**How old** are you?
How long	duration / length	**How long** does it take? **How long** is the river?
How often	frequency	**How often** do you exercise?
How far	distance	**How far** is the station?
What kind of	type	**What kind of** music do you like?

Word order in Wh- questions

Question word + auxiliary + subject + main verb + ...?

Question word	Auxiliary	Subject	Main verb	Rest
Where	do	you	live?	
What	is	she	doing?	
When	did	they	arrive?	
How long	have	you	been	here?
Why	can't	he	come?	
What time	will	the train	arrive?	

✗ Where you are going? ✓ Where **are you** going?

✗ What you want? ✓ What **do you** want?

✗ Why she is angry? ✓ Why **is she** angry?

✗ How much it costs? ✓ How much **does it** cost?

Subject questions (no do/does/did)

When **who** or **what** is the **subject** (the person/thing doing the action), do not use do/does/did:

Object question	Subject question
Who did you **call**? – I called Sam.	**Who called** you? – Sam called me.
What did she **break**? – She broke a glass.	**What happened**? – There was an accident.

- **Who lives** here? (not "Who does live here?")
- **Who wants** coffee?
- **What makes** you happy?
- **How many** people **came** to the party?

Questions with prepositions at the end

In English, the preposition often goes at the **end** of the question:

- **Where** are you **from**?
- **Who** are you talking **to**?
- **What** are you looking **at**?
- **What** is this book **about**?
- **Who** is this gift **for**?
- **What** are you afraid **of**?

Indirect (polite) questions

To be more polite, start with "Could you tell me...", "Do you know...", "I wonder...". The word order becomes **normal** (subject + verb). There is no do/does/did.

Direct question	Indirect question
Where **is** the bank?	Could you tell me where **the bank is**?
What time **does** the shop **open**?	Do you know what time **the shop opens**?
How much **is** this?	Can you tell me how much **this is**?
Did she call?	Do you know **if / whether** she called?

Direct question	Indirect question
Why **is** he late?	I wonder why **he is** late.

✗ Can you tell me where is the station? ✓ Can you tell me where **the station is**?

✗ Do you know what time does the film start? ✓ Do you know what time **the film starts**?

Question tags

A question tag is a short question at the end of a sentence. We use it to check information or ask for agreement.

Positive sentence → negative tag. Negative sentence → positive tag.

Sentence	Tag
You **are** a student,	**aren't** you?
She **isn't** here,	**is** she?
He **can** drive,	**can't** he?
They **don't** eat meat,	**do** they?
You **like** coffee,	**don't** you?
She **went** home,	**didn't** she?
We **have** met before,	**haven't** we?
It **will** be fine,	**won't** it?
I **am** right,	**aren't** I? (special!)
Let's go,	**shall** we?
Open the door,	**will** you?

- Voice going **down** ↘ = you are sure, you want agreement: "It's a lovely day, isn't it? ↘"
- Voice going **up** ↗ = a real question, you are not sure: "You're coming, aren't you? ↗"

Short answers

In English, we rarely answer only "Yes" or "No". It can sound rude. Use short answers:

- "Do you like it?" – "Yes, I **do**." / "No, I **don't**."
- "Is she ready?" – "Yes, she **is**." / "No, she **isn't**."
- "Can you swim?" – "Yes, I **can**." / "No, I **can't**."
- "Have you finished?" – "Yes, I **have**." / "Not yet."

Agreeing: so do I / neither do I

Statement	Agree (same)	Disagree (different)
I like tea.	**So do I.** / Me too.	Really? I **don't**.
I don't like tea.	**Neither do I.** / Me neither.	Really? I **do**.
I'm tired.	**So am I.**	I'm **not**.
I can't swim.	**Neither can I.**	I **can**.
I went to Goa.	**So did I.**	I **didn't**.
I've never been there.	**Neither have I.**	I **have**.

✎ Practice: Make questions

1. She lives in Pune. (Where...?)

2. They are watching TV. (What...?)

3. He went to the doctor. (Where...?)

4. I get up at 6. (What time...?)

5. The bag costs 500 rupees. (How much...?)

6. Riya broke the window. (Who...?)

7. I have two sisters. (How many...?)

8. She is crying because she is sad. (Why...?)

9. I go to the gym three times a week. (How often...?)

10. It takes 20 minutes. (How long...?)

✎ Practice: Add question tags

1. You're from Delhi, ___?

2. She can't swim, ___?

3. They went to the party, ___?

4. He doesn't eat fish, ___?

5. We've met before, ___?

6. I'm late, ___?

7. Let's have a break, ___?

8. It will rain, ___?

✎ Practice: Make the questions polite

1. Where is the toilet? (Could you tell me...)

2. What time does the bank close? (Do you know...)

3. Is this seat free? (Do you know if...)

Negative Sentences

How to make negatives

Add **not** after the auxiliary. If there is no auxiliary, use **don't / doesn't / didn't**.

Positive	Negative
I **am** happy.	I'm **not** happy.
She **is** at home.	She **isn't** at home.
They **can** come.	They **can't** come.
I **will** go.	I **won't** go.
He **has** finished.	He **hasn't** finished.
I **like** tea.	I **don't** like tea.
She **works** here.	She **doesn't** work here.
We **saw** it.	We **didn't** see it.

Short forms

Long	Short
is not	isn't
are not	aren't
was not	wasn't
were not	weren't
do not	don't
does not	doesn't
did not	didn't
have not	haven't
has not	hasn't
had not	hadn't
will not	won't
would not	wouldn't

Long	Short
cannot	can't
could not	couldn't
should not	shouldn't
must not	mustn't

Only one negative!

In standard English, use only **one** negative word in a sentence.

✗ I don't know nothing. ✓ I don't know **anything**. / I know **nothing**.

✗ I didn't see nobody. ✓ I didn't see **anybody**. / I saw **nobody**.

✗ She never doesn't eat meat. ✓ She **never** eats meat.

✗ We don't have no money. ✓ We don't have **any** money.

Other negative words

Word	Example
never	I **never** drink alcohol.
nobody / no one	**Nobody** called.
nothing	There's **nothing** in the fridge.
nowhere	I have **nowhere** to go.
none	**None** of my friends came.
no + noun	There's **no** milk. I have **no** idea.
neither ... nor	**Neither** Ali **nor** Sara came.
hardly / barely	I can **hardly** see. (almost not)

Negative questions

We use these to show surprise or to check something we think is true:

- **Don't** you like chocolate? (I'm surprised!)
- **Isn't** she your sister? (I thought she was.)
- **Why didn't** you call me?
- **Can't** you see I'm busy?

Answer carefully: "Don't you like it?" – "**No**, I don't." (= I don't like it.) / "**Yes**, I do." (= I like it.)

✎ Practice: Make these sentences negative

1. I like football.

2. She is a doctor.

3. They went to school.

4. He can drive.

5. We have finished.

6. She speaks French.

7. I will come.

8. It was cold.

✎ Practice: Correct the double negatives

1. I don't want nothing.

2. Nobody didn't help me.

3. She doesn't know nobody here.

Modal Verbs: Can, Could, Must, Should and More

What are modal verbs?

Modal verbs are special helping verbs. They show **ability, possibility, permission, obligation, advice**, and more.

The modals: can, could, may, might, must, shall, should, will, would, and semi-modals **have to, need to, ought to, be able to**.

Grammar rules for modals

1. Modal + **base verb** (no "to"): I can **swim**. (not "I can to swim")
2. **No -s** with he/she/it: She **can** swim. (not "She cans")
3. Negatives: add **not**: can't, shouldn't, mustn't, won't
4. Questions: put the modal first: **Can** you help me?

✗ She can speaks English. ✓ She can **speak** English.

✗ I must to go. ✓ I must **go**.

✗ He cans swim. ✓ He **can** swim.

✗ Do you can help me? ✓ **Can** you help me?

CAN / CAN'T

Use	Example
Ability (present)	I **can** speak three languages. She **can't** swim.
Permission (informal)	**Can** I use your phone? You **can** sit here.
Requests (informal)	**Can** you pass the salt, please?
Possibility	It **can** be very hot in May.
Offers	**Can** I help you?

Be able to

Use "be able to" for ability in other tenses:

- I **will be able to** come tomorrow. (future)
- I **have** never **been able to** swim. (present perfect)
- I'd like **to be able to** play the piano.

COULD

Use	Example
Past ability	When I was five, I **could** read. I **couldn't** sleep last night.
Polite request	**Could** you help me, please? **Could** I ask a question?
Possibility	It **could** rain later. That **could** be true.
Suggestion	We **could** go to the cinema.

> **Tip:** "Could you...?" is more polite than "Can you...?". Use "could" with strangers, at work, and in shops.

MAY and MIGHT

Use	Example
Possibility (maybe)	It **may** rain. She **might** be at home. I **might not** come.
Formal permission	**May** I come in? You **may** leave now.

"May" and "might" are almost the same for possibility. "Might" is a little less sure.

- I **may** go to the party. (about 50%)
- I **might** go to the party. (about 30–40%)

MUST and HAVE TO

Use	Example
Strong obligation (from the speaker)	I **must** finish this today. You **must** see this film!
Obligation (rules, from outside)	I **have to** wear a uniform at work.
Strong logical conclusion	You've worked all day. You **must** be tired.

Mustn't vs don't have to – VERY different!

mustn't	don't have to
It is **forbidden**. Don't do it!	It is **not necessary**. You can choose.
You **mustn't** smoke here.	You **don't have to** come. (but you can if you want)
You **mustn't** tell anyone. It's a secret.	It's Sunday. I **don't have to** work.

Past of must = had to

- I **had to** work late yesterday. (not "I musted")

SHOULD and OUGHT TO

Use for **advice** and recommendations – what is a good idea.

- You **should** see a doctor.
- You **shouldn't** eat so much sugar.
- What **should** I do?
- You **ought to** apologise. (= should, a little more formal)
- I think you **should** learn English every day!

Had better (strong advice, warning)

- You'**d better** hurry, or you'll miss the train.
- You'**d better not** be late again.

WOULD

Use	Example
Polite requests	**Would** you open the door, please?
Offers	**Would** you like some tea?
Wishes / preferences	I **would like** a coffee. I'**d rather** stay home.
Imaginary situations	I **would** buy a house if I had money.

Would like vs like

- "**Do you like** coffee?" = in general. "Yes, I do."
- "**Would you like** a coffee?" = an offer now. "Yes, please." / "No, thank you."

  ✗ I like a coffee, please. ✓ I'**d like** a coffee, please.

SHALL

Mostly used with I/we for offers and suggestions (British English):

- **Shall** I carry your bag? (offer)
- **Shall** we go? (suggestion)
- What time **shall** we meet?

NEED

- I **need to** buy some milk.
- You **don't need to** worry. (= don't have to)
- **Do** I **need to** bring anything?

Modal verbs in the past (modal + have + V3)

Form	Meaning	Example
should have + V3	it was a good idea, but you didn't	You **should have told** me!
shouldn't have + V3	it was a bad idea, but you did it	I **shouldn't have eaten** so much.
could have + V3	it was possible, but didn't happen	You **could have died**!

Form	Meaning	Example
might / may have + V3	maybe it happened	She **might have missed** the bus.
must have + V3	I'm sure it happened	He **must have forgotten**.
can't have + V3	I'm sure it didn't happen	She **can't have seen** us.
would have + V3	imaginary past	I **would have helped** you.

Summary of modals

Function	Modals
Ability	can, could, be able to
Permission	can, could, may
Requests	can, could, will, would
Offers	can, shall, will, would you like
Possibility	may, might, could
Certainty / deduction	must (sure yes), can't (sure no)
Obligation	must, have to, need to
No obligation	don't have to, don't need to, needn't
Prohibition	mustn't, can't
Advice	should, ought to, had better

✎ Practice: Choose the correct modal

1. I ___ swim when I was six. (can / could)

2. You ___ smoke in the hospital. It's forbidden. (mustn't / don't have to)

3. It's a holiday tomorrow. We ___ go to work. (mustn't / don't have to)

4. You look ill. You ___ see a doctor. (should / can)

5. ___ I open the window? (Shall / Will)

6. ___ you like some cake? (Do / Would)

7. She ___ be at home. Her car is outside. (must / can't)

8. He ___ be at work. It's Sunday. (must / can't)

9. ___ you help me with this bag, please? (Could / Must)

10. It ___ rain later. Take an umbrella. (might / must)

✎ Practice: Correct the mistakes

1. She can sings very well.

2. You must to wear a seatbelt.

3. Do you can speak English?

4. I musted work yesterday.

5. He shoulds study more.

6. I like a cup of tea, please.

✎ Practice: Complete with should have / must have / could have

1. You ___ (tell) me! I would have helped.

2. The ground is wet. It ___ (rain) last night.

3. Be careful! You ___ (fall)!

Conditionals: If Sentences

What are conditionals?

Conditional sentences have two parts: the **if-clause** (the condition) and the **main clause** (the result).

"**If it rains**, **I will stay at home**."

You can start with either part. If you start with "if", use a comma: "If it rains, I'll stay home." / "I'll stay home if it rains."

Zero conditional: facts that are always true

If + present simple, present simple

- If you heat water to 100°C, it **boils**.
- If I **drink** coffee at night, I **can't** sleep.
- Plants **die** if they **don't get** water.

("If" here means "when" or "every time".)

First conditional: real future possibility

If + present simple, will + base verb

- If it **rains** tomorrow, we **will stay** at home.
- If you **study** hard, you **will pass** the exam.
- I**'ll call** you if I **have** time.
- If you **don't hurry**, you**'ll miss** the bus.

✗ If it will rain, I will stay home. ✓ If it **rains**, I will stay home.

> **Tip:** Never use "will" in the if-clause. "If" + present, then "will" in the result.

Unless = if not

- **Unless** you hurry, you'll be late. (= If you don't hurry...)
- I won't go **unless** you come with me.

Second conditional: imaginary present or unlikely future

If + past simple, would + base verb

The situation is **not real** or very **unlikely**. The past tense here does **not** mean past time – it means "imaginary".

- If I **had** a lot of money, I **would buy** a big house. (But I don't have a lot of money.)
- If I **won** the lottery, I**'d travel** around the world.
- What **would** you **do** if you **saw** a ghost?
- If she **lived** near here, she **would visit** us more often.

If I were you (advice)

With "be", we often use **were** for all persons in the second conditional:

- If I **were** you, I **would** take the job.
- If I **were** rich, I'd help poor people.
- If he **were** taller, he could play basketball.

Third conditional: imaginary past (regrets)

If + past perfect, would have + past participle

We talk about the **past** – something that did not happen, and its imaginary result.

- If I **had studied**, I **would have passed** the exam. (But I didn't study, and I failed.)
- If you **had told** me, I **would have helped** you.
- If we **had left** earlier, we **wouldn't have missed** the train.
- She **would have come** if she **had known** about the party.

Mixed conditionals

Past condition → present result:

- If I **had taken** that job, I **would be** rich now.
- If she **hadn't missed** the flight, she **would be** here now.

Summary

Type	If-clause	Main clause	Use
Zero	present simple	present simple	always true
First	present simple	will + verb	real future possibility
Second	past simple	would + verb	imaginary present / unlikely future
Third	past perfect	would have + V3	imaginary past

Compare

- If I **have** time, I **will** help you. (Maybe I will have time – real.)
- If I **had** time, I **would** help you. (I don't have time – imaginary.)
- If I **had had** time, I **would have helped** you. (I didn't have time – past.)

Wishes and regrets

Wish about	Form	Example
Present (I want it to be different now)	wish + past simple	I **wish** I **had** a car. I wish I **were** taller. I wish I **spoke** English fluently.
Past (regret)	wish + past perfect	I **wish** I **had studied** harder. I wish I **hadn't said** that.
Annoying behaviour / want change	wish + would	I **wish** you **would** stop shouting!

"If only" is stronger: **If only** I **had** more time!

✎ Practice: First conditional

1. If it ___ (rain), I ___ (take) an umbrella.

2. If you ___ (not / eat), you ___ (be) hungry.

3. She ___ (be) angry if you ___ (be) late.

4. If I ___ (see) him, I ___ (tell) him.

5. Unless you ___ (study), you ___ (fail).

✎ Practice: Second conditional

1. If I ___ (have) a car, I ___ (drive) to work.

2. If she ___ (know) the answer, she ___ (tell) us.

3. What ___ you ___ (do) if you ___ (win) a million dollars?

4. If I ___ (be) you, I ___ (accept) the offer.

5. We ___ (go) to the beach if it ___ (be) sunny.

✎ Practice: Third conditional

1. If I ___ (know), I ___ (come).

2. If he ___ (study), he ___ (pass).

3. We ___ (not / be) late if we ___ (take) a taxi.

4. If you ___ (call) me, I ___ (help) you.

✎ Practice: Write a wish

1. I don't have a job.

2. I can't speak French.

3. I didn't go to the party.

4. I am not tall.

The Passive Voice

Active and passive

In an **active** sentence, the subject **does** the action:

- "The cat **ate** the fish." (focus on the cat)

In a **passive** sentence, the subject **receives** the action:

- "The fish **was eaten** by the cat." (focus on the fish)

We use the passive when:

- the **action** is more important than who did it: "English **is spoken** all over the world."
- we **don't know** who did it: "My bike **was stolen**."
- it is **obvious** who did it: "He **was arrested**." (by the police, of course)
- in formal or scientific writing: "The results **were analysed**."

How to make it: be + past participle (V3)

The verb "be" changes for the tense. The V3 stays the same.

Tense	Active	Passive
Present simple	They **make** cars here.	Cars **are made** here.
Present continuous	They **are building** a bridge.	A bridge **is being built**.
Past simple	Someone **stole** my bag.	My bag **was stolen**.
Past continuous	They **were painting** the house.	The house **was being painted**.
Present perfect	They **have sold** the house.	The house **has been sold**.
Past perfect	They **had cancelled** the flight.	The flight **had been cancelled**.
Future (will)	They **will open** a new shop.	A new shop **will be opened**.
Going to	They **are going to repair** the road.	The road **is going to be repaired**.
Modal	You **must sign** the form.	The form **must be signed**.
Modal	They **can't fix** it.	It **can't be fixed**.

By + agent

Add "by" + the person/thing only when it is important:

- "Romeo and Juliet" **was written by** Shakespeare.
- This picture **was painted by** my grandfather.
- The house **was destroyed by** a fire.

Common passive phrases in daily life

- I **was born** in 1995. (never "I born" or "I am born")
- It **is made of** wood / glass / gold.
- It **is made in** China.
- She **was invited** to the wedding.
- The shop **is closed** on Sundays.
- The meeting **has been cancelled**.
- Breakfast **is included**.
- English **is spoken** here.
- **Is** this seat **taken**?
- I **was told** to wait here.
- He **got injured** in an accident. ("get" + V3 is informal passive)
- We **got married** in 2020.

  ✗ I born in Delhi. ✓ I **was born** in Delhi.

  ✗ The letter was wrote yesterday. ✓ The letter was **written** yesterday.

  ✗ This house built in 1990. ✓ This house **was built** in 1990.

  ✗ The window was broke. ✓ The window was **broken**.

✎ Practice: Change to passive

1. They clean the room every day.

2. Someone stole my phone.

3. They are building a new hospital.

4. They have cancelled the match.

5. They will deliver the parcel tomorrow.

6. Shakespeare wrote Hamlet.

7. You must wear a helmet.

8. People speak Spanish in Mexico.

✎ Practice: Complete with the correct passive form

1. I ___ (born) in Lucknow.

2. This bag ___ (make) of leather.

3. The thief ___ (catch) yesterday.

4. Your car ___ (repair) at the moment.

5. The results ___ (announce) next week.

Reported Speech

Direct and reported speech

Direct speech repeats the exact words: She said, "**I am tired**."

Reported (indirect) speech reports the meaning: She said (that) **she was tired**.

Tense changes (backshift)

When the reporting verb is in the past (said, told), the tense usually moves **one step back**.

Direct speech	Reported speech
Present simple: "I **work** here."	Past simple: He said he **worked** there.
Present continuous: "I **am cooking**."	Past continuous: She said she **was cooking**.
Past simple: "I **saw** him."	Past perfect: He said he **had seen** him.
Present perfect: "I **have finished**."	Past perfect: She said she **had finished**.
will: "I **will** call you."	would: He said he **would** call me.
can: "I **can** swim."	could: She said she **could** swim.
may: "I **may** come."	might: He said he **might** come.
must: "I **must** go."	had to: She said she **had to** go.

> **Tip:** If the information is still true now, you don't have to change the tense: "He said he **lives** in Delhi." (He still lives there.)

Other changes

Direct	Reported
now	then / at that time
today	that day
tonight	that night
yesterday	the day before / the previous day

Direct	Reported
tomorrow	the next day / the following day
last week	the week before / the previous week
next week	the week after / the following week
ago	before
here	there
this	that
these	those

Pronouns change too: "**I** love **you**." → He said **he** loved **me**.

Say or tell?

- **say** + (that) + sentence: She **said** (that) she was hungry. ("said to me" is possible but less common)
- **tell** + **person** + (that) + sentence: She **told me** (that) she was hungry.

  ✗ She said me she was hungry. ✓ She **told me** she was hungry. / She **said** she was hungry.

  ✗ He told that he was busy. ✓ He **said** that he was busy. / He **told me** that he was busy.

Reported questions

The word order becomes **normal** (subject + verb). No question mark. No do/does/did.

Direct question	Reported question
"Where **do you live**?"	She asked me where **I lived**.
"What **is** your name?"	He asked me what **my name was**.
"**Are** you married?"	She asked **if / whether** I was married.
"**Did** you see the film?"	He asked **if** I **had seen** the film.
"**Can** you help me?"	She asked **if** I **could** help her.

✗ He asked me where did I live. ✓ He asked me where **I lived**.

Reported orders and requests

Use **tell / ask + person + (not) to + verb**:

- "Sit down." → The teacher **told us to sit** down.
- "Don't be late." → My boss **told me not to be** late.
- "Please help me." → She **asked me to help** her.

Other reporting verbs

Verb	Example
explain	He **explained** that the train was late.
promise	She **promised to call** me.
offer	He **offered to help**.
refuse	They **refused to pay**.
advise	The doctor **advised me to rest**.
suggest	She **suggested going** to the cinema.
apologise	He **apologised for being** late.
agree	We **agreed to meet** at 6.
warn	I **warned him not to touch** it.
remind	**Remind me to buy** milk.

✎ Practice: Change to reported speech

1. "I am happy," she said.

2. "I live in Mumbai," he said.

3. "We will come tomorrow," they said.

4. "I saw the film yesterday," she said.

5. "I can't swim," he said.

6. "Where do you work?" she asked me.

7. "Are you hungry?" he asked.

8. "Close the door," the teacher told me.

9. "Don't touch it," she said to the children.

10. "I have lost my keys," he said.

✎ Practice: Say or tell?

1. She ___ me a secret.

2. He ___ that he was tired.

3. Can you ___ me the time?

4. They ___ goodbye and left.

5. Please ___ him to call me.

Gerunds and Infinitives

What are they?

- **Gerund** = verb + -ing used like a noun: **swimming**, **reading**, **eating**
- **Infinitive** = to + verb: **to swim**, **to read**, **to eat**

Some verbs are followed by a gerund, some by an infinitive, and some by both.

Gerund (-ing) after these verbs

Verb	Example
enjoy	I **enjoy reading**.
like / love / hate (also + to)	She **loves dancing**.
don't mind	I **don't mind waiting**.
finish	Have you **finished eating**?
stop	**Stop talking**!
avoid	Try to **avoid eating** junk food.
consider	We're **considering moving**.
suggest	He **suggested going** out.
practise	You should **practise speaking**.
keep (= continue)	She **kept calling** me.
give up	He **gave up smoking**.
can't stand	I **can't stand waiting**.
miss	I **miss seeing** you.
imagine	**Imagine living** on the moon!
admit / deny	He **admitted stealing** the money.
risk	Don't **risk losing** your job.
feel like	I **feel like eating** pizza.
look forward to	I'm **looking forward to seeing** you.

✗ I enjoy to read. ✓ I enjoy **reading**.

✗ I look forward to see you. ✓ I look forward to **seeing** you.

✗ He suggested to go. ✓ He suggested **going**.

Gerund after prepositions

After a preposition (in, on, at, of, for, about, without, before, after...), always use **-ing**:

- I'm interested **in learning** Spanish.
- She's good **at cooking**.
- Thank you **for helping** me.
- He left **without saying** goodbye.
- **Before going** to bed, I brush my teeth.
- I'm thinking **about changing** my job.
- How **about going** for a walk?

Gerund as a subject

- **Swimming** is good exercise.
- **Learning** English takes time.
- **Smoking** is bad for your health.

Infinitive (to + verb) after these verbs

Verb	Example
want	I **want to learn** English.
need	You **need to sleep**.
decide	We **decided to stay**.
hope	I **hope to see** you soon.
plan	They **plan to travel**.
promise	He **promised to help**.
agree	She **agreed to come**.
refuse	He **refused to answer**.
learn	I'm **learning to drive**.
try (make an effort)	**Try to relax**.

Verb	Example
would like / would love	I'**d like to go**.
offer	She **offered to pay**.
afford	I **can't afford to buy** a car.
seem	He **seems to be** happy.
forget / remember (see below)	Don't **forget to call** me.
manage	I **managed to finish** on time.
expect	I **expect to be** there by 6.
choose	She **chose to stay**.
pretend	He **pretended to be** asleep.
tend	People **tend to forget**.

Infinitive of purpose (why?)

Use **to + verb** to say **why** you do something:

- I went to the shop **to buy** some bread.
- She's saving money **to buy** a car.
- I'm learning English **to get** a better job.

✗ I went to the shop for buy bread. ✓ I went to the shop **to buy** bread.

✗ I came here for to study. ✓ I came here **to study**.

Adjective + infinitive

- It's **easy to learn**.
- It's **nice to meet** you.
- I'm **happy to help**.
- It's **difficult to understand**.
- It's **important to sleep** well.

Verbs with a different meaning

Verb	+ -ing	+ to
stop	stop the activity: I **stopped smoking**. (I don't smoke now)	stop in order to do something: I **stopped to smoke**. (I stopped walking so I could smoke)
remember	memory of the past: I **remember meeting** her.	not forget to do: **Remember to lock** the door.
forget	forget a past event: I'll never **forget seeing** the Taj Mahal.	forget a task: I **forgot to call** her.
try	experiment: **Try drinking** warm water.	make an effort: I **tried to open** it, but I couldn't.
regret	sorry about the past: I **regret telling** him.	sorry to give bad news: We **regret to inform** you...

Make and let + base verb (no "to")

- My mother **made me clean** my room. (forced)
- My father **let me drive** his car. (allowed)
- **Let's go**!
- Don't **make me laugh**!

✗ She made me to wait. ✓ She made me **wait**.

✗ Let me to help you. ✓ Let me **help** you.

✎ Practice: Gerund or infinitive?

1. I enjoy ___ (swim).

2. She wants ___ (become) a doctor.

3. They decided ___ (sell) the house.

4. Do you mind ___ (open) the window?

5. I'm looking forward to ___ (meet) you.

6. He promised ___ (call) me.

7. Stop ___ (make) that noise!

8. I went to the bank ___ (get) some money.

9. She is good at ___ (draw).

10. We can't afford ___ (buy) a new car.

11. Thank you for ___ (help) me.

12. I need ___ (talk) to you.

13. He gave up ___ (smoke) last year.

14. My parents let me ___ (stay) out late.

15. Remember ___ (turn off) the lights.

Relative Clauses: Who, Which, That, Where, Whose

What is a relative clause?

A relative clause gives more information about a noun. It helps you join two sentences.

- I have a friend. **She** lives in Paris. → I have a friend **who** lives in Paris.
- This is the book. I bought **it** yesterday. → This is the book **that** I bought yesterday.

Relative pronouns

Pronoun	For	Example
who	people	The man **who** called you is my uncle.
which	things, animals	The phone **which** I bought is great.
that	people or things (informal)	The film **that** we saw was boring.
where	places	This is the house **where** I was born.
when	times	I remember the day **when** we met.
whose	possession	That's the girl **whose** father is a pilot.
whom	people as object (formal)	The person **whom** I met was kind.

✗ The man which lives here. ✓ The man **who** lives here.

✗ The book who I read. ✓ The book **which/that** I read.

✗ This is the man who he helped me. ✓ This is the man who helped me. (don't repeat the pronoun)

✗ The city where I live in. ✓ The city where I live. / The city (which) I live in.

Can I leave out who/which/that?

Yes, when it is the **object** of the relative clause (there is another subject after it):

- The film (**that**) **we** saw was great. ✓ (we = subject)
- The man (**who**) **I** met was friendly. ✓

No, when it is the **subject**:

- The man **who** lives next door is a doctor. (You can't remove "who".)

Defining and non-defining

- **Defining** (no commas): necessary information. "Students **who study hard** pass exams." (only those students)
- **Non-defining** (with commas): extra information. "My brother, **who lives in Delhi**, is a lawyer." (I have only one brother; the information is extra.)

In non-defining clauses, you **cannot** use "that": "My car, **which** is red, is very fast." (not "that")

✎ Practice: Complete with who, which, where or whose

1. A doctor is someone ___ helps sick people.

2. This is the restaurant ___ we had our first date.

3. I lost the watch ___ my father gave me.

4. That's the woman ___ son plays for India.

5. The people ___ live upstairs are very noisy.

6. A fridge is a machine ___ keeps food cold.

7. Do you know a shop ___ I can buy cheap shoes?

8. He's the boy ___ bike was stolen.

✎ Practice: Join the sentences

1. I have a friend. He speaks five languages.

2. This is the café. I met my wife here.

3. She bought a dress. It was very expensive.

4. I know a man. His daughter is an actress.

Linking Words and Conjunctions

Why linking words matter

Linking words connect your ideas. They make your speaking and writing **smooth** and **clear**. Without them, you sound like a robot: "I was tired. I went to bed. I didn't sleep." With them: "I was tired, **so** I went to bed, **but** I couldn't sleep."

The basic linkers

Purpose	Words	Example
Adding	and, also, too, as well, in addition, moreover, furthermore, besides	I like tea **and** coffee. She speaks French **too**.
Contrast	but, however, although, though, even though, while, whereas, on the other hand, despite, in spite of	It was raining, **but** we went out. **Although** he's rich, he isn't happy.
Reason	because, because of, since, as, due to	I stayed home **because** I was sick. **Because of** the rain, the match was cancelled.
Result	so, therefore, as a result, that's why	I was hungry, **so** I ate. He didn't study. **As a result**, he failed.
Purpose	to, in order to, so that	I study **to** get a good job. Speak slowly **so that** everyone understands.
Condition	if, unless, as long as, in case	Take an umbrella **in case** it rains.
Time / sequence	first, then, next, after that, finally, before, after, when, while, as soon as, until	**First**, wash the rice. **Then** add water. **Finally**, cook it for 15 minutes.
Example	for example, for instance, such as, like	I love fruit, **such as** mangoes and bananas.
Opinion	in my opinion, I think, personally, I believe	**In my opinion**, the film was too long.

Purpose	Words	Example
Summary	in conclusion, to sum up, overall, in short	**In conclusion**, exercise is important.
Emphasis	in fact, actually, especially, indeed	I'm not tired. **In fact**, I feel great.

Because vs because of

- **because** + subject + verb: "The flight was late **because the weather was bad**."
- **because of** + noun: "The flight was late **because of the bad weather**."

Although / even though vs despite / in spite of

- **although / even though** + subject + verb: "**Although it was cold**, we went swimming."
- **despite / in spite of** + noun or -ing: "**Despite the cold**, we went swimming." "**In spite of being** tired, she finished the work."

  ✗ Although it was raining, but we went out. ✓ **Although** it was raining, we went out. (don't use "although" and "but" together)

  ✗ Despite of the rain. ✓ **Despite** the rain. / **In spite of** the rain.

  ✗ Because I was tired, so I slept. ✓ **Because** I was tired, I slept. / I was tired, **so** I slept.

So and such

- **so** + adjective / adverb: "It was **so hot**." "She speaks **so quickly**."
- **such** + (a/an) + adjective + noun: "It was **such a hot** day." "They are **such nice** people."
- so/such ... **that** (result): "It was **so** cold **that** we stayed inside." "It was **such** a good film **that** I watched it twice."

Both ... and, either ... or, neither ... nor, not only ... but also

- **Both** my brother **and** my sister are doctors.
- You can **either** call me **or** send a message.
- **Neither** the bus **nor** the train was on time.
- She is **not only** clever **but also** very kind.

Punctuation with linkers

- **However**, **therefore**, **moreover** usually start a new sentence and have a comma after: "I wanted to go. **However**, I was too tired."
- **But**, **so**, **and** join two parts of one sentence: "I wanted to go, **but** I was too tired."

✎ Practice: Choose the best linking word

1. I was hungry, (so / but) I made a sandwich.

2. She is rich, (but / so) she isn't happy.

3. We stayed at home (because / because of) the storm.

4. (Although / Despite) he was ill, he went to work.

5. (Although / Despite) the rain, we played football.

6. It was (so / such) a beautiful day.

7. The tea is (so / such) hot that I can't drink it.

8. I study hard (to / for) pass my exams.

9. Take a jacket (in case / unless) it gets cold.

10. I like many sports, (such as / so) football and tennis.

11. (First / Finally), boil the water. Then add the pasta.

12. She can speak (both / either) English and Hindi.

Punctuation and Capital Letters

Capital letters

Use a capital letter for:

- The **first word** of a sentence: "**T**he sun is hot."
- The word **I**: "My friend and **I** went out."
- **Names** of people and places: **P**riya, **L**ondon, **M**ount **E**verest
- **Days and months**: **M**onday, **J**uly (but not seasons: summer, winter)
- **Languages and nationalities**: **E**nglish, **J**apanese, **I**ndian
- **Titles**: **M**r **S**harma, **D**r **K**han, **P**rofessor **R**ao
- Names of **books, films, companies**: *The Lion King*, **G**oogle

Main punctuation marks

Mark	Name	Use	Example
.	full stop (UK) / period (US)	end of a sentence	I am tired.
,	comma	pauses, lists, after linkers	I bought apples, bananas and grapes.
?	question mark	end of a question	Where are you?
!	exclamation mark	strong feeling	Wow! That's amazing!
'	apostrophe	short forms, possession	don't, it's, Ravi's car
" "	quotation marks	direct speech	She said, "Hello."
:	colon	before a list or explanation	You need three things: a pen, paper and time.
;	semicolon	joins two related sentences	It was late; we went home.
-	hyphen	joins words	a well-known actor, twenty-one
( )	brackets	extra information	My boss (who is very kind) helped me.

Common comma rules

- After introductory words: "**However,** I was late." "**Yesterday,** I went to the market."
- In lists: "red, blue, green and yellow"
- Before "but" and "so" joining two sentences: "I like tea, **but** she likes coffee."
- After an if-clause at the start: "If it rains, we will stay home."
- Around extra information: "My sister, **a nurse**, works at night."

Apostrophe mistakes

✗ Apple's for sale. ✓ Apple**s** for sale. (plural – no apostrophe)

✗ The dog wagged it's tail. ✓ The dog wagged **its** tail.

✗ In the 1990's ✓ In the **1990s**

✎ Practice: Add capital letters and punctuation

1. my name is ali and i live in dubai

2. where do you work

3. i bought eggs milk bread and butter

4. we met on monday in june

5. its my brothers car

Part 5: Vocabulary

The words and phrases you need for everyday life

How to Learn Vocabulary

Learning words the smart way

You do not need 50,000 words to be fluent. The **2,000 most common words** cover about **80–90%** of everyday conversation. 3,000 words is enough for most situations. This part of the book gives you those words, organised by topic.

Five methods that work

- **Learn in context.** Always learn a word with an example sentence. "Borrow" → "Can I **borrow** your pen?"
- **Learn word partners (collocations).** "heavy rain" (not "strong rain"), "make a mistake" (not "do a mistake").
- **Use spaced repetition.** Review new words after 1 day, 3 days, 1 week, 2 weeks and 1 month. Flashcard apps (like Anki) do this automatically.
- **Use the word.** Within 24 hours, use each new word in a sentence – spoken or written. Words you use become yours.
- **Group words by topic.** It's easier to remember "kitchen words" together than random words.

How many words per day?

10 new words per day = 300 words per month = 3,600 words per year. That is enough to become fluent! Don't try to learn 100 words in one day – you will forget them.

> **Tip:** For each topic in this part, choose the words you don't know. Write them in your notebook with your **own** example sentence. Then say the sentence out loud three times.

Irregular Verbs: The Complete List

How to learn irregular verbs

Irregular verbs are some of the most common verbs in English. Learn them in groups with similar patterns. Say all three forms out loud: "**go – went – gone**".

Group 1: All three forms are the same (A-A-A)

Base	Past	Past participle	Meaning
bet	bet	bet	risk money on a result
cost	cost	cost	have a price
cut	cut	cut	divide with a knife
fit	fit	fit	be the right size
hit	hit	hit	strike
hurt	hurt	hurt	cause pain
let	let	let	allow
put	put	put	place
quit	quit	quit	stop, leave
read	read	read	(said "reed", "red", "red")
set	set	set	put, arrange
shut	shut	shut	close
spread	spread	spread	open out, cover
upset	upset	upset	make sad / worried
broadcast	broadcast	broadcast	send out on TV/radio
forecast	forecast	forecast	predict

Group 2: Past and past participle are the same (A-B-B)

Base	Past	Past participle	Meaning
bring	brought	brought	carry to here
build	built	built	make a structure

Base	Past	Past participle	Meaning
buy	bought	bought	pay for
catch	caught	caught	take hold of
dig	dug	dug	make a hole
feed	fed	fed	give food
feel	felt	felt	experience
fight	fought	fought	battle
find	found	found	discover
get	got	got (UK) / gotten (US)	receive, become
hang	hung	hung	attach at the top
have	had	had	own, possess
hear	heard	heard	receive sound
hold	held	held	keep in your hand
keep	kept	kept	continue to have
lay	laid	laid	put down flat
lead	led	led	guide
leave	left	left	go away
lend	lent	lent	give for a time
light	lit	lit	start a fire
lose	lost	lost	not have any more
make	made	made	create
mean	meant	meant	have a meaning
meet	met	met	see someone
pay	paid	paid	give money
say	said	said	speak words
sell	sold	sold	give for money
send	sent	sent	make something go
shine	shone	shone	give light
shoot	shot	shot	fire a gun
sit	sat	sat	be on a chair

Base	Past	Past participle	Meaning
sleep	slept	slept	rest at night
slide	slid	slid	move smoothly
spend	spent	spent	use money/time
stand	stood	stood	be on your feet
stick	stuck	stuck	attach, glue
sting	stung	stung	hurt (bees)
strike	struck	struck	hit
sweep	swept	swept	clean with a brush
swing	swung	swung	move back and forth
teach	taught	taught	give lessons
tell	told	told	say to someone
think	thought	thought	use your mind
understand	understood	understood	know the meaning
win	won	won	be first
burn	burnt / burned	burnt / burned	be on fire
dream	dreamt / dreamed	dreamt / dreamed	see in sleep
learn	learnt / learned	learnt / learned	get knowledge
smell	smelt / smelled	smelt / smelled	use your nose
spell	spelt / spelled	spelt / spelled	say the letters

Group 3: All three forms are different (A-B-C)

Base	Past	Past participle	Meaning
be	was / were	been	exist
bear	bore	born / borne	carry, give birth
begin	began	begun	start
bite	bit	bitten	cut with teeth
blow	blew	blown	move air
break	broke	broken	damage
choose	chose	chosen	select

Base	Past	Past participle	Meaning
do	did	done	perform
draw	drew	drawn	make a picture
drink	drank	drunk	take liquid
drive	drove	driven	control a car
eat	ate	eaten	take food
fall	fell	fallen	drop down
fly	flew	flown	move in the air
forbid	forbade	forbidden	not allow
forget	forgot	forgotten	not remember
forgive	forgave	forgiven	stop being angry
freeze	froze	frozen	become ice
give	gave	given	hand to
go	went	gone	move to
grow	grew	grown	get bigger
hide	hid	hidden	put out of sight
know	knew	known	have information
lie (down)	lay	lain	be flat (on a bed)
ride	rode	ridden	travel on a bike/horse
ring	rang	rung	make a bell sound
rise	rose	risen	go up
see	saw	seen	use your eyes
shake	shook	shaken	move quickly side to side
show	showed	shown	let someone see
sing	sang	sung	make music with voice
sink	sank	sunk	go under water
speak	spoke	spoken	talk
steal	stole	stolen	take without permission
swim	swam	swum	move in water
take	took	taken	carry, get

Base	Past	Past participle	Meaning
tear	tore	torn	rip paper/cloth
throw	threw	thrown	send through the air
wake	woke	woken	stop sleeping
wear	wore	worn	have clothes on
write	wrote	written	put words on paper
mistake	mistook	mistaken	be wrong about
undertake	undertook	undertaken	start a task

Group 4: Base and past participle are the same (A-B-A)

Base	Past	Past participle	Meaning
become	became	become	start to be
come	came	come	move here
run	ran	run	move fast on foot
overcome	overcame	overcome	defeat a problem

Tip: Make it a game. Every day, choose 10 irregular verbs. Make three sentences for each one: "I **eat** rice every day. I **ate** rice yesterday. I **have eaten** rice many times."

Confusing pairs

Verb	Forms	Example
lie (be flat)	lie – lay – lain	I **lay** on the bed for an hour.
lie (not tell the truth)	lie – lied – lied	He **lied** to me.
lay (put down)	lay – laid – laid	She **laid** the baby on the bed.
rise (go up, no object)	rise – rose – risen	The sun **rose** at 6.
raise (lift something)	raise – raised – raised	**Raise** your hand.
fall (drop)	fall – fell – fallen	I **fell** off my bike.
feel (experience)	feel – felt – felt	I **felt** sick.
fill (make full)	fill – filled – filled	She **filled** the glass.

✎ Practice: Write the past simple and past participle

1. go
2. eat
3. write
4. buy
5. take
6. see
7. begin
8. bring
9. speak
10. drink
11. fly
12. teach
13. choose
14. forget
15. put
16. run
17. catch
18. break
19. know
20. swim

Topic Vocabulary 1: People, Family and the Body

Family members

Word	Meaning / example
parents	your mother and father
father / dad	My dad is a farmer.
mother / mum (UK) / mom (US)	My mum cooks very well.
son / daughter	They have one son and two daughters.
brother / sister	I have an older brother.
siblings	brothers and sisters: "How many siblings do you have?"
grandfather / grandmother	your parents' father / mother
grandparents	My grandparents live in a village.
grandson / granddaughter / grandchildren	your children's children
uncle / aunt	your parents' brother / sister (or their husband/wife)
cousin	your uncle's or aunt's child
nephew / niece	your brother's or sister's son / daughter
husband / wife	married partners: "This is my wife, Anita."
spouse	husband or wife (formal)
father-in-law / mother-in-law	your husband's or wife's father / mother
brother-in-law / sister-in-law	your spouse's brother/sister, or your sibling's spouse
son-in-law / daughter-in-law	your daughter's husband / your son's wife
stepfather / stepmother	the new husband/wife of your mother/father
twins	two children born at the same time
only child	a child with no brothers or sisters
relatives	people in your family: "Many relatives came to the wedding."
ancestors	family members who lived long ago
fiancé / fiancée	the man / woman you will marry
boyfriend / girlfriend / partner	someone in a romantic relationship

Word	Meaning / example
single / married / divorced / widowed	relationship status
nuclear family / joint family	parents + children / many generations living together

Describing appearance

Topic	Words
Height	tall, short, medium height, average height
Build	slim, thin, skinny, slender, overweight, fat (rude!), plump, chubby, muscular, well-built, fit
Age	young, middle-aged, old, elderly (polite), in his twenties, in her forties, a teenager, a baby, a toddler
Hair	long, short, shoulder-length, straight, wavy, curly, black, brown, blonde, red, grey, bald, a ponytail
Face	round, oval, square, a beard, a moustache, wrinkles, freckles, dimples
Eyes	brown, blue, green, big, small, dark
Skin	fair, dark, tanned, pale, smooth
General	good-looking, handsome (men), beautiful / pretty (women), attractive, cute, plain, well-dressed, smart

- "What does she **look like**?" – "She's tall and slim, with long black hair."
- "He's **in his thirties**, with short curly hair and a beard."

✗ How does he look like? ✓ **What** does he look like?

> **Tip:** "What is he like?" asks about **personality**. "What does he look like?" asks about **appearance**.

Describing personality

Positive	Negative
kind, caring	unkind, cruel
friendly, sociable, outgoing	unfriendly, shy, unsociable
honest, trustworthy	dishonest, untrustworthy
generous	mean, stingy, selfish
hardworking	lazy
patient	impatient
calm, relaxed	nervous, anxious, stressed
confident	insecure, shy
funny, humorous	serious, boring
polite, respectful	rude, impolite
clever, intelligent, smart, bright	stupid, foolish, silly
cheerful, positive, optimistic	gloomy, negative, pessimistic
reliable, responsible	unreliable, irresponsible
brave, courageous	cowardly
humble, modest	arrogant, proud, big-headed
open-minded	narrow-minded
easy-going	strict, bossy
creative, imaginative	unimaginative
organised, tidy	disorganised, messy
sensible, mature	immature, childish
loyal	disloyal
ambitious, determined	unmotivated
talkative, chatty	quiet, reserved
thoughtful, considerate	thoughtless, inconsiderate

- "My sister is very **outgoing**. She loves meeting new people."
- "My boss is **strict** but **fair**."

The body

Head and face	Body	Arms and legs
head	neck	arm
hair	shoulder	elbow
face	chest	wrist
forehead	back	hand
eyebrow	stomach / belly	finger
eyelash	waist	thumb
eye	hip	nail
ear	bottom	palm
nose	skin	leg
cheek	heart	knee
mouth	lungs	ankle
lip	liver	foot / feet
tooth / teeth	kidney	toe
tongue	brain	heel
chin	blood	thigh
jaw	bone	calf
throat	muscle	

Feelings and emotions

Word	Example
happy / glad / pleased	I'm **glad** you came.
sad / unhappy / upset	She was **upset** about the news.
angry / annoyed / furious	He gets **annoyed** when people are late.
scared / afraid / frightened / terrified	I'm **afraid of** snakes.
worried / anxious / nervous	I'm **nervous** about my interview.
excited	The children are **excited** about the trip.
bored	I'm **bored**. Let's do something.

Word	Example
tired / exhausted	I'm **exhausted** after work.
surprised / shocked	I was **shocked** by the price.
embarrassed / ashamed	I was **embarrassed** when I fell.
jealous / envious	He's **jealous** of his brother.
proud	I'm **proud** of my daughter.
lonely	She feels **lonely** in the new city.
relaxed / calm	I feel **relaxed** on holiday.
confused	I'm **confused**. Can you explain again?
grateful / thankful	I'm **grateful** for your help.
disappointed	We were **disappointed** with the hotel.
homesick	I miss my family. I'm **homesick**.
hopeful	I'm **hopeful** about the future.
stressed	Exams make me **stressed**.

✎ Practice: Family words

1. My father's brother is my ___.

2. My aunt's son is my ___.

3. My sister's daughter is my ___.

4. My wife's mother is my ___.

5. My mother's mother is my ___.

6. My brother's son is my ___.

✎ Practice: Opposites

1. generous

2. hardworking

3. patient

4. polite

5. confident

6. honest

Topic Vocabulary 2: Home and Daily Life

Rooms and parts of a house

Word	Meaning / example
living room / sitting room / lounge	where you relax and watch TV
bedroom	where you sleep
kitchen	where you cook
dining room	where you eat
bathroom	with a shower or bath, sink, toilet
toilet / restroom (US) / washroom	"Where is the toilet, please?"
balcony	a small area outside a flat, on an upper floor
garden (UK) / yard (US)	land around a house
garage	where you keep a car
roof / ceiling / floor / wall	top outside / top inside / bottom / sides
stairs / upstairs / downstairs	"My room is **upstairs**."
ground floor / first floor	the floor at street level / the floor above it (UK)
hall / corridor	a long passage
flat (UK) / apartment (US)	a home on one floor of a building
landlord / tenant / rent	owner / person who pays / money paid each month

Furniture and things at home

Room	Things
Living room	sofa, armchair, coffee table, TV, carpet, rug, curtains, cushion, lamp, bookshelf, fan, air conditioner (AC)
Bedroom	bed, pillow, blanket, sheet, mattress, wardrobe / cupboard, chest of drawers, mirror, alarm clock
Kitchen	cooker / stove, oven, microwave, fridge, freezer, sink, tap, kettle, toaster, pan, pot, plate, bowl, cup, mug, glass, knife, fork, spoon, chopping board, dustbin

Room	Things
Bathroom	shower, bath, toilet, washbasin, towel, soap, shampoo, toothbrush, toothpaste, comb, razor, bucket
Other	door, window, light, switch, plug, socket, key, lock, broom, mop, washing machine, iron, vacuum cleaner

Household chores

Phrase	Example
do the cooking	My father **does the cooking** on Sundays.
do the washing-up / wash the dishes	I'll **do the washing-up** after dinner.
do the laundry / wash clothes	She **does the laundry** on Saturday.
do the ironing	I hate **doing the ironing**.
do the shopping / go grocery shopping	We **do the shopping** once a week.
clean the house / tidy up	Please **tidy up** your room.
make the bed	**Make your bed** every morning.
sweep / mop the floor	She **swept** the floor.
vacuum / hoover the carpet	
dust the furniture	
take out the rubbish / trash	Can you **take out the rubbish**?
water the plants	Don't forget to **water the plants**.
feed the pets	
lay / set the table	**Set the table** for dinner, please.
clear the table	
hang out the washing	

Daily routine verbs

Morning	Day	Evening
wake up	go to work / school	come back home
get up	start work	have dinner
turn off the alarm	have a meeting	watch TV
go to the toilet	have a break	relax
brush my teeth	have lunch	read
have a shower / take a bath	finish work	chat with family
shave	leave the office	go online / check social media
get dressed	pick up the kids	brush my teeth
comb my hair	go shopping	set the alarm
put on make-up	go to the gym	go to bed
have breakfast		fall asleep
leave home		
catch the bus		

✎ Practice: Write the room

1. You cook here.

2. You sleep here.

3. You have a shower here.

4. You keep your car here.

5. You relax and watch TV here.

✎ Practice: Make or do?

1. ___ the bed

2. ___ the cooking

3. ___ the washing-up

4. ___ the shopping

5. ___ the laundry

Topic Vocabulary 3: Food and Drink

Food groups

Group	Words
Fruit	apple, banana, mango, orange, grapes, watermelon, pineapple, papaya, guava, pomegranate, strawberry, lemon, lime, coconut, pear, peach, cherry, plum, kiwi, apricot, fig, dates
Vegetables	potato, tomato, onion, garlic, ginger, carrot, cabbage, cauliflower, spinach, peas, beans, cucumber, pumpkin, aubergine (UK) / eggplant (US), lady's finger / okra, capsicum / pepper, chilli, mushroom, lettuce, radish, beetroot, sweet corn, broccoli
Grains and staples	rice, wheat, flour, bread, pasta, noodles, oats, cereal, corn
Proteins	chicken, mutton, lamb, beef, pork, fish, prawns, eggs, lentils (dal), chickpeas, kidney beans, tofu, paneer (cottage cheese)
Dairy	milk, butter, cheese, yoghurt / curd, cream, ghee, ice cream
Spices and seasonings	salt, pepper, sugar, turmeric, cumin, coriander, cinnamon, cardamom, cloves, mustard seeds, chilli powder, oil, vinegar, sauce, ketchup
Snacks and sweets	biscuits / cookies, chips (UK: crisps), chocolate, cake, sweets (UK) / candy (US), nuts, popcorn, sandwich
Drinks	water, tea, coffee, juice, milk, soft drink / soda, lemonade, coconut water, milkshake, smoothie, beer, wine

Cooking verbs

Verb	Meaning
boil	cook in very hot water: boil eggs, boil rice
fry	cook in hot oil: fry onions
deep-fry	cook in a lot of oil: deep-fry samosas
bake	cook in an oven: bake bread, bake a cake
roast	cook in an oven or over fire: roast chicken
grill	cook over or under direct heat: grill fish
steam	cook with steam: steam vegetables, idli
stir	mix with a spoon
chop / cut / slice / dice	cut into pieces
peel	take the skin off: peel potatoes
grate	cut into small pieces with a grater: grate cheese
mix / blend	combine together
add	put in: add salt
pour	let liquid flow: pour milk
heat / warm up	make hot
melt	make solid into liquid: melt butter
season	add salt and spices
marinate	soak meat in spices before cooking
knead	press dough with your hands

Tastes and textures

Taste	Texture / other
sweet	crispy / crunchy
salty	soft
sour	hard
bitter	juicy
spicy / hot	creamy

Taste	Texture / other
mild	tender (meat)
bland (no taste)	tough (meat)
delicious / tasty	greasy / oily
disgusting / horrible	fresh / stale / rotten
savoury	raw / cooked / overcooked / undercooked

At the table

- "Could you **pass** the salt, please?"
- "This is **delicious**!"
- "Would you like **some more**?" – "Yes, please. Just a little." / "No, thank you. I'm **full**."
- "Help yourself!" (Take what you want.)
- "I'm **vegetarian**. I don't eat meat or fish." / "I'm **vegan**." / "I'm **allergic to** nuts."
- "Enjoy your meal!" / "Bon appétit!"
- meals: **breakfast** (morning), **brunch** (late morning), **lunch** (midday), **snack** (small food), **dinner / supper** (evening)

✎ Practice: How do you cook it?

1. You cook a cake in an oven. You ___ it.

2. You cook eggs in hot water. You ___ them.

3. You cook onions in a little hot oil. You ___ them.

4. You take the skin off a potato. You ___ it.

5. You cut bread into thin pieces. You ___ it.

✎ Practice: Describe the taste

1. Lemons are ___.

2. Chillies are ___.

3. Sugar is ___.

4. Coffee without sugar is ___.

5. Chips (crisps) are ___.

Topic Vocabulary 4: Clothes, Shopping and Money

Clothes and accessories

Clothes	Footwear	Accessories
shirt, T-shirt	shoes	watch
trousers (UK) / pants (US)	trainers / sneakers	belt
jeans	sandals	tie
shorts	slippers	wallet
skirt	boots	purse / handbag
dress	high heels	sunglasses
suit	flip-flops	glasses
jacket	socks	hat / cap
coat		scarf
sweater / jumper		gloves
hoodie		umbrella
kurta, saree, salwar kameez		jewellery: ring, earrings, necklace, bracelet, bangles
uniform		backpack
pyjamas		
underwear, vest, bra		

Clothes verbs

Verb	Example
wear	She's **wearing** a red dress.
put on	**Put on** your coat. It's cold.
take off	**Take off** your shoes, please.
try on	Can I **try on** this shirt?

Verb	Example
get dressed / get undressed	I **got dressed** quickly.
fit (right size)	These shoes don't **fit**. They're too small.
suit (look good on)	Blue **suits** you.
match / go with	Your bag **matches** your shoes.
change (clothes)	I need to **change** before dinner.

Describing clothes

tight, loose, long, short, comfortable, uncomfortable, fashionable, old-fashioned, casual, formal, smart, plain, striped, checked, spotted / polka-dot, patterned, cotton, silk, wool, leather, denim

Shops and places

Shop	What you buy
supermarket	food and household goods
grocery store / grocer's	everyday food
baker's / bakery	bread, cakes
butcher's	meat
chemist's (UK) / pharmacy / drugstore (US)	medicine
clothes shop / boutique	clothes
shoe shop	shoes
bookshop	books
stationery shop	pens, paper, notebooks
jeweller's	rings, necklaces
electronics shop	phones, laptops, TVs
hardware store	tools, paint
department store	many kinds of goods
shopping centre / mall	many shops in one building
market	stalls selling fruit, vegetables, etc.
florist's	flowers

Shop	What you buy
optician's	glasses

Shopping language

Phrase	When to use
How much is this? / How much does it cost?	asking the price
Do you have this in a smaller / bigger size?	sizes
Do you have it in blue?	colours
Can I try it on? Where are the changing rooms?	clothes
I'm just looking, thanks.	you don't need help
I'll take it.	you decide to buy
Can I pay by card? / Do you accept cash?	paying
Can I have a receipt, please?	proof of payment
Is there a discount? / Is it on sale?	lower price
Can I return / exchange it?	bring it back
It's too expensive. Do you have anything cheaper?	
Could I have a bag, please?	

Money words

Word	Meaning / example
cash / notes / coins	paper money and metal money
credit card / debit card	plastic cards to pay
price / cost	how much money
change	money you get back: "Here's your **change**."
receipt	paper showing what you paid
bill (UK) / check (US)	paper showing what you must pay in a restaurant
discount / sale / offer	lower price
refund	money given back
salary / wages / income	money you earn

Word	Meaning / example
save / spend / waste	keep / use / use badly
borrow / lend	take for a time / give for a time
owe	have to pay back: "I **owe** you 100 rupees."
afford	have enough money: "I can't **afford** a new car."
bargain	a very good price; also to discuss a price
budget	a plan for spending
loan / debt	borrowed money
account / balance	money in the bank
withdraw / deposit	take out / put in money
ATM / cash machine	machine for cash
tax / fee / fine	money to the government / for a service / for breaking a rule
expensive / cheap / reasonable / free	

✗ Can you borrow me your pen? ✓ Can you **lend** me your pen? / Can I **borrow** your pen?

✗ I spent a lot of money for clothes. ✓ I spent a lot of money **on** clothes.

✎ Practice: Borrow or lend?

1. Can I ___ your car tomorrow?

2. Could you ___ me 500 rupees?

3. I ___ a book from the library.

4. My brother never ___ me his things.

✎ Practice: Complete the shopping dialogue

1. "Can I help you?" – "No thanks, I'm just ___."

2. "Can I ___ it on?" – "Of course. The changing rooms are over there."

3. "How much ___ it cost?"

4. "It's perfect. I'll ___ it."

5. "Here's your ___ and your receipt."

Topic Vocabulary 5: Work, Jobs and the Office

Jobs

Job	What they do
doctor / physician	treats sick people
nurse	cares for patients
dentist	looks after teeth
surgeon	does operations
pharmacist	prepares and sells medicine
teacher / lecturer / professor	teaches
engineer	designs machines, buildings, software
software developer / programmer	writes computer programs
accountant	manages money records
lawyer / advocate	gives legal advice
judge	decides cases in court
police officer	keeps law and order
soldier	serves in the army
firefighter	puts out fires
pilot	flies planes
flight attendant	looks after passengers on a plane
driver / taxi driver	drives vehicles
mechanic	repairs cars
electrician	fixes electrical things
plumber	fixes water pipes
carpenter	works with wood
farmer	grows crops, keeps animals
chef / cook	prepares food

Job	What they do
waiter / waitress	serves food in a restaurant
shopkeeper / shop assistant / cashier	sells things / takes payment
receptionist	greets visitors and answers phones
secretary / assistant	helps with office work
manager	controls a team or business
businessman / businesswoman / entrepreneur	runs a business
salesperson	sells products
journalist / reporter	writes news
photographer	takes photos
designer	designs clothes, websites, etc.
architect	designs buildings
scientist	does research
tailor	makes clothes
barber / hairdresser	cuts hair
security guard	protects a building
delivery driver	brings parcels
cleaner	cleans buildings
civil servant	works for the government

- "What do you do?" / "What's your job?" – "I'm **a** nurse." / "I work **as an** accountant." / "I work **in** IT / marketing / sales." / "I work **for** a bank."

  ✗ I am engineer. ✓ I am **an** engineer.

  ✗ I work like a teacher. ✓ I work **as** a teacher.

The workplace

Word	Meaning
office / factory / shop / hospital / site	places of work
company / firm / organisation	a business
colleague / co-worker	someone you work with
boss / manager / supervisor	the person above you
employee / staff	people who work for a company
employer	the company or person who employs you
team / department	a group in a company: the HR department
client / customer	the person who buys services/goods
salary / pay / bonus / raise	money from work
promotion	moving to a higher position
deadline	the last time to finish something
meeting / conference / presentation	work events
report / email / document / file	work papers
full-time / part-time	about 40 hours / fewer hours per week
shift	a period of work: the night shift
overtime	extra hours
holiday / leave / day off / sick leave	time away from work
resign / quit / retire	leave a job / stop working because of age
hire / employ / recruit	give someone a job
fire / sack / dismiss	take a job away (for a bad reason)
be made redundant / laid off	lose a job because the company doesn't need you
unemployed / out of work	without a job
apply for a job / application	ask for a job
CV (UK) / résumé (US)	a document about your education and work
interview	a meeting to get a job
experience / skills / qualifications	what you know and can do

Word	Meaning
contract	a legal agreement
work from home / remote work	work outside the office

Useful work phrases

- I'm **in charge of** the sales team.
- I'm **responsible for** customer service.
- I **deal with** complaints.
- I **report to** the general manager.
- Can we **schedule** a meeting for Monday?
- I'll **get back to you** by Friday.
- Let me **check** and **confirm**.
- Could you **send me** the file, please?
- I'm **working on** a new project.
- We need to **meet the deadline**.
- I'm **on leave** next week.

✎ Practice: Who does this job?

1. This person repairs cars.

2. This person flies planes.

3. This person fixes water pipes.

4. This person cuts hair.

5. This person designs buildings.

6. This person writes news.

✎ Practice: Complete the sentences

1. I work ___ a teacher.

2. She works ___ a big bank.

3. He got a ___ and now he is a manager.

4. We must finish the project before the ___.

5. I'm ___ charge of ten people.

Topic Vocabulary 6: Health and the Doctor

Illnesses and symptoms

Word	Example
headache	I have a **headache**.
toothache / stomach ache / backache / earache	I have **a stomach ache**.
sore throat	My throat hurts. I have a **sore throat**.
cold	I have **a cold**. My nose is running.
cough	He has a bad **cough**.
fever / temperature	She has **a fever** / **a high temperature**.
flu	I've got **the flu**.
runny / blocked nose	
sneeze	Bless you! You **sneezed**.
feel sick / nauseous	I **feel sick**. I want to vomit.
vomit / throw up	
diarrhoea / constipation	stomach problems
dizzy	I feel **dizzy**. The room is spinning.
rash	red spots on the skin
itchy	My skin is **itchy**.
swollen	My ankle is **swollen**.
allergy / allergic	I'm **allergic** to dust.
infection	an **infection** in the ear
injury / injured / hurt	He **hurt** his back.
cut / bruise / burn	a cut on my finger, a blue bruise on my leg
broken bone / fracture	She **broke her arm**.
sprain	I **sprained** my ankle.
blood pressure	high / low blood pressure

Word	Example
diabetes	a disease with blood sugar
asthma	a breathing problem
pain / ache / hurt	My knee **hurts**. I have **pain** in my knee.
tired / weak / exhausted	

Saying what is wrong

- I don't feel well. / I feel unwell.
- My back **hurts**. / I have a pain in my back.
- I've had a fever **for two days**.
- It hurts **when I** walk.

✗ I have pain in head. ✓ I have a **headache**. / My head hurts.

✗ I am having fever. ✓ I have a fever.

At the doctor's

Doctor says	Patient says
What seems to be the problem?	I've had a headache since yesterday.
How long have you had it?	For about three days.
Where does it hurt?	Here, on the left side.
Do you have any allergies?	Yes, I'm allergic to penicillin.
Are you taking any medicine?	Just some painkillers.
Let me check your temperature.	
Take a deep breath.	
I'll give you a prescription.	How often should I take it?
Take two tablets three times a day after meals.	Are there any side effects?
Get plenty of rest and drink lots of water.	Thank you, doctor.

Health words

Word	Meaning
appointment	a time to see the doctor: "I'd like to make an **appointment**."
prescription	the doctor's paper for medicine
medicine / tablet / pill / capsule / syrup	
painkiller	medicine for pain
antibiotic	medicine for infections
injection / vaccine	medicine given with a needle
operation / surgery	
ambulance / emergency	
clinic / hospital / ward	
check-up	a general examination
X-ray / scan / blood test	
patient	the sick person
recover / get better	become healthy again: "Get well soon!"
healthy / unhealthy / fit	
diet / exercise / sleep	

✎ Practice: What's the matter?

1. My head hurts. I have a ___.

2. My throat hurts. I have a ___ throat.

3. My temperature is 39°C. I have a ___.

4. I can't stop sneezing and my nose is running. I have a ___.

5. The doctor gave me a ___ for antibiotics.

6. I want to see the doctor. I need to make an ___.

Topic Vocabulary 7: Travel, Transport and Places

Transport

Type	Words
Road	car, bus, taxi, auto-rickshaw, motorbike, scooter, bicycle / bike, lorry (UK) / truck, van, coach (long-distance bus)
Rail	train, metro / underground / subway, tram, platform, ticket office, carriage / coach
Air	plane / aeroplane / airplane, airport, flight, terminal, gate, boarding pass, check-in, luggage, baggage claim
Water	boat, ship, ferry, port, cruise

Transport verbs

Verb	Example
get on / get off	**Get on** the bus. **Get off** at the third stop.
get in / get out of	**Get in** the car. **Get out of** the taxi.
catch / take	I **catch** the 8:15 train. I **take** a taxi.
miss	Hurry or we'll **miss** the bus!
board	Passengers can now **board** the plane.
take off / land	The plane **took off** at 6 and **landed** at 9.
drive / ride	**drive** a car / **ride** a bike, a motorbike, a horse
park	Where can I **park**?
book / reserve	I **booked** a hotel room.
check in / check out	We **checked in** at 2 p.m.
commute	travel to work every day
pick someone up / drop someone off	I'll **pick you up** at the station.

At the airport

- "Where is the check-in desk for Air India?"
- "Can I see your **passport** and **ticket**, please?"
- "Do you have any **luggage** to check in?" – "Just one **suitcase**. This bag is **hand luggage**."
- "Window or **aisle** seat?"
- "Your flight leaves from **gate** 12. **Boarding** starts at 9:30."
- "The flight is **delayed** / **cancelled** / **on time**."
- **Departures** (leaving) / **Arrivals** (coming) / **customs** / **security** / **immigration** / **duty-free**

At the hotel

- "I have a **reservation** under the name Kapoor."
- "I'd like a **single** / **double** / **twin** room for two nights."
- "Is **breakfast included**?"
- "What time is **check-out**?"
- "Could I have a **wake-up call** at 6, please?"
- "The air conditioner in my room isn't working."
- "Could I have an extra **towel** / **pillow**, please?"
- "Can you **recommend** a good restaurant nearby?"

Places in a city

Places	
bank, post office, police station, hospital, pharmacy	
school, college, university, library, museum, art gallery	
park, playground, stadium, gym, swimming pool	
restaurant, café, hotel, cinema, theatre, shopping mall, market	
bus stop, bus station, railway station, airport, petrol station (UK) / gas station (US), car park (UK) / parking lot (US)	
temple, mosque, church, gurdwara	

Places	
bridge, square, street, road, lane, roundabout, traffic lights, crossroads / junction, pavement (UK) / sidewalk (US), zebra crossing	
factory, office building, skyscraper, apartment block	

Asking for and giving directions

Asking	Giving
Excuse me, how do I get to the station?	Go straight on / straight ahead.
Excuse me, where is the nearest bank?	Turn left / right at the traffic lights.
Is there a pharmacy near here?	Take the second turning on the left.
Is it far? / Can I walk there?	Go past the hospital.
How long does it take to walk?	It's on your left / right.
Could you show me on the map?	It's next to / opposite / behind the cinema.
	It's at the end of the road.
	Cross the road.
	It's about five minutes' walk.
	Go along this road until you reach the bridge.
	You can't miss it!

✎ Practice: Complete the travel sentences

1. Hurry up! We will ___ the train.

2. Please ___ off the bus at the next stop.

3. The plane ___ off at 10 a.m.

4. I'd like to ___ a room for two nights.

5. Do you want a window or an ___ seat?

6. Go ___ ahead and turn left at the traffic lights.

Topic Vocabulary 8: Nature, Weather and Animals

Weather

Noun	Adjective	Example
sun	sunny	It's **sunny** today.
rain	rainy	It's a **rainy** day. It's **raining**.
cloud	cloudy	The sky is **cloudy**.
wind	windy	It's very **windy**.
fog	foggy	It's **foggy** – drive carefully.
snow	snowy	It's **snowing**!
storm	stormy	There was a big **storm** last night.
ice	icy	The roads are **icy**.
humidity	humid	Mumbai is very **humid**.
heat	hot / boiling	It's **boiling** today!
cold	cold / freezing	It's **freezing** outside.
	warm / cool / mild	a **mild** winter
thunder / lightning		a **thunderstorm**
drizzle / shower / downpour		light rain / short rain / very heavy rain
flood / drought		too much water / no rain for a long time
cyclone / hurricane / tornado		very strong storms
temperature / degrees		It's 35 **degrees**.
forecast		What's the weather **forecast** for tomorrow?
rainbow / monsoon / breeze		

- "What's the weather like today?" – "It's hot and humid."
- "It's **pouring** with rain." (raining very heavily)

- "Collocations: **heavy** rain (not strong rain), **strong** wind, **thick** fog, **light** snow, **bright** sunshine"

  ✗ Today is very hot weather. ✓ It's very hot today. / The weather is very hot today.

Nature and landscape

mountain, hill, valley, river, lake, sea, ocean, beach, coast, island, desert, forest, jungle, field, waterfall, cave, volcano, earth, sky, star, moon, sun, planet, plant, tree, flower, grass, leaf / leaves, branch, root, seed, rock, stone, sand, soil, environment, pollution, climate change, global warming, recycle

Animals

Group	Animals
Pets / farm animals	dog, cat, puppy, kitten, cow, bull, buffalo, goat, sheep, pig, horse, donkey, camel, chicken / hen, cock / rooster, duck, rabbit
Wild animals	lion, tiger, elephant, monkey, bear, wolf, fox, deer, giraffe, zebra, rhino, hippo, leopard, cheetah, kangaroo, gorilla
Birds	parrot, crow, sparrow, pigeon, eagle, owl, peacock, swan, penguin
Water animals	fish, shark, whale, dolphin, crab, octopus, frog, turtle, crocodile
Insects and small animals	ant, bee, fly, mosquito, butterfly, spider, cockroach, snake, lizard, mouse / rat, worm, snail

Animal sounds

dogs **bark**, cats **meow** / **purr**, cows **moo**, lions **roar**, birds **sing** / **tweet**, bees **buzz**, snakes **hiss**, ducks **quack**

✎ Practice: Weather

1. There is a lot of water in the air and it's hot. It's ___.

2. You can't see far because of the ___.

3. Collocation: ___ rain (very much rain).

4. Many months with no rain = a ___.

5. "What's the weather ___ today?"

Topic Vocabulary 9: Education, Technology and Media

School and university

Word	Meaning
primary school / secondary school / high school	schools for different ages
college / university / institute	higher education
student / pupil	a person who studies
teacher / tutor / lecturer / professor / principal / head teacher	
subject	maths, science, history, geography, English, computer science, art, physical education (PE), economics, biology, chemistry, physics
classroom / lecture hall / library / laboratory (lab) / canteen / hostel	
timetable / schedule	when lessons happen
homework / assignment / project / essay	
exam / test / quiz / result / grade / marks	
pass / fail / revise (UK) / review	"I **passed** my exam!"
degree / diploma / certificate	
bachelor's / master's / PhD	university degrees
scholarship / fees	money to study / money you pay
semester / term	parts of the school year
graduate / graduation	finish university
enrol / admission	join a course
attend / attendance	go to class

- **take / sit** an exam (not "give an exam" – that's what the teacher does)
- **make** progress, **do** homework, **get** good marks, **study** for an exam

  ✗ I gave my exam yesterday. ✓ I **took** my exam yesterday. / I **wrote** my exam yesterday.

  ✗ I made my homework. ✓ I **did** my homework.

Technology

Word	Example
computer / laptop / tablet / smartphone	
screen / keyboard / mouse / charger / battery / headphones / earphones	
app / software / program / website / browser	
internet / Wi-Fi / online / offline	Is there **Wi-Fi** here?
download / upload	**Download** the app.
install / update	You need to **update** your phone.
log in / log out / sign up	**Log in** with your password.
password / username / account	
click / tap / scroll / swipe / type	**Tap** the icon.
search / google	I'll **search** for it online.
save / delete / copy / paste	
send / forward / reply / attach	**Attach** the file to the email.
charge (a phone)	My phone needs **charging**. The battery is dead / low.
turn on / switch on / turn off / restart	
crash / freeze / hang	My laptop **crashed**.
virus / hacker / security / privacy	
social media / post / share / like / comment / follow	
video call / message / text / voice note	Send me a **text**.

Media and entertainment

newspaper, magazine, news, article, headline, TV channel, programme / show, series, episode, film / movie, cinema, actor, actress, director, documentary, cartoon, comedy, drama, horror film, thriller, romance, science fiction, music, song, singer, band, concert, album, podcast, YouTube channel, influencer, advertisement / ad

✎ Practice: Choose the correct verb

1. I need to (do / make) my homework.

2. She (passed / succeeded) her driving test.

3. Please (attach / stick) the photo to the email.

4. I forgot my (password / passport) and can't log in.

5. My phone battery is low. I need to (charge / load) it.

6. I (took / gave) an English exam last week.

150 Essential Phrasal Verbs

What is a phrasal verb?

A phrasal verb = **verb + small word** (up, down, in, out, on, off, away, back...). Together they have a **new meaning**.

- "**give**" = hand something to someone. "**give up**" = stop trying.
- "**look**" = use your eyes. "**look after**" = take care of.

Native speakers use phrasal verbs **all the time**, especially in conversation. Learning them makes you sound natural.

Separable or not?

Some phrasal verbs can be separated by the object:

- **Turn off** the light. = **Turn** the light **off**. ✓
- With a pronoun, you **must** separate: **Turn it off**. ✓ (not "Turn off it")

Others cannot be separated: "**Look after** the baby." (not "Look the baby after")

Phrasal verbs A–G

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
ask out	invite on a date	He **asked** her **out** to dinner.
back up	support; make a copy	**Back up** your files. My friends **backed** me **up**.
blow up	explode; get very angry	The car **blew up**.
break down	stop working (machine); start crying	Our car **broke down** on the highway.
break in / into	enter by force	Thieves **broke into** our house.
break up	end a relationship	They **broke up** after two years.
bring up	raise a child; mention a topic	She was **brought up** by her grandmother. Don't **bring up** money.
call back	return a phone call	I'll **call** you **back** in five minutes.
call off	cancel	They **called off** the match because of rain.
calm down	become calm	**Calm down**! Everything is OK.
carry on	continue	**Carry on** – I'm listening.
catch up (with)	reach the same level	Walk faster – I can't **catch up with** you.
check in / out	register / leave (hotel, airport)	We **checked in** at noon.
cheer up	become happier	**Cheer up**! It's not so bad.
clean up	make clean and tidy	**Clean up** your room.
come across	find by chance	I **came across** an old photo.
come back	return	When will you **come back**?
come in	enter	**Come in** and sit down.
come on	hurry; encourage	**Come on**, we're late!
come up with	think of (an idea)	She **came up with** a great plan.
count on	rely on	You can **count on** me.
cut down (on)	reduce	I'm **cutting down on** sugar.
deal with	handle	I'll **deal with** the problem.
drop by / in	visit briefly	**Drop by** any time!

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
drop off	take someone to a place and leave	I'll **drop** you **off** at school.
drop out	leave school or a course	He **dropped out** of college.
eat out	eat in a restaurant	Let's **eat out** tonight.
end up	finally be in a situation	We **ended up** staying home.
fall apart	break into pieces	My old shoes are **falling apart**.
fall down	fall to the ground	The old man **fell down**.
figure out	understand, solve	I can't **figure out** this problem.
fill in / out	complete a form	Please **fill in** this form.
find out	discover information	I **found out** the truth.
get along / on (with)	have a good relationship	I **get on well with** my sister.
get away	escape	The thief **got away**.
get back	return	When did you **get back** from Goa?
get by	survive with little	I **get by** on a small salary.
get in / out (of)	enter / leave (car)	**Get in** the car.
get on / off	enter / leave (bus, train)	**Get off** at the next stop.
get over	recover from	She **got over** her cold.
get rid of	throw away, remove	I **got rid of** my old clothes.
get up	rise from bed	I **get up** at 6.
give away	give for free	She **gave away** her old books.
give back	return	**Give** me **back** my pen!
give in	stop fighting, agree	He finally **gave in** and said yes.
give up	stop trying / stop a habit	Don't **give up**! He **gave up** smoking.
go ahead	start, proceed	"Can I ask something?" – "**Go ahead**."
go away	leave	**Go away**! I'm busy.
go back	return	I want to **go back** to my village.
go off	ring (alarm); explode; go bad (food)	My alarm **went off** at 5. The milk has **gone off**.
go on	continue; happen	**Go on**, tell me. What's **going on**?

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
go out	leave home for fun	Let's **go out** tonight.
go over	review, check	Let's **go over** the plan again.
go through	experience (difficult)	She **went through** a hard time.
grow up	become an adult	I **grew up** in Kolkata.

Phrasal verbs H–P

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
hand in	give work to a teacher/boss	**Hand in** your homework on Friday.
hand out	distribute	The teacher **handed out** the papers.
hang on	wait a moment	**Hang on**, I'm coming!
hang out	spend time relaxing	We **hang out** at the mall.
hang up	end a phone call	She **hung up** on me!
hold on	wait (on the phone)	**Hold on**, please. I'll connect you.
hurry up	be quick	**Hurry up**! The bus is here.
keep on	continue	He **kept on** talking.
keep up (with)	stay at the same level	I can't **keep up with** the class.
kick off	start	The meeting **kicks off** at 9.
knock down	destroy a building; hit with a car	They **knocked down** the old school.
leave out	not include	Don't **leave out** any details.
let down	disappoint	Please don't **let** me **down**.
let in	allow to enter	**Let** the dog **in**.
lie down	rest flat	I need to **lie down**.
log in / out	enter / leave a computer account	**Log in** with your password.
look after	take care of	Can you **look after** my cat?
look for	try to find	I'm **looking for** my glasses.

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
look forward to	be happy about the future	I **look forward to** hearing from you.
look into	investigate	We'll **look into** the problem.
look out	be careful	**Look out**! A car!
look up	find in a dictionary/online	**Look up** the word.
look up to	respect, admire	I **look up to** my father.
make up	invent a story; become friends again	He **made up** an excuse. They argued and then **made up**.
make up for	compensate	I'll **make up for** being late.
mix up	confuse	I always **mix up** the twins.
move in / out	start / stop living in a place	We **moved in** last month.
move on	go forward, forget the past	It's time to **move on**.
nod off	fall asleep (not planned)	I **nodded off** during the film.
pass away	die (polite)	His grandfather **passed away** last year.
pass out	faint, lose consciousness	It was so hot that she **passed out**.
pay back	return money	I'll **pay** you **back** tomorrow.
pick out	choose	**Pick out** a dress you like.
pick up	lift; collect; learn easily	**Pick up** your toys. I'll **pick** you **up** at 5. I **picked up** some Spanish.
point out	show, mention	She **pointed out** my mistake.
put away	put in its place	**Put away** your books.
put off	postpone	Don't **put off** your homework.
put on	dress in; gain weight	**Put on** your shoes. I've **put on** weight.
put out	stop a fire	The firefighters **put out** the fire.

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
put up	build; let someone stay	They **put up** a tent. Can you **put** me **up** tonight?
put up with	tolerate	I can't **put up with** this noise.

Phrasal verbs R–Z

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
run away	escape	The dog **ran away**.
run into	meet by chance	I **ran into** my teacher at the mall.
run out (of)	have no more	We've **run out of** milk.
set off	start a journey	We **set off** at dawn.
set up	start (a business); arrange	She **set up** her own company.
settle down	start a calm life; relax	He got married and **settled down**.
show off	try to impress	He's always **showing off** his car.
show up	arrive, appear	He didn't **show up** for the meeting.
shut up	stop talking (rude!)	**Shut up**! (Be careful – this is rude.)
sign up	register	I **signed up** for a yoga class.
sit down	take a seat	Please **sit down**.
slow down	go slower	**Slow down**! You're driving too fast.
sort out	organise, solve	I need to **sort out** my papers.
speak up	talk louder	Could you **speak up**, please?
stand up	get on your feet	**Stand up** when the teacher comes in.
stand for	represent (letters)	"UN" **stands for** United Nations.
stay up	not go to bed	I **stayed up** until 2 a.m.
take after	look/act like a family member	She **takes after** her mother.
take back	return; withdraw words	I **take back** what I said.

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Example
take care of	look after	**Take care of** yourself.
take off	remove clothes; leave the ground	**Take off** your coat. The plane **took off**.
take over	take control	A big company **took over** our firm.
take up	start a hobby; use space/time	I **took up** painting. This sofa **takes up** too much space.
tell off	speak angrily to	My mum **told** me **off** for being late.
think over	consider carefully	**Think** it **over** and tell me tomorrow.
throw away / out	put in the rubbish	Don't **throw away** that box.
try on	test clothes	Can I **try on** these jeans?
try out	test	Let's **try out** the new app.
turn down	reduce volume; refuse	**Turn down** the music! She **turned down** the job.
turn into	become	The caterpillar **turned into** a butterfly.
turn off / on	stop / start (a machine)	**Turn off** the TV. **Turn on** the light.
turn up	increase volume; arrive	**Turn up** the radio. He **turned up** late.
wake up	stop sleeping	I **woke up** at 7.
warm up	prepare for exercise; heat	**Warm up** before running. **Warm up** the soup.
watch out	be careful	**Watch out**! The floor is wet.
wear out	become old and useless; make tired	My shoes are **worn out**. I'm **worn out**.
work out	exercise; solve; be successful	I **work out** at the gym. Things will **work out**.
write down	write on paper	**Write down** my number.

✎ Practice: Complete with the correct phrasal verb

1. Can you ___ my dog while I'm on holiday? (look after / look for)

2. Please ___ the TV. I'm trying to sleep. (turn off / turn up)

3. We've ___ sugar. Can you buy some? (run out of / run into)

4. Don't ___! You can do it! (give up / give in)

5. I ___ an old friend at the station yesterday. (ran into / ran away)

6. She ___ her mother. They both have curly hair. (takes after / takes off)

7. The meeting was ___ because the boss was sick. (called off / called back)

8. I need to ___ early tomorrow. (get up / get on)

9. Please ___ this form. (fill in / fill up)

10. I can't ___ this noise any more! (put up with / put off)

11. I'm ___ to seeing you next week. (looking forward / looking up)

12. They ___ after five years together. (broke up / broke down)

13. Can you ___ me ___ at the airport? (pick ... up / pick ... out)

14. I'll ___ this word in the dictionary. (look up / look into)

15. ___ ! There's a car coming! (Watch out / Work out)

100 Common Idioms and Expressions

What is an idiom?

An idiom is a group of words with a meaning that is different from the meaning of each word. "It's raining **cats and dogs**" does not mean animals are falling from the sky! It means it's raining very heavily. Learn idioms to understand native speakers – and use a few to sound natural.

Idiom	Meaning	Example
a piece of cake	very easy	The test was **a piece of cake**.
break the ice	start a conversation in a new group	He told a joke to **break the ice**.
hit the books	study hard	I need to **hit the books** tonight.
hit the sack / hit the hay	go to bed	I'm tired. I'm going to **hit the sack**.
under the weather	a little ill	I'm feeling **under the weather** today.
cost an arm and a leg	very expensive	That car **cost an arm and a leg**.
once in a blue moon	very rarely	I eat fast food **once in a blue moon**.
it's raining cats and dogs	raining very heavily	Take an umbrella – **it's raining cats and dogs**!
better late than never	it's good you did it, even if late	You came! **Better late than never**.
break a leg	good luck (to performers)	**Break a leg** in your show tonight!
call it a day	stop working for today	We're tired. Let's **call it a day**.
cut corners	do something badly to save time/money	Don't **cut corners** on safety.
get out of hand	become uncontrolled	The party **got out of hand**.
get the hang of	learn how to do	You'll soon **get the hang of** it.
hang in there	don't give up	**Hang in there**! It will get better.
in the same boat	in the same difficult situation	We're all **in the same boat**.
keep an eye on	watch carefully	**Keep an eye on** my bag, please.

Idiom	Meaning	Example
let the cat out of the bag	tell a secret by accident	Who **let the cat out of the bag**?
miss the boat	miss an opportunity	Book now or you'll **miss the boat**.
no pain, no gain	you must work hard to succeed	Exercise is hard, but **no pain, no gain**.
on cloud nine	very happy	She's **on cloud nine** after the wedding.
on the same page	agree, understand the same	Let's make sure we're **on the same page**.
over the moon	extremely happy	I was **over the moon** when I got the job.
pull someone's leg	joke, tease	Don't worry, I'm just **pulling your leg**.
see eye to eye	agree	We don't always **see eye to eye**.
sit on the fence	not choose a side	Stop **sitting on the fence** and decide!
speak of the devil	the person we're talking about appears	**Speak of the devil** – here's Ravi!
take it easy	relax	**Take it easy**. Don't work too hard.
the ball is in your court	it's your decision now	I made an offer. **The ball is in your court**.
the best of both worlds	all the advantages	Working from home gives me **the best of both worlds**.
time flies	time passes quickly	**Time flies** when you're having fun!
up in the air	not decided	Our plans are still **up in the air**.
when pigs fly	never	He'll clean his room **when pigs fly**.
bite off more than you can chew	try to do too much	Don't **bite off more than you can chew**.
burn the midnight oil	work late at night	I **burned the midnight oil** before the exam.
by the skin of your teeth	only just	I passed **by the skin of my teeth**.

Idiom	Meaning	Example
cry over spilt milk	be sad about something you can't change	**Don't cry over spilt milk**.
face the music	accept punishment	He has to **face the music** now.
feel blue	feel sad	I'm **feeling blue** today.
get cold feet	become nervous before an event	He **got cold feet** before the wedding.
give someone a hand	help	Can you **give me a hand** with this box?
go the extra mile	do more than expected	She always **goes the extra mile** for customers.
have a lot on my plate	be very busy	I **have a lot on my plate** this week.
hit the nail on the head	be exactly right	You **hit the nail on the head**!
in a nutshell	in a few words	**In a nutshell**, we need more money.
it's not rocket science	it's not difficult	Come on, **it's not rocket science**.
keep your chin up	stay positive	**Keep your chin up**. You'll find a job.
kill two birds with one stone	do two things at once	I **killed two birds with one stone**: I shopped and met my friend.
learn the ropes	learn how to do a job	It takes time to **learn the ropes**.
make ends meet	have just enough money	It's hard to **make ends meet** on this salary.
on the dot	exactly on time	Be here at 9 **on the dot**.
out of the blue	unexpectedly	He called me **out of the blue**.
play it by ear	decide as things happen	Let's **play it by ear**.
put all your eggs in one basket	risk everything on one thing	Don't **put all your eggs in one basket**.
ring a bell	sound familiar	That name **rings a bell**.
save for a rainy day	save money for the future	**Save** some money **for a rainy day**.
sleep on it	think about it overnight	I'll **sleep on it** and tell you tomorrow.
spill the beans	tell a secret	Come on, **spill the beans**!

Idiom	Meaning	Example
steal the show	be the best part	The little girl **stole the show**.
take a rain check	postpone an invitation	Can I **take a rain check** on dinner?
tie the knot	get married	They **tied the knot** in December.
through thick and thin	in good and bad times	They stayed together **through thick and thin**.
a blessing in disguise	something bad that becomes good	Losing that job was **a blessing in disguise**.
actions speak louder than words	what you do matters more than what you say	Don't promise – **actions speak louder than words**.
at the drop of a hat	immediately	She'd help you **at the drop of a hat**.
back to square one	start again	The plan failed. We're **back to square one**.
beat around the bush	avoid the main point	Stop **beating around the bush**!
every cloud has a silver lining	something good comes from bad	**Every cloud has a silver lining**.
get something off your chest	tell a worry	I need to **get this off my chest**.
go down in flames	fail badly	The project **went down in flames**.
head over heels	completely in love	He's **head over heels** in love.
in hot water	in trouble	He's **in hot water** with his boss.
jump to conclusions	decide too quickly	Don't **jump to conclusions**.
keep something under your hat	keep a secret	**Keep it under your hat**.
know something like the back of your hand	know very well	I **know** this city **like the back of my hand**.
let sleeping dogs lie	don't disturb an old problem	**Let sleeping dogs lie**.
make a long story short	tell the main point	**To make a long story short**, we got married.
on the tip of my tongue	almost remember	His name is **on the tip of my tongue**.
out of order	not working	The lift is **out of order**.

Idiom	Meaning	Example
practice makes perfect	doing it often makes you good	Keep speaking – **practice makes perfect**!
Rome wasn't built in a day	big things take time	Be patient. **Rome wasn't built in a day**.
the last straw	the final problem that makes you angry	Being late again was **the last straw**.
throw in the towel	give up	Don't **throw in the towel** yet.
twist someone's arm	persuade	OK, you **twisted my arm** – I'll come.
under pressure	stressed by demands	I work well **under pressure**.
a dime a dozen	very common	Cheap phones are **a dime a dozen**.
add fuel to the fire	make a bad situation worse	Don't **add fuel to the fire**.
all ears	listening carefully	Tell me – I'm **all ears**.
bend over backwards	try very hard to help	They **bent over backwards** to help us.
cool as a cucumber	very calm	She was **cool as a cucumber** in the interview.
down to earth	practical and humble	Despite being famous, he's very **down to earth**.
easier said than done	difficult to actually do	Stop worrying? **Easier said than done**.
fish out of water	uncomfortable in a new place	I felt like a **fish out of water** at the party.
get your act together	organise yourself	You need to **get your act together**.
have second thoughts	doubt a decision	I'm **having second thoughts** about the trip.
keep in touch	stay in contact	Let's **keep in touch**!
lose your temper	become very angry	He **lost his temper** and shouted.
a bad apple	a bad person in a good group	One **bad apple** can spoil the team.
up to you	your decision	"Pizza or pasta?" – "It's **up to you**."
word of mouth	people telling other people	The restaurant became famous by **word of mouth**.

Idiom	Meaning	Example
you can say that again	I completely agree	"It's hot!" – "**You can say that again!**"

✎ Practice: Match the idiom to its meaning

1. a piece of cake

2. under the weather

3. over the moon

4. cost an arm and a leg

5. once in a blue moon

6. hit the sack

7. break the ice

8. call it a day

9. out of the blue

10. keep an eye on

Collocations: Words That Go Together

What are collocations?

Collocations are words that **naturally go together**. A native speaker says "**make** a mistake", not "**do** a mistake". There is no logical rule – you just need to learn them. Using correct collocations makes your English sound **natural**.

Make or do?

Make = create, produce something. **Do** = actions, work, tasks.

MAKE	DO
make a mistake	do homework
make a decision	do the housework
make a plan	do the shopping
make money	do business
make a phone call	do your best
make friends	do exercise
make noise	do the dishes
make a mess	do a favour
make an effort	do a job / do work
make progress	do research
make a promise	do damage
make a suggestion	do the laundry
make a complaint	do an exam (UK)
make an excuse	do well / badly
make a choice	do nothing
make breakfast / dinner	do your hair
make the bed	do a course
make a difference	do someone good
make sure	do the cooking

MAKE	DO
make a speech	do yoga

✗ I did a mistake. ✓ I **made** a mistake.

✗ Can you make me a favour? ✓ Can you **do** me a favour?

✗ I make my homework. ✓ I **do** my homework.

Take, have, get, give

TAKE	HAVE	GET	GIVE
take a photo	have breakfast	get a job	give advice
take a shower	have a party	get married	give a speech
take a break	have fun	get lost	give a hand
take a seat	have a look	get ready	give a call
take a taxi / bus	have a problem	get better	give permission
take an exam	have an idea	get angry	give a presentation
take medicine	have a baby	get home	give birth
take notes	have time	get a message	give a discount
take care	have a rest	get tired	give a smile
take a risk	have a conversation	get permission	give an example
take time	have a headache	get the point	give an opinion
take place (happen)	have an argument	get dressed	give a reason
take part (in)	have a good time	get rid of	give up
take responsibility	have a drink	get started	give a lift
take advantage of	have a bath	get worse	give a hug

Other important collocations

Collocation	Example
pay attention	Please **pay attention** in class.
pay a visit	Let's **pay a visit** to grandma.
pay a compliment	He **paid** me a nice **compliment**.
catch a cold	I **caught a cold** in the rain.
catch a bus / train	
keep a secret / promise	Can you **keep a secret**?
keep calm / quiet	**Keep calm** and carry on.
save time / money / energy	Taking the metro **saves time**.
waste time / money	Don't **waste time**.
spend time / money	I **spend** a lot of **time** online.
tell the truth / a lie / a story / a joke	Always **tell the truth**.
say hello / goodbye / sorry / thank you	**Say sorry** to your sister.
break the law / a promise / a record	He **broke his promise**.
come to a decision / an end	The meeting **came to an end**.
go online / abroad / missing / crazy / bad	The milk **went bad**.
heavy rain / traffic / smoker	There's **heavy traffic** today.
strong coffee / wind / opinion	I like **strong coffee**.
fast food / asleep (fast asleep)	The baby is **fast asleep**.
deep sleep / breath / water	Take a **deep breath**.
high price / temperature / speed	
best friend / close friend / old friend	She's my **close friend**.
a big mistake / a big decision	
a great idea / time / success	
bitterly cold / highly recommended / deeply sorry	This film is **highly recommended**.
fully aware / completely different / totally agree	I **totally agree**.

✎ Practice: Make or do?

1. ___ a mistake
2. ___ homework
3. ___ a decision
4. ___ exercise
5. ___ money
6. ___ me a favour
7. ___ the shopping
8. ___ a phone call
9. ___ your best
10. ___ friends

✎ Practice: Take, have, get or give?

1. ___ a photo
2. ___ breakfast
3. ___ married
4. ___ advice
5. ___ a shower
6. ___ fun
7. ___ lost
8. ___ a speech
9. ___ a break
10. ___ an idea

Confusing Words

Words that learners often mix up

Words	Difference	Example
say / tell	say something; tell someone something	She **said** hello. She **told** me a story.
speak / talk	speak = more formal, languages; talk = conversation	I **speak** Hindi. We **talked** for hours.
see / look / watch	see = notice; look = direct your eyes; watch = look for a time at moving things	I **saw** a bird. **Look** at this! I **watch** TV.
hear / listen	hear = sounds come to you; listen = pay attention	I **heard** a noise. **Listen** to me!
borrow / lend	borrow = take; lend = give	Can I **borrow** your pen? Can you **lend** me your pen?
bring / take	bring = to here; take = to there	**Bring** your book tomorrow. **Take** this to your mother.
come / go	come = towards the speaker; go = away	**Come** here! **Go** to your room!
remember / remind	remember = not forget; remind = make someone remember	I **remember** her name. **Remind** me to call him.
learn / teach	learn = get knowledge; teach = give knowledge	I'm **learning** English. She **teaches** maths.
win / earn / gain	win a prize/game; earn money from work; gain weight/experience	We **won** the match. He **earns** a good salary.
lose / loose	lose = verb (not have); loose = adjective (not tight)	Don't **lose** your keys. These trousers are **loose**.
rob / steal	rob a person/place; steal a thing	They **robbed** a bank. They **stole** money.
fun / funny	fun = enjoyable; funny = makes you laugh	The party was **fun**. The joke was **funny**.
affect / effect	affect = verb; effect = noun	Smoking **affects** your health. It has a bad **effect**.
advice / advise	advice = noun; advise = verb	Good **advice**. I **advise** you to rest.

Words	Difference	Example
accept / except	accept = agree to take; except = not including	I **accept** your offer. Everyone came **except** Ali.
then / than	then = time; than = comparison	First eat, **then** sleep. She's taller **than** me.
quite / quiet	quite = fairly; quiet = not noisy	It's **quite** good. Please be **quiet**.
live / life	live = verb; life = noun	I **live** here. **Life** is beautiful.
sometime / sometimes	sometime = one day; sometimes = occasionally	Let's meet **sometime**. I **sometimes** walk.
every day / everyday	every day = each day; everyday = normal (adjective)	I run **every day**. **everyday** clothes
among / between	between = two; among = more than two	**between** you and me / **among** friends
ago / before	ago = from now; before = from a past time	two years **ago** / I had been there two years **before**
alone / lonely	alone = without others; lonely = sad because alone	I live **alone**, but I'm not **lonely**.
actually / currently	actually = in fact; currently = now	**Actually**, I'm 30. I'm **currently** working in Pune.
control / check	control = have power over; check = examine	**Check** your answers. (not "control your answers")
sensible / sensitive	sensible = wise; sensitive = easily hurt / feels a lot	a **sensible** decision / **sensitive** skin
embarrassed / pregnant	embarrassed = shy, ashamed (be careful – some languages have a false friend!)	I was **embarrassed** when I fell.
economic / economical	economic = about the economy; economical = saves money	**economic** growth / an **economical** car
historic / historical	historic = important in history; historical = about history	a **historic** day / a **historical** film
shade / shadow	shade = cool area out of the sun; shadow = dark shape	sit in the **shade** / my **shadow** on the wall
job / work	job = countable (a job); work = uncountable	I have **a job**. I have a lot of **work**.

Words	Difference	Example
travel / trip / journey	travel = general (uncountable/verb); trip = a short visit; journey = going from A to B	I love **travel**. a **trip** to Goa / a long **journey**
hard / hardly	hard = with effort; hardly = almost not	Work **hard**. I **hardly** slept.
late / lately	late = not on time; lately = recently	I was **late**. I've been busy **lately**.
as / like	as = in the role of; like = similar to	He works **as** a chef. He cooks **like** a chef.

✎ Practice: Choose the correct word

1. Can you (say / tell) me your name?

2. I (heard / listened) a strange noise.

3. Please (bring / take) this letter to the post office.

4. I (lost / loosed) my wallet.

5. She is taller (then / than) me.

6. They (robbed / stole) my phone.

7. The film was very (fun / funny). I laughed a lot.

8. Can you (remember / remind) me to buy bread?

9. He (earns / wins) 50,000 rupees a month.

10. Please be (quite / quiet). The baby is sleeping.

11. Please (check / control) your work before you hand it in.

12. I live (alone / lonely) but I have many friends.

100 Common Mistakes and How to Fix Them

Read each pair. Say the correct sentence out loud three times. If you make one of these mistakes, write it in the "Mistakes" section of your notebook.

Grammar mistakes

✗ He don't like it. ✓ He **doesn't** like it.
✗ She go to school. ✓ She **goes** to school.
✗ I am agree. ✓ I agree.
✗ I have 20 years. ✓ I **am** 20 years old.
✗ I am living here since 2015. ✓ I **have been** living here since 2015.
✗ I didn't went. ✓ I didn't **go**.
✗ Did you saw it? ✓ Did you **see** it?
✗ I am knowing him. ✓ I **know** him.
✗ He is more taller. ✓ He is **taller**.
✗ She is more better now. ✓ She is **better** now.
✗ Where you are going? ✓ Where **are you** going?
✗ What means this word? ✓ What **does** this word **mean**?
✗ I can to swim. ✓ I can swim.
✗ I must to go. ✓ I must go.
✗ If I will see him, I will tell him. ✓ If I **see** him, I will tell him.
✗ I have seen him yesterday. ✓ I **saw** him yesterday.
✗ I born in 1990. ✓ I **was born** in 1990.
✗ Everybody are happy. ✓ Everybody **is** happy.
✗ One of my friend is a doctor. ✓ One of my **friends** is a doctor.
✗ I enjoy to cook. ✓ I enjoy **cooking**.
✗ I look forward to meet you. ✓ I look forward to **meeting** you.
✗ I want that you come. ✓ I want **you to** come.
✗ He let me to go. ✓ He let me **go**.
✗ She explained me the problem. ✓ She explained the problem **to me**.

✗ He said me hello. ✓ He **said** hello **to me**.

✗ Can you tell me where is the bank? ✓ Can you tell me where **the bank is**?

✗ I don't know nothing. ✓ I don't know **anything**.

✗ Although it was late, but we stayed. ✓ Although it was late, we stayed.

✗ I have a good news. ✓ I have **some** good news.

✗ The informations are correct. ✓ The **information is** correct.

Vocabulary mistakes

✗ I did a mistake. ✓ I **made** a mistake.

✗ Open the light. ✓ **Turn on** the light.

✗ Close the TV. ✓ **Turn off** the TV.

✗ I will learn you English. ✓ I will **teach** you English.

✗ Borrow me your pen. ✓ **Lend** me your pen.

✗ He is my cousin brother. ✓ He is my cousin.

✗ What is your good name? ✓ What is your name?

✗ My mobile is not working, its battery is down. ✓ My phone isn't working. Its battery is **dead / flat**.

✗ I'm coming from Mumbai. (meaning: Mumbai is my home) ✓ I **come from** Mumbai. / I'm **from** Mumbai.

✗ I am having two sisters. ✓ I **have** two sisters.

✗ The prices are very expensive. ✓ The prices are very **high**. / The things are very expensive.

✗ I'm feeling boring. ✓ I'm feeling **bored**.

✗ Pass me the salt. (sounds rude) ✓ Could you pass me the salt, **please**?

✗ I passed out from college in 2020. ✓ I **graduated** from college in 2020. ("pass out" = faint!)

✗ Please do the needful. ✓ Please do what is necessary. / Please could you help with this?

✗ Revert back to me. ✓ **Reply** to me. / Get back to me.

✗ I'll discuss about it. ✓ I'll discuss it.

✗ We reached to the station. ✓ We reached the station. / We arrived at the station.

✗ Where is the toilet? (direct but OK) ✓ Excuse me, where is the toilet, please?

✗ He is a very rich and wealthy man. ✓ He is a very rich man.

✗ Return back the book. ✓ Return the book.

✗ I wear my clothes in the morning. ✓ I **get dressed** / **put on** my clothes in the morning.

✗ Make a photo. ✓ **Take** a photo.

✗ Give an exam. (as a student) ✓ **Take** an exam.

✗ Do a party. ✓ **Have** a party.

✗ Say me. ✓ **Tell** me.

✗ Explain me. ✓ Explain **to me**.

✗ She is married with a doctor. ✓ She is married **to** a doctor.

✗ I am interested about music. ✓ I am interested **in** music.

✗ It depends of the weather. ✓ It depends **on** the weather.

✗ I'm good in English. ✓ I'm good **at** English.

✗ Different than / Different to (UK OK) ✓ Different **from** (safest)

✗ Congratulations for your exam. ✓ Congratulations **on** your exam.

✗ I prefer tea than coffee. ✓ I prefer tea **to** coffee.

✗ On the night ✓ **At** night

✗ In the weekend ✓ **At** the weekend (UK) / **On** the weekend (US)

✗ Arrive to ✓ Arrive **at** / **in**

✗ Go to home ✓ Go home

✗ Enter in the room ✓ Enter the room

✗ Wait me ✓ Wait **for** me

✗ Listen music ✓ Listen **to** music

✗ Married with ✓ Married **to**

✗ Afraid from ✓ Afraid **of**

Pronunciation and spelling mistakes

✗ I am vary happy. ✓ I am **very** happy.

✗ I recieved your email. ✓ I **received** your email. ("i before e, except after c")

✗ Untill ✓ **Until**

✗ Tommorow ✓ **Tomorrow**

✗ Accomodation ✓ **Accommodation**

✗ Begining ✓ **Beginning**

✗ Beleive ✓ **Believe**

✗ Definately ✓ **Definitely**

✗ Wich ✓ **Which**

✗ Thier ✓ **Their**

✗ Becuase ✓ **Because**

✗ Freind ✓ **Friend**

✗ Goverment ✓ **Government**

✗ Neccessary ✓ **Necessary**

✗ Wensday ✓ **Wednesday**

✗ Februray ✓ **February**

✗ Buisness ✓ **Business**

✗ Truely ✓ **Truly**

✗ Alot ✓ **A lot** (two words)

✗ Your welcome ✓ **You're** welcome

Politeness mistakes

✗ Give me water. ✓ **Could I have** some water, please?

✗ I want the bill. ✓ **Could we have** the bill, please?

✗ What? (when you didn't hear) ✓ **Sorry? / Pardon? / Could you say that again, please?**

✗ Tell me your name. ✓ **May I have / Could I have** your name, please?

✗ You are wrong. ✓ **I'm not sure that's right.** / **I see it differently.**

✗ Come here. (to a stranger) ✓ **Excuse me, could you come here for a moment, please?**

✗ I don't understand you. (rude tone) ✓ **Sorry, I didn't quite understand. Could you explain?**

Tip: In English, "please", "thank you", "sorry" and "excuse me" are used **much more** than in many other languages. Use them all the time! Questions ("Could you...?") are more polite than orders ("Do this.").

Part 6: Speaking and Conversation

Real English for real life

Greetings, Introductions and Goodbyes

Saying hello

Formal	Informal
Good morning. (until 12)	Hi!
Good afternoon. (12–5 p.m.)	Hello!
Good evening. (after 5 p.m.)	Hey! (very informal)
How do you do? (very formal, first meeting)	Hi there!
Pleased to meet you. / Nice to meet you.	Good to see you!
It's a pleasure to meet you.	Long time no see! (haven't seen you for a long time)

> **Tip:** "Good night" is **not** a greeting. It means goodbye, at night or before sleeping.

How are you? – and how to answer

Question	Answers
How are you?	I'm fine, thanks. And you?
How are you doing?	I'm good / great / very well, thank you.
How's it going?	Not bad. / Pretty good. / Can't complain.
How have you been?	I've been busy, but good.
What's up? (informal)	Not much. / Nothing much. You?
How's everything?	Everything's fine.
How's work? / How's your family?	It's going well. / They're all well, thanks.

If you're not fine: "Not so good, actually. I've got a cold." / "I'm a bit tired today."

> **Tip:** "How are you?" is often just a greeting. People expect a short, positive answer and then "And you?" Always ask back!

Introducing yourself

- Hi, I'm Rohan. / My name is Rohan Mehta.
- I'm from Jaipur, in Rajasthan.
- I live in Bangalore now.
- I'm 26 years old.
- I work as a software engineer. / I'm a student. I'm studying commerce.
- I work for an IT company.
- I'm married with two kids. / I'm single.
- In my free time, I like reading and playing badminton.
- I'm learning English because I want to work abroad.

A full example

"Hello everyone. My name is Fatima and I'm 24. I'm from Hyderabad, but I live in Pune now because of my job. I work as a nurse in a big hospital. I live with my sister. In my free time, I love cooking and watching films. I'm learning English because I want to improve my career and travel to new countries. Nice to meet you all!"

Introducing other people

- This is my friend, Ali.
- I'd like you to meet my colleague, Ms Sharma.
- Let me introduce you to my boss, Mr Das.
- Have you met my sister, Neha?

Reply: "Nice to meet you." / "Pleased to meet you." / "Hi, Ali. Good to meet you."

Asking about someone

Question	Example answer
What's your name?	I'm Kiran.
Where are you from?	I'm from Nepal.
Where do you live?	I live in Kathmandu.
What do you do?	I'm an accountant.
Where do you work?	At a bank in the city centre.
How old are you? (careful – can be personal)	I'm 30.
Are you married? (personal)	Yes, I am. / No, I'm single.
Do you have any children?	Yes, a son and a daughter.
What do you do in your free time?	I play guitar.
How long have you lived here?	For about three years.
Why are you learning English?	For my job.

Tip: In many English-speaking cultures, questions about **age, salary, weight, religion and politics** can be personal. Be careful with them when you first meet someone.

Saying goodbye

Formal	Informal
Goodbye.	Bye! / Bye-bye!
It was nice meeting you.	See you! / See you later!
Have a nice day.	See you soon! / See you tomorrow!
I look forward to seeing you again.	Take care!
Good night. (at night)	Catch you later!
	Talk to you soon.

Ending a conversation politely

- "Well, it was great talking to you, but I have to go now."
- "Sorry, I need to leave. I have a meeting."
- "Let's keep in touch!"
- "Say hello to your family for me."

✎ Practice: Complete the conversation

1. A: Hi, I'm Sam. B: Hi Sam, I'm Mina. Nice to ___ you.

2. A: How ___ you? B: I'm fine, thanks. And you?

3. A: Where are you ___? B: I'm from Sri Lanka.

4. A: What do you ___? B: I'm a teacher.

5. A: Bye! B: See you ___!

6. A: This is my friend Raj. B: ___ to meet you, Raj.

Small Talk: Easy Conversation Topics

What is small talk?

Small talk is short, friendly conversation about easy topics. People use it with neighbours, colleagues, people at parties, taxi drivers – anyone! Good small talk helps you make friends and feel confident.

Safe topics

- the weather
- the weekend / holidays
- work or studies (in general)
- food and restaurants
- films, TV series, music, sports
- travel
- the place you are in (the party, the event, the city)

Topics to avoid with new people

- salary and money
- religion and politics
- age and weight
- very personal problems

Useful small talk questions

Topic	Questions
Weather	Lovely day, isn't it? / It's so hot today! / Do you think it'll rain?
Weekend	Did you have a good weekend? / Any plans for the weekend? / What did you get up to?
Work	How's work going? / Have you been busy? / How long have you worked here?
Free time	What do you like doing in your free time? / Do you play any sports?
Food	Have you tried the new restaurant? / What's your favourite food?
Films / TV	Have you seen any good films recently? / Are you watching anything good?

Topic	Questions
Travel	Have you been on holiday this year? / Where would you love to travel?
Place	How do you know the host? / Is this your first time here? / How long have you lived in this city?

How to keep the conversation going

1. Ask follow-up questions

A: "I went to Goa last weekend."

B: "Oh, nice! **Who did you go with?** / **How was it?** / **What did you do there?**"

2. Don't answer only "yes" or "no" – add information

A: "Do you like your job?"

✗ "Yes."

✓ "Yes, I do. It's busy, but my colleagues are great. What about you?"

3. Show interest

Phrase	When
Really? / Oh, really?	surprise, interest
That's interesting!	
Wow! / That's amazing!	
Oh, I see. / I see what you mean.	understanding
That sounds great / fun / lovely.	positive news
Oh no! / That's terrible! / I'm sorry to hear that.	bad news
Lucky you!	someone has something good
Me too! / Same here!	you agree
Good for you!	someone did something good
No way!	very surprised (informal)

4. Ask "What about you?" / "How about you?"

Always give the other person a chance to talk.

5. Use "fillers" to give yourself time to think

Native speakers use small words while they think. It's normal and natural!

- Well, ...
- Um... / Er...
- Let me think...
- Let me see...
- You know, ...
- I mean, ...
- Actually, ...
- That's a good question.
- How can I say this?
- What's the word...?
- Kind of / sort of ...

Example small talk conversation

A: Hi! Lovely weather today, isn't it?

B: Yes, it's beautiful. Finally, no rain!

A: I know! The monsoon was so long this year. Did you do anything fun at the weekend?

B: Not much, actually. I just relaxed at home and watched a series. How about you?

A: I went hiking with some friends near Lonavala.

B: Oh, really? That sounds amazing. How was it?

A: It was great, but very tiring! We walked for six hours.

B: Wow! I'd love to try that. Do you go hiking often?

A: About once a month. You should come with us next time!

B: I'd love to. Thanks!

✎ Practice: Choose the best response

1. "I got a new job!" – (a) "Good for you! Congratulations!" (b) "Oh no!"
2. "My cat died last week." – (a) "Lucky you!" (b) "Oh, I'm so sorry to hear that."
3. "I love Italian food." – (a) "Me too! Have you tried the new pizza place?" (b) "Yes."
4. "Did you have a good weekend?" – (a) "Yes." (b) "Yes, it was really relaxing. I visited my parents. And you?"

Everyday Functions: Phrases You Need Every Day

Thanking and responding

Thanking	Responding
Thanks. / Thank you.	You're welcome.
Thanks a lot. / Thank you very much.	No problem. / No worries.
Thank you so much for your help.	My pleasure. / Don't mention it.
I really appreciate it.	Not at all. / Anytime!
That's very kind of you.	Glad I could help.
Cheers! (UK, informal)	

Apologising and responding

Apologising	Responding
Sorry.	That's OK. / No problem.
I'm (so / really) sorry.	Don't worry about it.
I'm sorry I'm late.	It doesn't matter.
I apologise for the mistake. (formal)	Never mind.
Excuse me. (before interrupting or passing someone)	That's all right.
Pardon me. / Sorry? (didn't hear)	Apology accepted.
My fault. / My bad. (informal)	It's fine. Forget it.
I didn't mean to.	

Tip: Use "**Excuse me**" **before** you disturb someone ("Excuse me, can I ask you something?"). Use "**Sorry**" **after** you make a mistake ("Sorry, I stepped on your foot!").

Making requests

More polite ↑	
Would you mind opening the window?	(answer "No, not at all" = yes I'll do it!)
Could you possibly help me?	
Could you help me, please?	
Can you help me?	
Help me, please.	(less polite)

Asking for permission:

- **Can I** use your phone?
- **Could I** sit here?
- **May I** come in? (formal)
- **Do you mind if I** open the window?
- **Is it OK if I** leave early today?

Answers: "Sure." / "Of course." / "Go ahead." / "No problem." / "I'm afraid not." / "Sorry, you can't."

Offering and responding

Offering	Accepting	Refusing
Would you like some tea?	Yes, please. / I'd love some.	No, thank you. / I'm fine, thanks.
Can I help you?	That would be great, thanks.	No, it's OK, thanks.
Shall I carry your bag?	That's very kind of you.	Don't worry, I can manage.
Let me get that for you.	Thanks a lot!	It's all right, thank you.
How about some cake?	Sounds good!	Not for me, thanks.

Invitations

Inviting	Accepting	Refusing politely
Would you like to come to my party?	I'd love to!	I'd love to, but I'm busy.
Do you want to go for a coffee?	Sure, why not?	Sorry, I can't. Maybe next time?
Are you free on Saturday?	Yes, I am. What's the plan?	I'm afraid I have other plans.
How about dinner tonight?	That sounds great!	Thanks for asking, but I can't tonight.
Let's go to the cinema!	Good idea!	Can I take a rain check?

Tip: When you say no to an invitation, always give a reason and say thank you. Just "No" sounds rude in English.

Suggestions

- **Let's** go to the beach.
- **Why don't we** order pizza?
- **How about** watching a film?
- **What about** going for a walk?
- **Shall we** start?
- **We could** take a taxi.
- **Maybe we should** leave now.
- **If I were you, I'd** take the job.

Giving opinions

Giving an opinion	Asking for an opinion
I think...	What do you think?
In my opinion, ...	What's your opinion?
I believe...	How do you feel about...?
Personally, I feel...	What's your view on...?

Giving an opinion	Asking for an opinion
If you ask me, ...	Do you agree?
As far as I'm concerned, ...	
It seems to me that...	
I'm sure that... / I'm not sure, but...	

Agreeing and disagreeing

Agreeing	Partly agreeing	Disagreeing (politely)
I agree.	Maybe, but...	I'm not sure about that.
Exactly! / Absolutely!	That's true, but...	I see your point, but...
You're right.	I agree up to a point.	I don't really agree.
That's a good point.	Yes, but on the other hand...	I'm afraid I disagree.
I think so too.	I see what you mean, but...	I see it differently.
Definitely.	It depends.	Actually, I think...
Me too. / Same here.		Really? I think...

✗ I am agree with you. ✓ I agree with you.

✗ I am not agree. ✓ I **don't** agree. / I disagree.

Checking understanding and asking for repetition

These phrases are your best friends when you are learning! Use them without fear.

When you don't understand	
Sorry, could you say that again?	
Could you repeat that, please?	
Could you speak more slowly, please?	
Sorry, I didn't catch that.	
What does "___" mean?	
How do you spell that?	
How do you say "___" in English?	

When you don't understand	
What do you mean by "___"?	
Sorry, I'm not sure I understand.	
Do you mean...?	
So, you're saying that...?	
Checking the other person understands you	
Does that make sense?	
Do you know what I mean?	
Is that clear?	
Are you with me?	

Expressing likes and dislikes

Love (++)	Like (+)	Neutral	Dislike (–)	Hate (– –)
I love...	I like...	I don't mind...	I don't like...	I hate...
I'm crazy about...	I'm into...	It's OK.	I'm not keen on...	I can't stand...
I adore...	I enjoy...		I'm not a big fan of...	I really dislike...
...is my favourite.	I'm fond of...			...drives me crazy.

- "I'**m really into** photography."
- "I **can't stand** waiting in queues."
- "I'**m not a big fan of** horror films."

Talking about ability

- I can swim well. / I can't drive.
- I'm good at maths. / I'm not very good at singing.
- I'm quite good at cooking.
- I'm terrible at remembering names!
- I know how to use Excel.
- I've never learned to swim.

Expressing feelings and reactions

Situation	Phrases
Good news	That's great! / Congratulations! / I'm so happy for you! / Well done!
Bad news	I'm sorry to hear that. / That's terrible. / Oh no! / What a shame! / That's too bad.
Surprise	Really? / Are you serious? / You're joking! / I can't believe it! / No way!
Encouraging	You can do it! / Don't give up! / Good luck! / Keep going! / I believe in you!
Sympathy	Don't worry. / It's not your fault. / It'll be OK. / I understand how you feel.
Relief	Thank goodness! / What a relief! / Phew!
Annoyed	That's so annoying! / I'm fed up with this. / This is ridiculous!

✎ Practice: Choose the most polite option

1. (a) Give me the menu. (b) Could I have the menu, please?

2. (a) What? (b) Sorry, could you say that again?

3. (a) Would you mind closing the door? (b) Close the door.

4. (a) No. (b) I'd love to, but I'm busy that day.

5. (a) You're wrong. (b) I see your point, but I see it differently.

✎ Practice: Complete with a suitable phrase

1. "I passed my driving test!" – "___!"

2. "Thank you for your help." – "You're ___."

3. "Sorry I'm late." – "Don't ___ about it."

4. "___ don't we go to the park?"

5. "Would you like some coffee?" – "Yes, ___."

At a Restaurant or Café

Useful phrases

Customer	Waiter / Staff
A table for two, please.	Do you have a reservation?
I've booked a table for 8 o'clock under the name Patel.	Right this way, please.
Could we see the menu, please?	Here's the menu.
What do you recommend?	Are you ready to order?
What's in this dish? / Is it spicy?	What would you like to drink?
I'd like the vegetable biryani, please.	Anything else?
I'll have the same.	Would you like a starter / dessert?
Can I have it without onions, please?	How would you like your steak? (rare / medium / well done)
Could we have some more water, please?	Is everything OK with your meal?
Excuse me, I ordered the chicken, not the fish.	I'm so sorry. I'll change it right away.
Could we have the bill, please? (UK) / Check, please. (US)	Would you like to pay together or separately?
Can I pay by card?	Here's your receipt.
Is service included?	Thank you. Have a nice evening!
Keep the change.	

Dialogue 1: Ordering dinner

Waiter: Good evening. Do you have a reservation?

Customer: Yes, a table for two under the name Sharma.

Waiter: Ah yes, Mr Sharma. Follow me, please. Here's your table. Here are the menus.

Customer: Thank you.

Waiter: Can I get you something to drink?

Customer: Could we have a bottle of water and two mango lassis, please?

Waiter: Of course. Are you ready to order, or do you need a few minutes?

Customer: We need a few more minutes, please.

Waiter: No problem.

(Five minutes later)

Waiter: Are you ready to order now?

Customer: Yes. What do you recommend?

Waiter: The paneer tikka is very popular. And our fish curry is excellent.

Customer: Is the fish curry very spicy?

Waiter: It's medium spicy. We can make it mild if you like.

Customer: Great. I'll have the fish curry, mild, with rice. And my wife would like the paneer tikka with two naans.

Waiter: Anything else?

Customer: No, that's all for now, thank you.

(After the meal)

Customer: Excuse me, could we have the bill, please?

Waiter: Certainly. Here you are.

Customer: Can I pay by card?

Waiter: Yes, of course.

Customer: Thank you. Everything was delicious.

Dialogue 2: At a café

Barista: Hi! What can I get you?

Customer: Can I have a cappuccino, please?

Barista: Sure. What size – small, medium or large?

Customer: Medium, please.

Barista: Would you like anything to eat?

Customer: Yes, one of those chocolate muffins, please.

Barista: For here or to take away?

Customer: To take away, please.

Barista: That's 320 rupees, please.

Customer: Here you are.

Barista: Thanks. Your coffee will be ready in a minute.

✎ Practice: Restaurant language

1. Who says "Are you ready to order?" – the waiter or the customer?

2. How do you ask for the price list of food?

3. How do you ask to pay?

4. "For here or to take away?" means...

Shopping

Dialogue 3: Buying clothes

Assistant: Hello. Can I help you?

Customer: Yes, please. I'm looking for a shirt for work.

Assistant: What size are you?

Customer: Medium, I think.

Assistant: These ones are very popular. They're 100% cotton.

Customer: Do you have this one in blue?

Assistant: Let me check... Yes, here you are.

Customer: Can I try it on?

Assistant: Of course. The changing rooms are over there.

(A few minutes later)

Customer: It's a bit tight. Do you have a bigger size?

Assistant: Here's a large.

Customer: This fits perfectly. How much is it?

Assistant: It's 1,200 rupees, but there's 20% off today, so it's 960.

Customer: Great, I'll take it.

Assistant: How would you like to pay?

Customer: By card, please.

Assistant: Could you enter your PIN? ... Thank you. Here's your receipt.

Customer: Can I return it if there's a problem?

Assistant: Yes, within 14 days with the receipt.

Customer: Perfect. Thank you!

Dialogue 4: Returning something

Customer: Excuse me. I bought these headphones yesterday, but the left side doesn't work.

Assistant: Oh, I'm sorry about that. Do you have the receipt?

Customer: Yes, here it is.

Assistant: Would you like to exchange them or get a refund?

Customer: I'd like to exchange them for a new pair, please.

Assistant: No problem. Here you are. Let's test them first... Is that OK?

Customer: Yes, they work perfectly now. Thanks for your help.

Dialogue 5: At the market (bargaining)

Customer: How much are the mangoes?

Seller: 200 rupees a kilo.

Customer: That's a bit expensive. Can you do 150?

Seller: 180. They're very fresh – they came this morning.

Customer: OK, 180. Can I have two kilos, please?

Seller: Sure. Anything else?

Customer: Half a kilo of tomatoes, please.

Seller: That's 400 in total.

Customer: Here's 500.

Seller: And here's your change, 100. Thank you!

On the Phone

Phone phrases

Situation	Phrases
Answering	Hello? / Hello, this is Priya speaking. / Good morning, ABC Company. How can I help you?
Saying who you are	Hi, it's Ravi. / This is Ravi from XYZ. (not "I am Ravi")
Asking for someone	Can I speak to Mr Khan, please? / Is Anita there? / Could you put me through to the sales department?
Asking who is calling	Who's calling, please? / May I ask who's calling?
Asking to wait	Hold on a moment, please. / Just a second. / Please hold.
Person not available	I'm afraid he's not available right now. / She's in a meeting. / He's out of the office.
Taking a message	Can I take a message? / Would you like to leave a message?
Leaving a message	Could you ask him to call me back? / Please tell her that Ravi called.
Checking information	Could you spell that, please? / Could you repeat the number? / Let me read that back to you.
Problems	Sorry, the line is bad. / You're breaking up. / I can't hear you very well. / Could you speak up a bit?
Ending	Thanks for calling. / I'll call you back later. / Talk to you soon. Bye!

Dialogue 6: A business call

Receptionist: Good morning, Green Tech Solutions. How can I help you?

Caller: Good morning. Could I speak to Mr Fernandes, please?

Receptionist: May I ask who's calling?

Caller: This is Neha Kapoor from Star Electronics.

Receptionist: Thank you, Ms Kapoor. Please hold... I'm sorry, Mr Fernandes is in a meeting right now. Can I take a message?

Caller: Yes, please. Could you ask him to call me back this afternoon? It's about our order.

Receptionist: Of course. Could I have your number, please?

Caller: It's 98450 12367.

Receptionist: Let me repeat that: 98450 12367. Is that right?

Caller: Yes, that's right.

Receptionist: I'll give him the message.

Caller: Thank you very much. Goodbye.

Receptionist: Goodbye, and thank you for calling.

Dialogue 7: Making an appointment

Receptionist: Good afternoon, City Dental Clinic.

Caller: Hello. I'd like to make an appointment with the dentist, please.

Receptionist: Have you been here before?

Caller: No, this is my first time.

Receptionist: OK. What's the problem?

Caller: I have a toothache. It started two days ago.

Receptionist: I see. We have an appointment tomorrow at 10:30 or on Thursday at 4. Which is better for you?

Caller: Tomorrow at 10:30, please.

Receptionist: Can I have your name, please?

Caller: Amit Verma. That's V-E-R-M-A.

Receptionist: Thank you, Mr Verma. So that's tomorrow, 10:30, with Dr Iyer. Please come 10 minutes early.

Caller: Great. Thanks a lot.

> **Tip:** Phone numbers: say each number separately. "0" can be "oh" or "zero". "44" = "double four". "999" = "nine nine nine" or "triple nine".

At the Doctor and Pharmacy

Dialogue 8: At the doctor's

Doctor: Good morning. Please sit down. What seems to be the problem?

Patient: Good morning, doctor. I've had a bad cough and a sore throat for four days.

Doctor: Do you have a fever?

Patient: Yes, last night it was 38.5.

Doctor: Any other symptoms? Headache? Body pain?

Patient: Yes, my whole body aches, and I feel very tired.

Doctor: Let me check your throat. Open your mouth and say "ah"... Your throat is very red. Now, take a deep breath... and again.

Patient: Is it serious?

Doctor: No, don't worry. It's a throat infection. I'll give you some antibiotics. Are you allergic to any medicine?

Patient: No, I'm not.

Doctor: Take one tablet twice a day after meals, for five days. And drink lots of warm water. Get plenty of rest.

Patient: Can I go to work?

Doctor: I'd stay at home for two or three days. If you don't feel better in three days, come back and see me.

Patient: Thank you, doctor.

Dialogue 9: At the pharmacy

Pharmacist: Hello. How can I help?

Customer: Hi. I have this prescription from my doctor.

Pharmacist: Let me see... OK. This will take five minutes.

Customer: Also, do you have something for a headache?

Pharmacist: Yes, these painkillers are good. Take one or two every six hours. Not more than eight in one day.

Customer: Can I take them with the antibiotics?

Pharmacist: Yes, that's fine.

Customer: Thank you. How much is that altogether?

Pharmacist: 450 rupees, please.

Travel and Directions

Dialogue 10: At the airport check-in

Agent: Good morning. Where are you flying to today?

Passenger: To Dubai.

Agent: Can I see your passport and ticket, please?

Passenger: Here you are.

Agent: Thank you. How many bags are you checking in?

Passenger: Just one suitcase.

Agent: Please put it on the scale... 22 kilos. That's fine. Did you pack the bag yourself?

Passenger: Yes, I did.

Agent: Would you like a window or an aisle seat?

Passenger: A window seat, please.

Agent: OK. Here's your boarding pass. You're in seat 24A. Boarding is at gate 15 at 10:20. The flight leaves at 10:50.

Passenger: Is the flight on time?

Agent: Yes, it is. Have a nice flight!

Dialogue 11: At the hotel

Receptionist: Good evening. Welcome to the Grand Hotel. How can I help you?

Guest: Hi. I have a reservation. My name is Joseph Thomas.

Receptionist: Let me check... Yes, Mr Thomas. A double room for three nights. Could I see your ID, please?

Guest: Sure. Here's my passport.

Receptionist: Thank you. Your room is 512, on the fifth floor. Here's your key card. Breakfast is from 7 to 10 in the restaurant on the ground floor.

Guest: Is there Wi-Fi?

Receptionist: Yes, it's free. The password is on your key card holder.

Guest: Great. What time is check-out?

Receptionist: Check-out is at 12 noon.

Guest: Could I have a wake-up call at 6:30 tomorrow?

Receptionist: Of course. Do you need help with your bags?

Guest: No, thanks. I can manage.

Receptionist: Enjoy your stay!

Dialogue 12: Asking for directions

Tourist: Excuse me. Could you help me? I'm looking for the National Museum.

Local: Sure. It's not far. Go straight along this road for about 200 metres.

Tourist: OK.

Local: Then turn left at the traffic lights. Go past the bank and the museum is on your right, opposite the park.

Tourist: So, straight on, left at the traffic lights, past the bank, and it's on the right?

Local: Exactly.

Tourist: How long does it take to walk?

Local: About ten minutes.

Tourist: Thank you so much!

Local: You're welcome. Enjoy the museum!

Dialogue 13: Taking a taxi

Passenger: Hello. Can you take me to the central railway station, please?

Driver: Sure. Get in.

Passenger: How long will it take?

Driver: About 25 minutes, if the traffic is OK.

Passenger: I need to catch a train at 5:30. Will we be on time?

Driver: Don't worry, we'll be there by 5.

(Later)

Passenger: How much is it?

Driver: 380 rupees.

Passenger: Here's 400. Keep the change.

Driver: Thank you! Have a good journey.

At Work and in the Office

Useful office phrases

Situation	Phrases
Starting a meeting	Shall we get started? / Let's begin. / Thanks for coming. / The purpose of this meeting is...
Giving your opinion	I think we should... / In my view... / From my point of view...
Interrupting politely	Sorry to interrupt, but... / Can I add something? / Could I just say something?
Asking for clarification	Could you explain that in more detail? / What do you mean by...?
Agreeing / disagreeing	I agree with Ravi. / I'm not sure that's the best idea.
Making suggestions	Why don't we...? / I suggest that we... / How about...?
Ending a meeting	Let's sum up. / To summarise... / Any other questions? / Thanks, everyone.
Asking for help	Could you give me a hand with this? / Do you have a minute?
Deadlines	When is the deadline? / I'll have it ready by Friday. / I need a bit more time.
Problems	We have a problem with... / The system is down. / I'm running late.
Updates	Just to update you... / The project is on track. / We're behind schedule.

Dialogue 14: Asking a colleague for help

Ali: Hi Meena, do you have a minute?

Meena: Sure. What's up?

Ali: I'm working on the sales report, but I can't figure out how to make a chart in Excel.

Meena: Oh, it's easy. Select the data first. Then click on "Insert" and choose "Chart".

Ali: Like this?

Meena: Yes, exactly. Now pick the type of chart you want.

Ali: Perfect! Thanks so much. I owe you a coffee.

Meena: No problem. Anytime!

Dialogue 15: Talking to your boss

Employee: Excuse me, Mr Rao. Do you have a moment?

Boss: Yes, of course. Come in.

Employee: I wanted to talk to you about the marketing project. I don't think we can finish it by Friday.

Boss: I see. What's the problem?

Employee: The client sent new information yesterday, and we need to change a lot of the design.

Boss: How much more time do you need?

Employee: I think we need until next Wednesday.

Boss: OK. I'll talk to the client. But please send me an update every day.

Employee: Of course. Thank you for understanding.

Job Interviews

Common interview questions and model answers

1. "Tell me about yourself."

"I'm a recent commerce graduate from Delhi University. During my studies, I did a six-month internship at an accounting firm, where I learned to prepare financial reports and work with clients. I'm hardworking, organised, and I enjoy working with numbers. I'm now looking for a full-time position where I can grow my skills."

2. "Why do you want to work here?"

"I've read a lot about your company, and I really admire your focus on customer service. I believe my skills would be a good fit, and I'd love to learn from your experienced team."

3. "What are your strengths?"

"I'm a fast learner and very reliable. For example, at my last job, I learned a new software system in one week and then trained my colleagues."

4. "What is your biggest weakness?"

"I sometimes spend too much time trying to make everything perfect. I'm learning to manage my time better by setting clear deadlines for myself."

5. "Where do you see yourself in five years?"

"In five years, I hope to be in a senior role, managing a small team, and continuing to develop my skills in this field."

6. "Why did you leave your last job?"

"I enjoyed my last job, but I was looking for new challenges and more opportunities to grow."

7. "Do you have any questions for us?"

"Yes. What does a typical day look like in this role?" / "What are the next steps in the process?" / "How do you measure success in this position?"

Interview tips

- Arrive 10–15 minutes early.
- Smile, make eye contact and shake hands firmly.
- Listen carefully to each question. If you don't understand, ask: "Could you repeat the question, please?"
- Give examples from your experience.
- Don't speak badly about your old company.
- At the end, say: "Thank you for your time. I look forward to hearing from you."
- Practise your answers out loud **many times** before the interview.

✎ Practice: Interview language

1. How do you ask the interviewer to repeat a question?

2. What do you say at the end of an interview?

3. Complete: "I'm a fast ___ and very reliable."

4. Is it a good idea to speak badly about your old boss?

More Everyday Dialogues

Dialogue 16: Meeting a new neighbour

Sara: Hi! I'm Sara. I've just moved into the flat next door.

Kumar: Oh, hello! Welcome to the building. I'm Kumar.

Sara: Nice to meet you, Kumar. Have you lived here long?

Kumar: About five years. It's a nice, quiet area.

Sara: That's good to hear. Is there a supermarket near here?

Kumar: Yes, there's one just round the corner, next to the pharmacy. It's open until 10.

Sara: Great, thanks. And which bus goes to the city centre?

Kumar: Number 42. The bus stop is at the end of the street.

Sara: Thanks so much. You've been very helpful.

Kumar: No problem. If you need anything, just knock on my door.

Dialogue 17: Making plans with a friend

Anil: Hey Priya! Are you free this Saturday?

Priya: I think so. Why?

Anil: There's a new comedy film at the cinema. Do you want to see it?

Priya: Sounds great! What time?

Anil: There's a show at 6:30. We could have dinner after.

Priya: Perfect. Where shall we meet?

Anil: How about at the café opposite the cinema, at 6?

Priya: OK. See you there!

Anil: Great. I'll book the tickets online.

Dialogue 18: Complaining politely

Guest: Excuse me. I'm in room 305. I'm afraid there's a problem with my room.

Receptionist: I'm sorry to hear that. What's the problem?

Guest: The air conditioning isn't working, and it's very hot.

Receptionist: I apologise for that. I'll send someone to fix it right away.

Guest: Thank you. Also, there are no towels in the bathroom.

Receptionist: I'm very sorry. Housekeeping will bring some immediately. If the AC can't be fixed, we'll move you to another room.

Guest: That would be great. Thank you for your help.

Dialogue 19: At the bank

Customer: Good morning. I'd like to open a savings account.

Bank clerk: Certainly. Do you have your ID and proof of address?

Customer: Yes, here's my Aadhaar card and an electricity bill.

Bank clerk: Thank you. Please fill in this form. Do you want a debit card too?

Customer: Yes, please. How long will it take to get it?

Bank clerk: About seven working days. It will be sent to your address.

Customer: Is there a minimum balance?

Bank clerk: Yes, 5,000 rupees.

Customer: OK. And can I use online banking?

Bank clerk: Yes. You'll receive the login details by email.

Dialogue 20: Talking about the weekend

Lisa: Hi Raj! How was your weekend?

Raj: It was great, thanks. I went to my cousin's wedding in Jaipur.

Lisa: Oh, wow! How was it?

Raj: Amazing. There was lots of music and dancing, and the food was delicious. We danced until 2 a.m.!

Lisa: That sounds like so much fun. Did you take any photos?

Raj: Hundreds! I'll show you later. What about you? What did you do?

Lisa: Nothing special. I cleaned my flat and watched a few episodes of a new series.

Raj: Sometimes a relaxing weekend is the best kind!

Lisa: True!

> **Tip:** Read each dialogue **out loud** three times. First, read both parts. Then cover one part and try to say it from memory. Finally, change some details (names, places, food) and make your own dialogue.

Talking About Yourself: 30 Speaking Topics

How to practise

For each topic, speak for **one to two minutes**. Record yourself on your phone. Listen back. Notice your mistakes, and try again. Use the question prompts to help you.

#	Topic	Questions to answer
1	Yourself	Name, age, where you live, job/studies, hobbies
2	Your family	How many people? What are they like? What do they do?
3	Your home	Where is it? How many rooms? What's your favourite room?
4	Your daily routine	What do you do every day, from morning to night?
5	Your job or studies	What do you do? What do you like/dislike about it?
6	Your best friend	How did you meet? What is he/she like? What do you do together?
7	Your hometown	Where is it? What's it famous for? What can visitors do there?
8	Food	What's your favourite food? Can you cook? Describe a dish from your country.
9	Hobbies	What do you do in your free time? How long have you done it?
10	Your last holiday	Where did you go? Who with? What did you do?
11	Your childhood	Where did you grow up? What did you use to do?
12	A festival	Which festival do you like? How do you celebrate it?
13	Weather and seasons	What's the weather like where you live? Favourite season?
14	Shopping	Do you like shopping? Where do you shop? Online or in shops?
15	Technology	How do you use your phone? Could you live without the internet?

#	Topic	Questions to answer
16	Health	What do you do to stay healthy? Do you exercise?
17	A film or book	What is it about? Why do you like it?
18	Music	What music do you like? Favourite singer?
19	Your future plans	What are you going to do next year? In five years?
20	Your dream job	What is it? Why?
21	A person you admire	Who? Why? What did they do?
22	A difficult time	What happened? How did you deal with it?
23	Your best day ever	When? What happened? Why was it special?
24	Transport	How do you travel to work/school? Is traffic a problem?
25	Learning English	Why are you learning? What is difficult? How are you improving?
26	If you won the lottery	What would you do?
27	Social media	Do you use it? Is it good or bad?
28	Your country	What do you love about it? What would you change?
29	A place you want to visit	Where? Why? What would you do there?
30	Advice	What advice would you give to a young person?

Example answer: Topic 25 – Learning English

"I'm learning English because I want to get a better job. In my city, many companies want employees who can speak English well. When I started, I was very nervous about speaking. I knew some grammar, but I couldn't say anything! Now I practise every day. I read this book, I watch videos on YouTube, and I talk to myself in the mirror. The most difficult thing for me is listening, because native speakers talk so fast. But I'm getting better. My goal is to have a job interview in English next year."

Part 7: Reading, Listening and Writing

Short stories, listening skills, emails, letters and paragraphs

Reading Practice: 10 Short Stories

How to read in English

- **First read**: read quickly for the general idea. Don't stop for every new word.
- **Second read**: read slowly. Underline new words. Guess their meaning from the sentence.
- **Third read**: read **out loud**. This helps your pronunciation and fluency.
- Then answer the questions and check the answer key.
- Write 5 new words from each story in your notebook.

> **Tip:** Read something in English **every day** – even 10 minutes. Start with easy texts (children's stories, graded readers, simple news websites). Reading is the fastest way to build vocabulary.

Story 1: The New Job (Level: Beginner)

Maya is 22 years old. She lives in a small town with her parents and her younger brother. Last month, she finished college. Yesterday, she got her first job! She is going to work in a bank in the city.

Maya is very happy, but she is also nervous. The city is big and busy. She has to take a bus every morning at 7 o'clock. The journey takes one hour.

On her first day, Maya wore a new blue dress. Her mother made her a big breakfast. "Don't worry," said her father. "Everyone is nervous on the first day."

At the bank, her manager was very kind. He showed her the office and introduced her to her colleagues. At lunchtime, a woman called Rita invited Maya to eat with her. They talked and laughed. In the evening, Maya called her mother. "It was a great day," she said. "I think I'm going to love this job."

✎ Practice: Story 1 questions

1. How old is Maya?

2. Where is her new job?

3. How long does the bus journey take?

4. What did Maya wear on her first day?

5. Who invited Maya to lunch?

6. How did Maya feel at the end of the day?

Story 2: The Lost Wallet (Level: Beginner)

One rainy evening, Sam was walking home from work. Near the bus stop, he saw something on the ground. It was a brown leather wallet. He picked it up and opened it. Inside, there was a lot of money – about 10,000 rupees – and an ID card. The name on the card was "Mr Harish Gupta", and there was an address.

Sam thought for a moment. He didn't have much money himself. But he knew it was wrong to keep it. The address was not far, so he walked there.

An old man opened the door. "Excuse me, are you Mr Gupta?" Sam asked. "Yes, I am," said the man. "I think this is yours," Sam said, and he gave him the wallet.

The old man's eyes filled with tears. "Thank you! This money was for my wife's medicine. I looked everywhere for it!" He tried to give Sam some money, but Sam said no. "Then please, come in and have some tea," said Mr Gupta. That evening, Sam made a new friend.

✎ Practice: Story 2 questions

1. What was the weather like?

2. What did Sam find?

3. How much money was in it?

4. Why was the money important to Mr Gupta?

5. Did Sam take money from Mr Gupta?

6. Find a word in the story that means "drops of water from your eyes".

Story 3: A Day at the Beach (Level: Elementary)

Last summer, the Fernandes family went to Goa for a week. On their third day, they decided to spend the whole day at the beach.

They woke up early and packed a big bag with towels, sunscreen, sandwiches, fruit and lots of water. When they arrived at the beach, it was still quiet. The sea was calm and blue, and the sand was warm.

The children, Leo and Mia, ran straight into the water. Their father, Antony, sat under a big umbrella and read a book, while their mother, Clara, went for a long walk along the beach. She collected some beautiful shells.

At lunchtime, they ate their sandwiches and fruit. In the afternoon, the beach became very crowded. Leo and Mia built a huge sandcastle, and some other children helped them. Later, the whole family went on a boat trip and they saw dolphins jumping out of the water!

In the evening, they watched the sun go down over the sea. "This is the best day of the holiday," said Mia. Everyone agreed.

✎ Practice: Story 3 questions

1. How long did the family stay in Goa?

2. What did they pack in their bag?

3. What did Clara collect?

4. What did the children build?

5. What animals did they see on the boat trip?

6. Find the opposite of "quiet" in paragraph 4.

Story 4: The Clever Crow (Level: Elementary – a traditional fable)

On a very hot summer day, a crow was flying in the sky. He was extremely thirsty. He flew here and there looking for water, but he couldn't find any. The rivers and ponds were dry.

At last, he saw a pot in a garden. He flew down quickly and looked inside. There was some water at the bottom, but the pot was tall, and his beak couldn't reach it.

The crow tried to push the pot over, but it was too heavy. He felt tired and hopeless. Then he had an idea. He saw some small stones near the pot. He picked up a stone with his beak and dropped it into the pot. Then another one, and another one.

Slowly, the water began to rise. The crow continued for a long time. Finally, the water was high enough. The crow drank the cool water happily and then flew away.

Moral: Where there's a will, there's a way. (If you really want something, you can find a way to get it.)

✎ Practice: Story 4 questions

1. Why was the crow looking for water?

2. Why couldn't he drink the water at first?

3. What did he put in the pot?

4. What happened to the water?

5. What is the moral of the story?

Story 5: Learning to Swim at 40 (Level: Pre-intermediate)

For most of his life, Vikram was afraid of water. When he was seven, he fell into a river near his village. His uncle pulled him out, but Vikram never forgot the fear. Since that day, he had never gone into deep water.

Last year, Vikram's daughter, Aisha, started swimming lessons. Every Saturday, Vikram sat beside the pool and watched her. "Papa, why don't you swim with me?" she asked one day. Vikram felt embarrassed. "I can't swim," he admitted.

That night, he couldn't sleep. He was 40 years old. Was it too late? The next morning, he spoke to Aisha's teacher. "I've never been able to swim," he said, "but I'd like to try." The teacher smiled. "It's never too late. I've taught people who were 70!"

The first lessons were very difficult. Vikram's heart was beating fast every time he put his face in the water. But the teacher was patient, and Aisha encouraged him. Slowly, he became more confident. After three months, he

swam a whole length of the pool for the first time. Aisha shouted and clapped.

Now, Vikram and Aisha swim together every weekend. "I wasted 33 years being afraid," he says. "Don't let fear stop you from learning something new – like English!"

✎ Practice: Story 5 questions

1. Why was Vikram afraid of water?

2. Who started swimming lessons first?

3. What did the teacher say about age?

4. How did Vikram feel during the first lessons?

5. How long did it take him to swim a whole length?

6. What is the main message of the story?

Story 6: The Power of Habit (Level: Pre-intermediate)

Ananya wanted to read more books. Every January, she made the same promise: "This year, I'm going to read 30 books." And every year, she read only two or three.

One day, she watched a video about habits. The speaker said: "Don't try to make big changes. Make your new habit so small that it's impossible to fail." Ananya decided to try. Her new rule was very simple: read **just two pages every night** before sleeping.

Two pages took her only three minutes. It was so easy that she never missed a day. But something interesting happened. Many nights, after two pages, she wanted to continue. Often she read twenty or thirty pages.

By December, Ananya had read 24 books – ten times more than before! "The secret," she says, "isn't motivation. It's starting small and doing it every single day."

You can use the same idea for English. Don't promise to study three hours a day. Promise to learn **five words** a day, or to speak English for **five minutes**. Small steps, every day, become big results.

✎ Practice: Story 6 questions

1. How many books did Ananya usually read in a year?

2. What was her new rule?

3. How long did two pages take?

4. How many books did she read by December?

5. According to Ananya, what is the secret?

Story 7: The Interview (Level: Intermediate)

Karan had applied for more than twenty jobs since graduating, but he had never been invited to an interview. When the email from a large software company finally arrived, he read it three times to make sure it was real.

The interview was going to be in English. Karan's technical skills were strong, but his spoken English was weak. He had always been too shy to practise. He had exactly two weeks to prepare.

He made a plan. Every morning, he wrote down five common interview questions and prepared answers. Every evening, he recorded himself answering them on his phone. When he listened back, he cringed – he spoke too fast, he said "um" constantly, and he made the same grammar mistakes again and again. But he kept recording. He also asked his cousin, who worked in Canada, to do a practice interview with him on a video call.

By the day of the interview, Karan wasn't perfect, but he was ready. When the interviewer asked, "Tell me about yourself," he smiled, took a breath and spoke clearly. He didn't understand one question, so he said, "I'm sorry, could you rephrase that, please?" – a phrase he had practised many times.

A week later, he received the offer. "They told me my English was clear and confident," he said. "Two weeks of daily practice changed my life."

✎ Practice: Story 7 questions

1. How many jobs had Karan applied for?

2. What was Karan's main problem?

3. What did he do every evening?

4. Who helped him with a practice interview?

5. What did Karan say when he didn't understand a question?

6. What does "cringed" probably mean?

Story 8: Two Neighbours (Level: Intermediate)

Mrs Kaur and Mr Ahmed had lived next door to each other for fifteen years, but they had hardly ever spoken. Years ago, they'd had an argument about a tree. Its branches grew over Mr Ahmed's wall, and leaves fell into his garden. Since then, they had only nodded coldly when they passed in the street.

One winter night, there was a terrible storm. The electricity went off in the whole street. At about midnight, Mr Ahmed heard someone knocking. It was Mrs Kaur, holding a candle. She was shaking. "I'm sorry to disturb you," she said, "but water is coming into my kitchen, and I don't know what to do."

Mr Ahmed didn't hesitate. He took his torch and some tools and followed her. A pipe had broken. He turned off the water and fixed the pipe as well as he could. It took nearly two hours. By the end, they were both wet and exhausted – and laughing.

"I've been silly about that tree," Mrs Kaur said, making tea on her gas stove. "No," said Mr Ahmed, "I was the silly one." From that night on, they became good friends. Every summer, Mr Ahmed now helps Mrs Kaur pick the fruit from the tree – and she always gives him half.

✎ Practice: Story 8 questions

1. How long had they been neighbours?

2. Why did they stop speaking?

3. Why did Mrs Kaur knock on Mr Ahmed's door?

4. How long did the repair take?

5. What happens every summer now?

6. Find a word that means "stop for a moment because you are not sure".

Story 9: The Smartphone Experiment (Level: Intermediate)

Last month, a school in Bangalore did an interesting experiment. They asked 100 teenagers to give up their smartphones for one week. Some students laughed. Some were angry. "A whole week? Impossible!" said one boy.

The first two days were the hardest. Many students said they felt anxious and bored. They kept reaching for their pockets, looking for a phone that wasn't there. "I didn't know what to do with my hands," said Divya, 15.

But by the fourth day, things started to change. Students began talking more to each other during breaks. Some started reading books from the library. A group of boys organised a cricket match. Several students said they were sleeping better and feeling less tired in class.

At the end of the week, the school asked the students to write about their experience. Most of them said it had been difficult but useful. "I realised I was spending six hours a day on my phone," wrote one girl. "That's 42 hours a week! I could learn a new language with that time."

Not everyone changed their habits after the experiment. But about half of the students decided to reduce their screen time, and many said they would try the challenge again.

✎ Practice: Story 9 questions

1. How many students took part?

2. How did students feel on the first two days?

3. Name two things students started doing by the fourth day.

4. How many hours a day was one girl spending on her phone?

5. Did all the students change their habits?

Story 10: A Letter to My Younger Self (Level: Upper-intermediate)

Dear 18-year-old me,

I know you're scared. You think your English is terrible, and you're embarrassed every time you open your mouth. You stay silent in class because you're afraid people will laugh. Let me tell you something: twenty years from now, you will give a presentation in English to 300 people – and you will enjoy it.

It won't happen by magic. It will happen because you'll make a decision to stop waiting until you feel "ready". You'll never feel completely ready. Nobody does. You'll start speaking anyway – badly at first, then a bit better, then quite well.

You'll make thousands of mistakes. Once, you'll tell a customer you're "very exciting" instead of "very excited" and everyone will laugh – including you. That's fine. Those mistakes are how you'll learn.

Here's my advice: listen to English every single day, even when you don't understand. Read things you enjoy. Talk to yourself in the shower. Write a few sentences each night about your day. Don't compare yourself with others – compare yourself with who you were last month.

Most importantly, be kind to yourself. Learning a language is one of the hardest and most rewarding things you'll ever do. I'm proud of you for starting.

With love,

Your future self

✎ Practice: Story 10 questions

1. Why did the writer stay silent in class?

2. What will the writer do in twenty years?

3. What mistake did the writer make with a customer?

4. Who should you compare yourself with, according to the letter?

5. Give two pieces of advice from the letter.

Listening Skills

Why is listening difficult?

Many learners say: "I can read English, but I can't understand when people speak!" This is very normal. Here's why:

- Native speakers speak **fast** and **join words together** ("Whaddaya want?" = "What do you want?").
- They use **weak forms** – small words almost disappear.
- There are many different **accents**: British, American, Australian, Indian, Nigerian and more.
- Real conversations have **idioms, slang and phrasal verbs**.

The good news: your ears can be **trained**, like a muscle. The more you listen, the better you understand.

A step-by-step listening method

1. **Choose the right level.** If you understand less than 50%, it's too difficult. If you understand 100%, it's too easy. Aim for **70–80%**.

2. **Listen once** for the general idea. Don't stop.

3. **Listen again** with subtitles **in English** (not your language).

4. **Listen a third time** without subtitles. You'll be surprised how much more you understand.

5. **Shadow** (see below): repeat what the speaker says, at the same time.

6. **Write down** 3–5 useful phrases you heard.

Shadowing: the secret technique

Shadowing means listening to a speaker and **repeating immediately** after them, like a shadow, copying their speed, rhythm and intonation.

- Choose a short audio (30–60 seconds) with a transcript.
- Listen and read the transcript.
- Play again, and speak **along with** the speaker, one or two words behind.
- Repeat 5–10 times until you can keep up.

This trains your **ears and mouth together**. It is one of the best ways to improve pronunciation and fluency.

What to listen to

Level	Suggestions
Beginner	Children's cartoons, simple songs, "slow English" podcasts and YouTube channels, graded audiobooks
Elementary	YouTube channels for English learners, simple podcasts, short news for learners, cooking videos
Intermediate	TV series (with English subtitles), TED talks, podcasts about your hobbies, YouTube vlogs, audiobooks
Advanced	Films without subtitles, news radio, interviews, debates, comedy shows

Tip: Listen to topics you **love**. If you like cricket, listen to cricket commentary. If you like cooking, watch cooking videos in English. When you are interested, you learn faster and you don't get bored.

Understanding fast speech: common reductions

You hear	It means
gonna	going to
wanna	want to
gotta	got to (have to)
hafta	have to
kinda	kind of
sorta	sort of
lemme	let me
gimme	give me
dunno	don't know
y'know	you know
d'you / didja	do you / did you
whatcha	what are you / what do you

You hear	It means
shoulda / coulda / woulda	should have / could have / would have
outta	out of
lotta	lot of
ain't	isn't / aren't / haven't (very informal, not standard)
ya	you
'cause / cuz	because

✎ Practice: What do these mean?

1. "I'm gonna call her."

2. "I dunno."

3. "Lemme see."

4. "I gotta go."

5. "You shoulda told me."

Writing: Sentences and Paragraphs

Writing good sentences

A good sentence:

- starts with a **capital letter** and ends with a **full stop**, question mark or exclamation mark;
- has a **subject** and a **verb**;
- expresses **one clear idea**.

Make simple sentences longer and better

Simple	Better
I have a dog.	I have a small brown dog called Max.
I went to the market.	Yesterday, I went to the market to buy vegetables.
The film was good.	The film was really exciting, and the actors were excellent.
I like my job.	I like my job because my colleagues are friendly and I learn new things every day.

Avoid very long sentences

✗ I woke up and I had breakfast and I went to work and I had a meeting and then I had lunch and it was good. ✓ I woke up, had breakfast and went to work. After a meeting, I had a delicious lunch.

Writing a paragraph

A paragraph is a group of sentences about **one main idea**. It has three parts:

1. **Topic sentence** – tells the main idea.
2. **Supporting sentences** – give details, reasons and examples.
3. **Concluding sentence** – finishes the idea.

Example paragraph: My Favourite Place

"**My favourite place is my grandmother's village in Kerala.** It is very green and peaceful, with coconut trees and small rivers everywhere. When I visit, I wake up to the sound of birds instead of traffic. My grandmother cooks delicious fish curry, and in the evenings we sit on the veranda and talk for hours. I also love swimming in the river with my cousins. **For me, this village is the perfect place to relax and forget about the stress of city life.**"

Example paragraph: The Benefits of Exercise

"**Regular exercise has many benefits for both the body and the mind.** First, it makes your heart and muscles stronger and helps you control your weight. Second, it gives you more energy during the day and helps you sleep better at night. In addition, exercise reduces stress. For example, a 30-minute walk can make you feel calmer and happier. **In short, everyone should try to exercise for at least a few minutes every day.**"

Your daily diary

Writing a short diary every day is a wonderful habit. Use this model:

"**Today** I woke up at 7. **In the morning**, I went to work by bus. **At work**, I had a long meeting. It was quite boring. **For lunch**, I ate rice and dal with my colleagues. **In the afternoon**, I finished a report. **After work**, I went to the gym. **In the evening**, I watched a film and studied English for 30 minutes. **Today I learned** the phrase "call it a day". **Tomorrow I'm going to** visit my aunt."

✎ Practice: Improve the sentences

1. i like cricket

2. She is teacher.

3. Yesterday I go to the park.

4. The food was good. (make it more interesting)

Writing Emails and Messages

Informal vs formal

	Informal (friends, family)	Formal (work, officials, strangers)
Greeting	Hi Sam, / Hey Sam! / Dear Sam,	Dear Mr Patel, / Dear Ms Rao, / Dear Sir or Madam,
Opening	Hope you're well! / How are things? / Thanks for your message.	I hope this email finds you well. / I am writing to... / Thank you for your email.
Asking	Can you...? / Could you...?	Could you please...? / I would be grateful if you could...
Closing line	Write soon! / Talk soon! / Can't wait to see you!	I look forward to hearing from you. / Please let me know if you have any questions.
Signing off	Love, / Take care, / Cheers, / Best,	Kind regards, / Best regards, / Yours sincerely, (if you know the name) / Yours faithfully, (if you started with Dear Sir or Madam)
Style	short forms (I'm, don't), simple words	full forms (I am, do not), polite words

Email 1: Informal – inviting a friend

Subject: Birthday party on Saturday!

Hi Neha,

Hope you're doing well! I'm having a small birthday party at my place this Saturday, 14th June, from 7 p.m. There'll be food, music and a few friends from college.

It would be great if you could come! Let me know by Thursday so I know how much food to make.

My address is Flat 3B, Lotus Apartments, Park Street.

Can't wait to see you!

Love,

Riya

Email 2: Formal – asking for information

Subject: Enquiry about English evening classes

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to ask for some information about your English evening classes, which I saw advertised on your website.

Could you please tell me how long the course lasts and how much it costs? I would also like to know if there is a test to check my level before I start.

I work until 6 p.m. on weekdays, so I would prefer classes after 7 p.m.

I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours faithfully,

Arjun Nair

Email 3: Formal – applying for a job

Subject: Application for the position of Customer Service Executive

Dear Ms Thomas,

I am writing to apply for the position of Customer Service Executive, which was advertised on your company website on 2nd March.

I have a bachelor's degree in commerce and two years of experience in customer service at a large telecom company. In my current role, I handle about 50 customer calls a day and solve problems quickly and politely. I have excellent communication skills and I am comfortable using computer systems.

I have attached my CV for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I could contribute to your team.

Thank you for your time. I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours sincerely,

Pooja Singh

Phone: 98765 43210

Email 4: Formal – making a complaint

Subject: Complaint about order no. 45721

Dear Customer Service Team,

I am writing to complain about an order I received on 10th May (order number 45721).

I ordered a black office chair, but I received a blue one. In addition, one of the wheels was broken.

I would be grateful if you could arrange for the chair to be collected and replaced with the correct item as soon as possible. Alternatively, I would like a full refund.

I have attached photos of the chair.

I look forward to your reply.

Kind regards,

Mohammed Ali

Email 5: Work – asking for leave

Subject: Leave request – 20th to 24th October

Dear Mr Rao,

I would like to request leave from Monday 20th October to Friday 24th October, as I need to attend my sister's wedding in Lucknow.

I will make sure that my current tasks are finished before I go, and Sunita has agreed to handle any urgent issues while I am away.

Please let me know if this is possible.

Best regards,

Kavita

Useful phrases for work emails

Purpose	Phrases
Replying	Thank you for your email. / Thanks for getting back to me.
Attaching	Please find attached... / I have attached...
Following up	I am writing to follow up on... / Just a quick reminder about...
Apologising	I apologise for the delay. / Sorry for the late reply.
Asking for action	Could you please send me...? / Please let me know by Friday.
Giving good news	I am pleased to inform you that...
Giving bad news	Unfortunately, ... / I am afraid that...
Offering help	Please let me know if you need any further information. / Feel free to contact me.
Confirming	I am writing to confirm... / This is to confirm that...

✗ Please do the needful. ✓ Please could you take care of this?

✗ Kindly revert back. ✓ Please reply / I look forward to your reply.

✗ PFA (Please find attached) – avoid abbreviations in formal emails ✓ Please find attached...

Text messages and chat

Short informal messages often use abbreviations. You should understand them, but don't use them in formal writing.

Abbreviation	Meaning
u / ur	you / your
pls / plz	please
thx / ty	thanks / thank you
btw	by the way
asap	as soon as possible
lol	laughing out loud (something is funny)
omg	oh my god
idk	I don't know

Abbreviation	Meaning
brb	be right back
ttyl	talk to you later
imo	in my opinion
np	no problem
gr8	great
tmrw	tomorrow
fyi	for your information

✎ Practice: Formal or informal?

1. "Hey! What's up?"

2. "I am writing to apply for..."

3. "Yours sincerely,"

4. "Talk soon!"

5. "I look forward to hearing from you."

6. "Please find attached my CV."

✎ Practice: Write a formal version

1. "Send me the report."

2. "Sorry I'm late replying."

3. "Here's my CV."

Writing a CV and Other Documents

A simple CV structure

Section	What to include
Personal details	Full name, phone number, email, city (no need for age, religion or a photo in many countries)
Profile / summary	2–3 sentences about who you are and what you can offer
Work experience	Most recent job first: job title, company, dates, 3–5 bullet points of achievements
Education	Degree, university, year; school if you are a recent graduate
Skills	Languages, computer skills, technical skills
Interests (optional)	2–3 interests that show something positive
References	"Available on request"

Strong action verbs for your CV

managed, led, organised, created, developed, improved, increased, reduced, trained, designed, handled, solved, achieved, delivered, coordinated, supported, launched, planned

Example bullet points

- **Managed** a team of five sales staff.
- **Increased** monthly sales by 20% in one year.
- **Handled** over 50 customer enquiries per day.
- **Trained** new employees in company software.

Filling in forms

Form word	Meaning
First name / Given name	your personal name: Rahul
Surname / Last name / Family name	Sharma
Date of birth (DOB)	15/08/1995
Place of birth	the city where you were born
Nationality	Indian, Nepali, etc.
Marital status	single / married / divorced / widowed
Occupation	your job
Address / Postcode / PIN code	where you live
Signature	your name written in your own style
Male / Female / Other (M / F)	gender
Block capitals	write in CAPITAL LETTERS
Tick the box	put ✓
N/A	not applicable (it doesn't apply to you)
Emergency contact	a person to call if there is a problem

Part 8: Your Fluency Plan

Habits, a 90-day plan, and how to keep improving for life

The Secrets of Fluency

What fluency really means

Fluency is **not** knowing every word or never making mistakes. Fluency means you can:

- speak **without stopping** a lot to think;
- **understand** most of what people say in everyday situations;
- **express your ideas** clearly, even with simple words;
- **keep a conversation going**, and recover when you don't know a word.

Many fluent speakers use only simple grammar and common words. What makes them fluent is **practice** and **confidence**.

Secret 1: Think in English

Translating in your head is slow. Train your brain to think directly in English:

- **Name things** around you: "cup, window, laptop, plant, fan..."
- **Describe what you're doing**: "I'm making tea. Now I'm adding sugar. It smells good."
- **Plan your day in English**: "First I'll go to the bank, then I'll buy vegetables..."
- **Talk to yourself**: in the shower, while walking, while cooking.
- **Ask yourself questions**: "What will I eat tonight? Why am I tired?"

Start with 5 minutes a day. After a few weeks, English thoughts will come naturally.

Secret 2: Speak every day – even alone

You learn to speak by speaking, just as you learn to swim by swimming.

- **Read aloud** for 10 minutes every day.
- **Record yourself** talking about a topic for 1–2 minutes. Listen back. Repeat.
- **Speak in front of a mirror** – watch your mouth and practise confidence.

- **Find a speaking partner**: a friend, a family member, an online language exchange, an English club.
- **Use voice messages** in English with friends who are also learning.
- **Use an AI chat assistant** to practise conversations – ask it to correct your mistakes.

Secret 3: When you don't know a word, go around it

Don't stop! Use simple words to explain:

- "It's a kind of..." – "It's a kind of fruit, it's yellow and long." (banana)
- "It's something you use for..." – "It's something you use for cutting paper." (scissors)
- "It's like a... but..." – "It's like a bus, but on rails." (train)
- "The person who..." – "the person who fixes water pipes" (plumber)
- "What's the word...? The opposite of 'cheap'." (expensive)
- "I don't know the word in English, but..."

This skill is called **paraphrasing**, and it is used by all fluent speakers.

Secret 4: Learn chunks, not single words

Fluent speakers have hundreds of ready-made phrases in their memory. They don't build every sentence from zero. Learn chunks like:

- "I was wondering if..."
- "To be honest, ..."
- "It depends on..."
- "The thing is, ..."
- "As far as I know, ..."
- "I'm not sure, but I think..."
- "What I mean is..."
- "It's up to you."
- "That makes sense."
- "I couldn't agree more."
- "Let me think about it."
- "I'm looking forward to it."

- "It's not a big deal."
- "I'd rather not."
- "Have you ever thought about...?"
- "No wonder!"
- "It's worth trying."
- "I'm used to it."
- "I didn't mean to..."
- "Sounds like a plan!"

Secret 5: Don't fear mistakes – fear silence

The only way to make no mistakes is to say nothing. And if you say nothing, you never improve. Native speakers usually **don't care** about your mistakes. They care about **understanding you**. Most of them will be impressed that you speak a second language!

> **Tip:** When you feel nervous, remember: **communication is more important than perfection**. Breathe, smile, speak slowly, and keep going.

Secret 6: Make English part of your life

- Change your **phone and apps** to English.
- Follow English-speaking people on **social media** about topics you like.
- Watch **one episode** of a series in English every day.
- Listen to English **podcasts** while travelling or exercising.
- Write your **shopping lists**, **to-do lists** and **diary** in English.
- Read **news** in simple English.
- Sing **English songs** – read the lyrics and sing along.
- Play **games** in English.

Secret 7: Be consistent

Thirty minutes every day for one year is about **180 hours**. That will transform your English. Three hours once a month will not. Consistency beats intensity. Never miss two days in a row.

The 90-Day Fluency Plan

How the plan works

This plan has **three phases** of 30 days. Every day, spend **45–60 minutes**. Use this book plus listening and speaking practice. Tick each day when you finish it. Don't worry if you need more time – go at your own speed, but **don't stop**.

Daily structure

Part	Time	What to do
Review	10 min	Read your notebook and yesterday's lesson
Learn	15–20 min	Study the lesson of the day from this book
Practise	10 min	Do the exercises; check the answer key
Listen	10 min	Listen to English (with English subtitles) and shadow
Speak / Write	5–10 min	Speak for 2 minutes on a topic, or write your diary

Phase 1 (Days 1–30): Foundations

Goal: introduce yourself, talk about your daily life, use the present tenses and the past simple.

Day	Lesson	Speaking / writing task
1	How to Use This Book; set your goals	Write why you are learning English
2	Alphabet and sounds (part 1)	Spell your name and address aloud
3	Sounds (part 2): -ed, -s, word stress	Read the sound tables aloud
4	Parts of speech; word order	Write 10 S-V-O sentences about yourself
5	Nouns, plurals	Describe objects in your room
6	Countable and uncountable nouns	Describe what's in your fridge

Day	Lesson	Speaking / writing task
7	Review week 1	Speak for 1 minute: "About me"
8	Articles a, an, the	Describe your street
9	Pronouns and possessives	Talk about your family's things
10	The verb "be"	Introduce five family members
11	Have / have got	Talk about what you have and don't have
12	Adjectives, comparatives	Compare two cities you know
13	Adverbs and frequency	Say how often you do 10 activities
14	Review week 2	Speaking topic 2: Your family
15	Prepositions of time	Talk about your weekly schedule
16	Prepositions of place and movement	Describe the way from your home to a shop
17	Quantifiers	Talk about food you eat
18	Numbers, dates, time, money	Say 10 prices and 10 times aloud
19	Tenses overview	Learn 20 irregular verbs
20	Present simple	Speaking topic 4: Your daily routine
21	Review week 3	Write a diary entry
22	Present continuous	Describe what people are doing around you
23	Present simple vs continuous	Make 10 contrast sentences
24	Past simple (part 1)	Talk about yesterday
25	Past simple (part 2) – story	Retell the story of Arjun's terrible Saturday
26	Greetings and introductions	Practise introducing yourself (record it)
27	Small talk	Have a small-talk conversation (or role-play alone)
28	Everyday functions	Practise thanking, apologising, requesting
29	Vocabulary: People, family, body	Describe a friend's appearance and personality
30	**Phase 1 review**	Record a 2-minute video about yourself and your life. Compare with Day 1!

Phase 2 (Days 31–60): Building

Goal: use all main tenses, ask any question, use modal verbs, handle daily situations.

Day	Lesson	Speaking / writing task
31	Present perfect (part 1): experiences	"Have you ever...?" – 10 questions and answers
32	Present perfect (part 2): for/since	Say how long you have done 10 things
33	Present perfect vs past simple	Talk about your life experiences with details
34	Present perfect continuous	Talk about what you've been doing recently
35	Past continuous	Tell a story: "I was walking when..."
36	Past perfect	Tell a story with "had already"
37	Review week 5	Speaking topic 10: Your last holiday
38	Used to / would	Speaking topic 11: Your childhood
39	Future: will and going to	Talk about your plans for next year
40	Future: present forms; time clauses	Describe your plans for next week
41	Future continuous and perfect	"This time next year, I'll be..."
42	All 12 tenses review	Do the mixed tenses exercise again
43	Asking questions	Write 20 questions to ask a new friend
44	Question tags; so do I / neither do I	Practise with a partner or recording
45	Negatives	Talk about things you never do
46	Modal verbs (part 1)	Give advice to a friend with problems
47	Modal verbs (part 2)	Talk about rules at your work/school
48	Review week 7	Speaking topic 19: Your future plans
49	Vocabulary: Home and daily life	Describe your home in detail
50	Vocabulary: Food and drink	Explain how to cook your favourite dish
51	At a restaurant (dialogues 1–2)	Role-play ordering food

Day	Lesson	Speaking / writing task
52	Vocabulary: Clothes, shopping, money	Describe what you are wearing
53	Shopping (dialogues 3–5)	Role-play buying clothes and returning something
54	Vocabulary: Work and jobs	Speaking topic 5: Your job or studies
55	On the phone (dialogues 6–7)	Practise a phone call and taking a message
56	Vocabulary: Health	Role-play at the doctor's
57	Vocabulary: Travel	Give directions from your home to a famous place
58	Travel dialogues (10–13)	Role-play checking in at a hotel
59	Reading: stories 1–4	Retell one story in your own words
60	**Phase 2 review**	Record a 3-minute video about your plans and past experiences

Phase 3 (Days 61–90): Fluency

Goal: speak in longer turns, give opinions, understand faster speech, write clearly.

Day	Lesson	Speaking / writing task
61	Conditionals: zero and first	"If I have time tomorrow, I will..."
62	Second conditional	Speaking topic 26: If you won the lottery
63	Third conditional; wishes	Talk about regrets and wishes
64	Passive voice	Describe how something is made
65	Reported speech	Report a conversation you had today
66	Gerunds and infinitives	Talk about things you enjoy, want and avoid
67	Review week 10	Speaking topic 21: A person you admire
68	Relative clauses	Define 10 words using who/which/where
69	Linking words	Write a paragraph with 6 linking words
70	Punctuation	Correct your old diary entries

Day	Lesson	Speaking / writing task
71	Phrasal verbs A–G	Write 10 sentences about your life
72	Phrasal verbs H–P	Use 10 phrasal verbs in a story
73	Phrasal verbs R–Z	Describe your day using 10 phrasal verbs
74	Idioms (first 50)	Use 5 idioms in conversation
75	Idioms (second 50)	Teach someone 5 idioms
76	Collocations	Make/do/take/have/get – 20 sentences
77	Confusing words; common mistakes	Check your notebook for these mistakes
78	Giving opinions; agreeing and disagreeing	Discuss: "Is social media good or bad?"
79	Office phrases and dialogues	Role-play a meeting
80	Job interviews	Answer all 7 interview questions (record)
81	Reading: stories 5–7	Summarise each story in 3 sentences
82	Reading: stories 8–10	Write a letter to your younger self
83	Listening skills and shadowing	Shadow a 1-minute video 10 times
84	Writing paragraphs	Write a paragraph: "My favourite place"
85	Informal emails	Write an email inviting a friend
86	Formal emails	Write a complaint email
87	CV and forms	Write your CV in English
88	Secrets of fluency	Think in English all day – try it!
89	Final test (next chapter)	Check your answers; review weak areas
90	**Phase 3 review – celebrate!**	Record a 5-minute video about your English journey. Compare with Day 1 and Day 30. You've done it!

After 90 days: keep going!

- Repeat the parts of this book that were difficult.
- Read one graded reader or simple novel every month.
- Watch series and films with English subtitles, then without.
- Find regular speaking practice: a class, a club, a language partner.
- Keep your diary. Keep learning 10 words a day.
- Set a new goal: an exam (IELTS, TOEFL, Cambridge), a job, a trip.

Pronunciation Practice and Tongue Twisters

Daily pronunciation workout (5 minutes)

1. **Warm up your mouth**: open wide, smile, make an "O" shape, move your tongue around.
2. **Minimal pairs**: say these pairs, feeling the difference.
3. **Tongue twister**: choose one, say it slowly, then faster.
4. **Sentence stress**: read a sentence and stress the important words.

Minimal pairs

Sound	Pairs
/ɪ/ – /iː/	ship – sheep, live – leave, fill – feel, sit – seat, hit – heat
/æ/ – /e/	bad – bed, man – men, sat – set, had – head, pan – pen
/æ/ – /ʌ/	cat – cut, bag – bug, hat – hut, match – much, ran – run
/ɒ/ – /ɔː/	pot – port, cot – caught, shot – short, not – nought
/ʊ/ – /uː/	full – fool, pull – pool, look – Luke
/v/ – /w/	vest – west, vine – wine, verse – worse, vet – wet
/b/ – /v/	best – vest, ban – van, boat – vote, berry – very
/p/ – /f/	pan – fan, pine – fine, pull – full, copy – coffee
/θ/ – /t/	thin – tin, three – tree, thank – tank, both – boat
/ð/ – /d/	they – day, those – doze, then – den, breathe – breed
/s/ – /ʃ/	sip – ship, see – she, sort – short, mess – mesh
/l/ – /r/	light – right, long – wrong, fly – fry, glass – grass
/tʃ/ – /ʃ/	chip – ship, cheap – sheep, watch – wash, chair – share
/dʒ/ – /z/	jew – zoo, page – phase
/n/ – /ŋ/	thin – thing, ran – rang, sin – sing, ban – bang

Tongue twisters

Start slowly. Repeat three times. Then speed up.

- She sells seashells by the seashore.
- Peter Piper picked a peck of pickled peppers.
- How much wood would a woodchuck chuck if a woodchuck could chuck wood?
- Red lorry, yellow lorry. (repeat 5 times)
- Unique New York, unique New York, you know you need unique New York.
- I scream, you scream, we all scream for ice cream.
- Three free throws. (th – fr – thr)
- The thirty-three thieves thought that they thrilled the throne throughout Thursday.
- Fred fed Ted bread, and Ted fed Fred bread.
- Very well, very well, very well. (v – w)
- We surely shall see the sun shine soon.
- Betty Botter bought some butter, but she said, "This butter's bitter."
- A big black bug bit a big black bear.
- Six slippery snails slid slowly seaward.
- Willie's really weary. (w – r)
- Which witch is which?
- Lesser leather never weathered wetter weather better.
- Truly rural, truly rural.
- A proper copper coffee pot.
- Eleven benevolent elephants.

Sentence stress practice

Read these. Stress the **CAPITAL** words. Small words are quick and weak.

- I'd LIKE a CUP of TEA, PLEASE.
- WHAT are you DOING at the WEEKEND?
- She's GOING to LONDON NEXT WEEK.
- I've NEVER BEEN to JAPAN.
- CAN you HELP me with my BAGS?
- I DIDN'T KNOW you were COMING!
- It's the BEST FILM I've EVER SEEN.

Stress changes meaning

- **I** didn't say he stole the money. (someone else said it)
- I didn't **say** he stole the money. (I wrote it, maybe!)
- I didn't say **he** stole the money. (someone else stole it)
- I didn't say he **stole** the money. (he borrowed it)
- I didn't say he stole the **money**. (he stole something else)

British and American English

The main differences

Both are correct! Choose one style and be consistent. Here are common vocabulary differences:

British (UK)	American (US)
flat	apartment
lift	elevator
lorry	truck
petrol	gas / gasoline
motorway	highway / freeway
pavement	sidewalk
car park	parking lot
underground / tube	subway
queue	line
holiday	vacation
autumn	fall
biscuit	cookie
crisps	chips
chips	(French) fries
sweets	candy
bill (restaurant)	check
shop	store
chemist's	pharmacy / drugstore
mobile (phone)	cell (phone)
post	mail
postcode	zip code
rubbish / bin	trash / garbage can
trousers	pants

British (UK)	American (US)
pants	underwear
jumper	sweater
trainers	sneakers
torch	flashlight
timetable	schedule
ground floor / first floor	first floor / second floor
football	soccer
maths	math
film	movie
CV	résumé
toilet	restroom / bathroom
return ticket / single ticket	round-trip ticket / one-way ticket

Spelling differences

British	American
colour, favourite, neighbour	color, favorite, neighbor
centre, theatre, metre	center, theater, meter
organise, realise, apologise	organize, realize, apologize
travelled, cancelled	traveled, canceled
programme	program
defence, licence	defense, license
cheque	check
grey	gray
jewellery	jewelry

Grammar differences

British	American
I've just eaten. / Have you finished yet?	I just ate. / Did you finish yet? (both are used)
at the weekend	on the weekend
in a team	on a team
Have you got a car?	Do you have a car?
got	gotten (past participle)
different from / to	different from / than
write to me	write me

Final Test: Check Your Progress

Instructions

This test covers the whole book. Do it **without looking** at the lessons. Then check the answer key. Give yourself one point for each correct answer.

- **45–50**: Excellent! You have a strong foundation. Focus on speaking and listening practice.
- **35–44**: Very good. Review the topics where you made mistakes.
- **25–34**: Good start. Go back to Parts 2–4 and review them carefully.
- **Below 25**: Don't worry! Repeat the 90-day plan more slowly. You will improve.

✎ Practice: Final test – Part A: Grammar

1. She ___ (work) in a hospital.

2. I ___ (not / like) spicy food.

3. Look! It ___ (snow).

4. I ___ (see) him yesterday.

5. ___ you ever ___ (be) to Delhi?

6. I have lived here ___ 2018.

7. When I arrived, the film ___ already ___ (start).

8. If it ___ (rain) tomorrow, we will stay home.

9. If I ___ (be) rich, I would travel the world.

10. This bridge ___ (build) in 1990.

11. He said that he ___ (be) tired.

12. I enjoy ___ (read).

13. I want ___ (learn) English.

14. The man ___ lives next door is a doctor.

15. She is ___ (tall) than her brother.

16. It's ___ best day of my life.

17. I'm interested ___ music.

18. I was born ___ 15th August.

19. You ___ smoke here. It's forbidden.

20. ___ you help me, please?

✎ Practice: Final test – Part B: Vocabulary and phrases

1. Opposite of "cheap"

2. ___ a mistake (make or do?)

3. ___ homework (make or do?)

4. Can I ___ your pen? (borrow / lend)

5. "Turn off" the TV means...

6. "A piece of cake" means...

7. Past simple of "buy"

8. Past participle of "write"

9. Your mother's sister is your ___.

10. The film was very ___. (bored / boring)

11. I ___ my keys. I can't find them. (lost / have lost)

12. Plural of "child"

13. "I'm ___ to seeing you."

14. "Give up" means...

15. "Under the weather" means...

✎ Practice: Final test – Part C: Everyday English

1. Polite way to ask for the bill in a restaurant

2. What do you say when someone says "Thank you"?

3. How do you ask someone to repeat?

4. Answer to "How are you?"

5. How do you ask the price?

6. Formal email ending when you know the person's name

7. How do you politely refuse an invitation?

8. Correct this: "I am agree with you."

9. Correct this: "He don't know."

10. Correct this: "Where you live?"

11. Correct this: "I have 25 years."

12. Correct this: "Can you tell me where is the bank?"

13. Correct this: "I didn't went."

14. Correct this: "Listen me."

15. Correct this: "I gave my exam."

Your Self-Check List and Final Words

Can you do these things?

Tick each one when you can do it with confidence. Come back to this list every month.

Speaking

- I can introduce myself and talk about my family, job and hobbies.
- I can ask and answer simple questions about daily life.
- I can order food in a restaurant and buy things in a shop.
- I can ask for and give directions.
- I can make a phone call and leave a message.
- I can explain a health problem to a doctor.
- I can talk about my past experiences and future plans.
- I can give my opinion and agree or disagree politely.
- I can keep a conversation going with follow-up questions.
- I can explain a word I don't know using other words.

Listening

- I can understand slow, clear English on everyday topics.
- I can understand the main idea of a short video or podcast for learners.
- I can follow a TV series with English subtitles.
- I can understand native speakers when they speak at normal speed (most of the time).

Reading

- I can read short stories and simple news articles.
- I can guess the meaning of new words from context.
- I can read emails and messages at work.

Writing

- I can write a diary entry about my day.
- I can write a clear paragraph with a topic sentence.
- I can write informal and formal emails.
- I can fill in forms and write a simple CV.

Grammar

- I can use the present simple and continuous correctly.
- I can use the past simple with regular and irregular verbs.
- I can use the present perfect with ever, never, for and since.
- I can talk about the future with will, going to and the present continuous.
- I can use modal verbs (can, should, must, have to) correctly.
- I can make first and second conditional sentences.

Final words

Congratulations! If you have reached this page, you have done something many people only dream about. You have studied English grammar, learned hundreds of words and phrases, read stories, practised dialogues, and built daily habits.

Remember:

- **Every expert was once a beginner.**
- **Small steps every day lead to big results.**
- **Mistakes are proof that you are trying.**
- **Fluency comes from practice, not perfection.**

Keep this book. Open it again when you forget something. Review the tables. Repeat the exercises. Read the stories again. Each time, you will notice that you understand more.

Most importantly, **use your English**. Speak to people. Watch, listen, read and write. English is not just a subject in a book – it is a key that opens doors to new jobs, new friends, new places and new ideas.

You can do it. In fact, you are already doing it.

Good luck, and enjoy your English journey!

Answer Key

Check your answers after you finish each exercise. If you made a mistake, go back and read the lesson again.

How to Use This Book

Getting ready: **1.** 30 to 60 minutes **2.** 30 minutes every day **3.** "make a decision" (learn phrases) **4.** ✗ = wrong, ✓ = right **5.** New words, Phrases, Mistakes, Diary

The English Alphabet and Sounds

Sounds and spelling: **1.** k **2.** t **3.** /ɪd/ **4.** /d/ **5.** /t/ **6.** two (watch-es) **7.** ba-NA-na (second syllable) **8.** pho-TO-gra-pher (second syllable) **9.** up (yes/no question) **10.** sheep **11.** h **12.** b

Parts of Speech: The 8 Word Families

Name the part of speech of the word in bold: **1.** noun **2.** verb **3.** adjective **4.** adverb **5.** preposition **6.** conjunction **7.** pronoun **8.** interjection **9.** adverb **10.** noun

Put the words in the correct order: **1.** We play football on Sundays. **2.** My mother drinks tea every morning. **3.** He bought a new phone yesterday. **4.** They study English at school. **5.** It is cold today.

Nouns: Singular, Plural, Countable, Uncountable

Write the plural: **1.** books **2.** boxes **3.** cities **4.** children **5.** knives **6.** teeth **7.** boys **8.** women **9.** potatoes **10.** sheep **11.** people **12.** watches

Countable (C) or uncountable (U)?: **1.** C **2.** U **3.** U **4.** C **5.** U **6.** U **7.** C **8.** U **9.** C **10.** U

Correct the mistake: **1.** I have a lot of homework. **2.** Can you give me some advice / a piece of advice? **3.** The news is very good. **4.** This is my uncle's house. **5.** The children are playing.

Articles: A, An and The

Write a, an, the or – (no article): **1.** an **2.** a **3.** The **4.** – (no article) **5.** an **6.** the **7.** – (no article) **8.** the **9.** an **10.** the **11.** – (no article) **12.** an **13.** The **14.** The **15.** a

Pronouns and Possessives

Choose the correct pronoun: **1.** I **2.** us **3.** my **4.** ours **5.** herself **6.** They're **7.** its **8.** him **9.** Whose **10.** those **11.** I **12.** yours **13.** Everybody **14.** themselves **15.** You're

The Verb "To Be"

Complete with am, is or are: **1.** am **2.** is **3.** are **4.** is **5.** are **6.** Are **7.** are **8.** is

Complete with was or were: **1.** was **2.** were **3.** Was **4.** were **5.** was

Correct the mistakes: **1.** I am 30 years old. **2.** She agrees with you. **3.** In my village there is a big temple. **4.** Yes, I am. **5.** There are two cats in the garden.

Have and Have Got

Complete with have, has, don't have or doesn't have: **1.** has **2.** don't have **3.** Does **4.** have **5.** doesn't have **6.** have

Correct the mistakes: **1.** She has a beautiful voice. **2.** Does he have a car? **3.** I have two sisters. **4.** He doesn't have a passport. **5.** We had fun at the party.

Adjectives: Describing Things

Choose the correct word: **1.** boring **2.** interested **3.** surprised **4.** tiring **5.** excited

Write the comparative and superlative: **1.** cheaper, the cheapest **2.** bigger, the biggest **3.** happier, the happiest **4.** better, the best **5.** more expensive, the most expensive **6.** worse, the worst **7.** nicer, the nicest **8.** farther/further, the farthest/furthest

Correct the mistakes: **1.** My sister is younger than me. **2.** This is the best restaurant. **3.** He isn't tall enough to play basketball. **4.** I bought two new books. **5.** This exercise is easier. **6.** She is as tall as her brother.

Adverbs: How, When, Where, How Often

Adjective or adverb?: **1.** careful **2.** carefully **3.** well **4.** easy **5.** easily **6.** hard **7.** quietly **8.** sad (after "look", use an adjective)

Put the adverb in the correct place: **1.** I never drink coffee. **2.** She is always happy. **3.** They sometimes play tennis. **4.** We have never been to Goa. **5.** He is often late for work.

Prepositions of Time, Place and Movement

Complete with at, on or in: **1.** in **2.** at **3.** on **4.** in **5.** at **6.** in **7.** on **8.** on **9.** at **10.** in **11.** on **12.** at **13.** in **14.** on **15.** in

Choose the correct preposition: **1.** since **2.** for **3.** at **4.** for you **5.** at **6.** of **7.** to **8.** to me **9.** by **10.** into

Some, Any, Much, Many and Other Quantifiers

Choose the correct word: **1.** any **2.** some **3.** much **4.** many **5.** a lot of **6.** a little **7.** a few **8.** too much **9.** any **10.** Both

Numbers, Dates, Time and Money

Write in words: **1.** fifteen **2.** fifty **3.** three hundred and forty-two **4.** third **5.** twelfth **6.** (a) quarter to eight / seven forty-five **7.** half past nine / nine thirty **8.** twenty twenty-six **9.** one thousand five hundred / fifteen hundred **10.** twenty-first

Present Simple

Write the correct form of the verb: **1.** goes **2.** don't like **3.** Does ... play **4.** watches **5.** don't live **6.** cries **7.** freezes **8.** Do ... speak **9.** has **10.** doesn't eat **11.** does ... work **12.** opens

Correct the mistakes: **1.** He goes to work at 8. **2.** She doesn't speak English. **3.** Does she like music? **4.** I have known him for years. **5.** Where do you live? **6.** My brother studies at university.

Present Continuous

Present simple or continuous?: **1.** is sleeping **2.** walk **3.** is coming **4.** doesn't eat **5.** are ... doing **6.** boils **7.** are meeting **8.** don't understand **9.** is working **10.** Do ... like **11.** is getting **12.** think

Present Perfect

Complete with the present perfect: **1.** have finished **2.** has never seen **3.** Have ... been **4.** haven't arrived **5.** has lost **6.** have lived **7.** Has ... eaten **8.** have just called

For or since?: **1.** for **2.** since **3.** since **4.** for **5.** since **6.** for

Past simple or present perfect?: **1.** saw **2.** Have ... tried **3.** went **4.** have known **5.** did ... start **6.** have forgotten **7.** moved **8.** has worked

Present Perfect Continuous

Complete with the present perfect continuous: **1.** have been waiting **2.** has been learning **3.** has been raining **4.** have ... been living **5.** have been playing **6.** has been working

Simple or continuous?: **1.** read **2.** been reading **3.** known **4.** been cleaning **5.** finished

Past Simple

Write the past simple: **1.** went **2.** played **3.** bought **4.** studied **5.** ate **6.** stopped **7.** saw **8.** wrote **9.** thought **10.** taught

Complete the sentences: **1.** visited **2.** didn't come **3.** Did ... enjoy **4.** had **5.** lost **6.** did ... go **7.** didn't see **8.** met **9.** did ... say **10.** started ... finished

Correct the mistakes: **1.** I didn't see him. **2.** Did you go to school? **3.** She bought a new dress. **4.** I saw him yesterday. **5.** We went to the cinema last night.

Past Continuous

Complete with past simple or past continuous: **1.** was reading ... went **2.** were ... doing **3.** cut ... was cooking **4.** were watching ... called **5.** were playing ... started **6.** saw ... was waiting **7.** was snowing ... woke up **8.** wasn't listening ... was explaining

Past Perfect

Complete with the past perfect: **1.** had eaten **2.** had lost **3.** had never flown **4.** had escaped **5.** Had ... finished **6.** hadn't studied

Past Perfect Continuous

Complete with the past perfect continuous: **1.** had been running **2.** had been waiting **3.** had been working **4.** had been raining **5.** had ... been driving

Used To and Would (Past Habits)

Complete with used to / didn't use to / use to: **1.** used to **2.** didn't use to **3.** use to **4.** used to **5.** used to

Choose the correct form: **1.** getting **2.** work **3.** living **4.** used to

Present Continuous and Present Simple for the Future

Will or going to?: **1.** 'll (will) **2.** 's going to **3.** 're going to **4.** 'll (will) **5.** 'll (will) **6.** 's going to **7.** won't **8.** 're going to

Correct the mistakes: **1.** I will go to the shop. **2.** When I finish, I'll call you. **3.** She will come tomorrow. **4.** If it rains, we will stay home. **5.** Are you going to study tonight?

Future Continuous

Complete with the future continuous: **1.** will be lying **2.** will be teaching **3.** Will ... be using **4.** will be having **5.** will be driving

Future Perfect

Complete with the future perfect: **1.** will have finished **2.** will have saved **3.** will have started **4.** Will ... have read **5.** will have built

Future Perfect Continuous

Complete with the future perfect continuous: **1.** will have been studying **2.** will have been living **3.** will have been working

All 12 Tenses: Summary and Review

Mixed tenses – choose the correct form: **1.** have lived **2.** are dancing **3.** went **4.** were having **5.** drinks **6.** had closed **7.** will be **8.** Have ... met **9.** have been waiting **10.** will be travelling **11.** haven't seen **12.** boils **13.** played / used to play **14.** is going to study / is studying **15.** will have finished **16.** was cooking **17.** don't understand **18.** are meeting **19.** will have been working **20.** had been walking

Asking Questions

Make questions: **1.** Where does she live? **2.** What are they watching? **3.** Where did he go? **4.** What time do you get up? **5.** How much does the bag cost? / How much is

the bag? **6.** Who broke the window? **7.** How many sisters do you have? **8.** Why is she crying? **9.** How often do you go to the gym? **10.** How long does it take?

Add question tags: **1.** aren't you **2.** can she **3.** didn't they **4.** does he **5.** haven't we **6.** aren't I **7.** shall we **8.** won't it

Make the questions polite: **1.** Could you tell me where the toilet is? **2.** Do you know what time the bank closes? **3.** Do you know if this seat is free?

Negative Sentences

Make these sentences negative: **1.** I don't like football. **2.** She isn't a doctor. **3.** They didn't go to school. **4.** He can't drive. **5.** We haven't finished. **6.** She doesn't speak French. **7.** I won't come. **8.** It wasn't cold.

Correct the double negatives: **1.** I don't want anything. / I want nothing. **2.** Nobody helped me. **3.** She doesn't know anybody here.

Modal Verbs: Can, Could, Must, Should and More

Choose the correct modal: **1.** could **2.** mustn't **3.** don't have to **4.** should **5.** Shall **6.** Would **7.** must **8.** can't **9.** Could **10.** might

Correct the mistakes: **1.** She can sing very well. **2.** You must wear a seatbelt. **3.** Can you speak English? **4.** I had to work yesterday. **5.** He should study more. **6.** I'd like a cup of tea, please.

Complete with should have / must have / could have: **1.** should have told **2.** must have rained **3.** could have fallen

Conditionals: If Sentences

First conditional: **1.** rains ... will take **2.** don't eat ... will be **3.** will be ... are **4.** see ... will tell **5.** study ... will fail

Second conditional: **1.** had ... would drive **2.** knew ... would tell **3.** would ... do ... won **4.** were ... would accept **5.** would go ... was/were

Third conditional: **1.** had known ... would have come **2.** had studied ... would have passed **3.** wouldn't have been ... had taken **4.** had called ... would have helped

Write a wish: **1.** I wish I had a job. **2.** I wish I could speak French. **3.** I wish I had gone to the party. **4.** I wish I were/was tall.

The Passive Voice

Change to passive: **1.** The room is cleaned every day. **2.** My phone was stolen. **3.** A new hospital is being built. **4.** The match has been cancelled. **5.** The parcel will be delivered tomorrow. **6.** Hamlet was written by Shakespeare. **7.** A helmet must be worn. **8.** Spanish is spoken in Mexico.

Complete with the correct passive form: **1.** was born **2.** is made **3.** was caught **4.** is being repaired **5.** will be announced

Reported Speech

Change to reported speech: **1.** She said (that) she was happy. **2.** He said (that) he lived in Mumbai. **3.** They said (that) they would come the next day. **4.** She said (that) she had seen the film the day before. **5.** He said (that) he couldn't swim. **6.** She asked me where I worked. **7.** He asked if/whether I was hungry. **8.** The teacher told me to close the door. **9.** She told the children not to touch it. **10.** He said (that) he had lost his keys.

Say or tell?: **1.** told **2.** said **3.** tell **4.** said **5.** tell

Gerunds and Infinitives

Gerund or infinitive?: **1.** swimming **2.** to become **3.** to sell **4.** opening **5.** meeting **6.** to call **7.** making **8.** to get **9.** drawing **10.** to buy **11.** helping **12.** to talk **13.** smoking **14.** stay **15.** to turn off

Relative Clauses: Who, Which, That, Where, Whose

Complete with who, which, where or whose: **1.** who **2.** where **3.** which/that **4.** whose **5.** who/that **6.** which/that **7.** where **8.** whose

Join the sentences: **1.** I have a friend who speaks five languages. **2.** This is the café where I met my wife. **3.** She bought a dress which/that was very expensive. **4.** I know a man whose daughter is an actress.

Linking Words and Conjunctions

Choose the best linking word: **1.** so **2.** but **3.** because of **4.** Although **5.** Despite **6.** such **7.** so **8.** to **9.** in case **10.** such as **11.** First **12.** both

Punctuation and Capital Letters

Add capital letters and punctuation: **1.** My name is Ali and I live in Dubai. **2.** Where do you work? **3.** I bought eggs, milk, bread and butter. **4.** We met on Monday in June. **5.** It's my brother's car.

Irregular Verbs: The Complete List

Write the past simple and past participle: **1.** went, gone **2.** ate, eaten **3.** wrote, written **4.** bought, bought **5.** took, taken **6.** saw, seen **7.** began, begun **8.** brought, brought **9.** spoke, spoken **10.** drank, drunk **11.** flew, flown **12.** taught, taught **13.** chose, chosen **14.** forgot, forgotten **15.** put, put **16.** ran, run **17.** caught, caught **18.** broke, broken **19.** knew, known **20.** swam, swum

Topic Vocabulary 1: People, Family and the Body

Family words: **1.** uncle **2.** cousin **3.** niece **4.** mother-in-law **5.** grandmother **6.** nephew

Opposites: **1.** mean / selfish **2.** lazy **3.** impatient **4.** rude **5.** shy / insecure **6.** dishonest

Topic Vocabulary 2: Home and Daily Life

Write the room: **1.** kitchen **2.** bedroom **3.** bathroom **4.** garage **5.** living room

Make or do?: **1.** make **2.** do **3.** do **4.** do **5.** do

Topic Vocabulary 3: Food and Drink

How do you cook it?: **1.** bake **2.** boil **3.** fry **4.** peel **5.** slice

Describe the taste: **1.** sour **2.** spicy / hot **3.** sweet **4.** bitter **5.** salty / crunchy

Topic Vocabulary 4: Clothes, Shopping and Money

Borrow or lend?: **1.** borrow **2.** lend **3.** borrowed **4.** lends

Complete the shopping dialogue: **1.** looking **2.** try **3.** does **4.** take **5.** change

Topic Vocabulary 5: Work, Jobs and the Office

Who does this job?: **1.** mechanic **2.** pilot **3.** plumber **4.** hairdresser / barber **5.** architect **6.** journalist / reporter

Complete the sentences: **1.** as **2.** for **3.** promotion **4.** deadline **5.** in

Topic Vocabulary 6: Health and the Doctor

What's the matter?: **1.** headache **2.** sore **3.** fever / temperature **4.** cold **5.** prescription **6.** appointment

Topic Vocabulary 7: Travel, Transport and Places

Complete the travel sentences: **1.** miss **2.** get **3.** took **4.** book / reserve **5.** aisle **6.** straight

Topic Vocabulary 8: Nature, Weather and Animals

Weather: **1.** humid **2.** fog **3.** heavy **4.** drought **5.** like

Topic Vocabulary 9: Education, Technology and Media

Choose the correct verb: **1.** do **2.** passed **3.** attach **4.** password **5.** charge **6.** took

150 Essential Phrasal Verbs

Complete with the correct phrasal verb: **1.** look after **2.** turn off **3.** run out of **4.** give up **5.** ran into **6.** takes after **7.** called off **8.** get up **9.** fill in **10.** put up with **11.** looking forward **12.** broke up **13.** pick ... up **14.** look up **15.** Watch out

100 Common Idioms and Expressions

Match the idiom to its meaning: **1.** very easy **2.** a little ill **3.** extremely happy **4.** very expensive **5.** very rarely **6.** go to bed **7.** start a conversation **8.** stop working for today **9.** unexpectedly **10.** watch carefully

Collocations: Words That Go Together

Make or do?: **1.** make **2.** do **3.** make **4.** do **5.** make **6.** do **7.** do **8.** make **9.** do **10.** make

Take, have, get or give?: **1.** take **2.** have **3.** get **4.** give **5.** take / have **6.** have **7.** get **8.** give **9.** take / have **10.** have

Confusing Words

Choose the correct word: **1.** tell **2.** heard **3.** take **4.** lost **5.** than **6.** stole **7.** funny **8.** remind **9.** earns **10.** quiet **11.** check **12.** alone

Greetings, Introductions and Goodbyes

Complete the conversation: **1.** meet **2.** are **3.** from **4.** do **5.** later / soon **6.** Nice / Pleased

Small Talk: Easy Conversation Topics

Choose the best response: **1.** (a) Good for you! Congratulations! **2.** (b) Oh, I'm so sorry to hear that. **3.** (a) Me too! Have you tried the new pizza place? **4.** (b) Yes, it was really relaxing...

Everyday Functions: Phrases You Need Every Day

Choose the most polite option: **1.** (b) **2.** (b) **3.** (a) **4.** (b) **5.** (b)

Complete with a suitable phrase: **1.** Congratulations! / Well done! **2.** welcome **3.** worry **4.** Why **5.** please

At a Restaurant or Café

Restaurant language: **1.** the waiter **2.** Could we see the menu, please? **3.** Could we have the bill, please? **4.** Will you eat here or take the food with you?

Job Interviews

Interview language: **1.** Could you repeat the question, please? **2.** Thank you for your time. I look forward to hearing from you. **3.** learner **4.** No

Reading Practice: 10 Short Stories

Story 1 questions: **1.** She is 22 (years old). **2.** In a bank in the city. **3.** One hour. **4.** A new blue dress. **5.** Rita (a colleague). **6.** Happy – she said it was a great day.

Story 2 questions: **1.** It was rainy. **2.** A (brown leather) wallet. **3.** About 10,000 rupees. **4.** It was for his wife's medicine. **5.** No, he didn't. **6.** tears

Story 3 questions: **1.** A week. **2.** Towels, sunscreen, sandwiches, fruit and water. **3.** Shells. **4.** A (huge) sandcastle. **5.** Dolphins. **6.** crowded

Story 4 questions: **1.** Because he was (extremely) thirsty. **2.** The pot was tall and his beak couldn't reach the water. **3.** Small stones. **4.** It rose (came up). **5.** Where there's a will, there's a way.

Story 5 questions: **1.** Because he fell into a river when he was seven. **2.** His daughter, Aisha. **3.** It's never too late. She/he had taught people who were 70. **4.** Nervous/afraid – his heart was beating fast. **5.** Three months. **6.** Don't let fear stop you from learning something new.

Story 6 questions: **1.** Two or three. **2.** Read just two pages every night before sleeping. **3.** About three minutes. **4.** 24. **5.** Starting small and doing it every single day (not motivation).

Story 7 questions: **1.** More than twenty. **2.** His spoken English was weak / he was too shy to practise. **3.** He recorded himself answering interview questions. **4.** His cousin (who worked in Canada). **5.** "I'm sorry, could you rephrase that, please?" **6.** felt embarrassed (made an uncomfortable face)

Story 8 questions: **1.** Fifteen years. **2.** Because of an argument about a tree. **3.** Water was coming into her kitchen (a pipe had broken). **4.** Nearly two hours. **5.** Mr Ahmed helps her pick the fruit and she gives him half. **6.** hesitate

Story 9 questions: **1.** 100 teenagers. **2.** Anxious and bored. **3.** Talking more, reading books, playing cricket, sleeping better (any two). **4.** Six hours. **5.** No – about half decided to reduce their screen time.

Story 10 questions: **1.** Because they were afraid people would laugh. **2.** Give a presentation in English to 300 people. **3.** Said "very exciting" instead of "very excited". **4.** Yourself last month (who you were last month). **5.** Listen every day; read things you enjoy; talk to yourself; write sentences each night; be kind to yourself (any two).

Listening Skills

What do these mean?: **1.** I'm going to call her. **2.** I don't know. **3.** Let me see. **4.** I've got to go (I have to go). **5.** You should have told me.

Writing: Sentences and Paragraphs

Improve the sentences: **1.** I like cricket. (Better: I really like cricket because it's exciting to watch with friends.) **2.** She is a teacher. **3.** Yesterday I went to the park. **4.** Example: The food was delicious, especially the spicy chicken curry.

Writing Emails and Messages

Formal or informal?: **1.** informal **2.** formal **3.** formal **4.** informal **5.** formal **6.** formal

Write a formal version: **1.** Could you please send me the report? **2.** I apologise for the delay in replying. **3.** Please find attached my CV. / I have attached my CV.

Final Test: Check Your Progress

Final test – Part A: Grammar: **1.** works **2.** don't like **3.** 's snowing / is snowing **4.** saw **5.** Have ... been **6.** since **7.** had ... started **8.** rains **9.** were / was **10.** was built **11.** was **12.** reading **13.** to learn **14.** who **15.** taller **16.** the **17.** in **18.** on **19.** mustn't **20.** Could / Can

Final test – Part B: Vocabulary and phrases: **1.** expensive **2.** make **3.** do **4.** borrow **5.** stop it / switch it off **6.** very easy **7.** bought **8.** written **9.** aunt **10.** boring **11.** have lost **12.** children **13.** looking forward **14.** stop trying / quit **15.** a little ill

Final test – Part C: Everyday English: **1.** Could we have the bill, please? **2.** You're welcome. / No problem. **3.** Sorry, could you say that again, please? **4.** I'm fine, thanks. And you? **5.** How much is it? / How much does it cost? **6.** Yours sincerely, / Kind regards, **7.** I'd love to, but I'm busy. / Thanks for asking, but I can't. **8.** I agree with you. **9.** He doesn't know. **10.** Where do you live? **11.** I am 25 years old. **12.** Can you tell me where the bank is? **13.** I didn't go. **14.** Listen to me. **15.** I took my exam.